

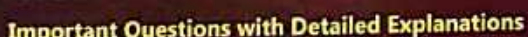


Chapter-wise & Topic-wise

CLASS 12



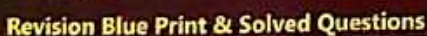
Chapter wise CONCEPT MAPS



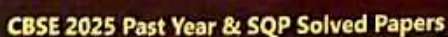
NCERT EXERCISES



PYQs



COMPETENCY FOCUSED



LATEST CBSE PAPERS



MOCK TESTS



ENGLISH CORE

Section-C**(40 marks)****Literature Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text**

This section will have variety of assessment items including Multiple Choice Questions, Objective Type Questions, Short Answer Type Questions and Long Answer Type Questions to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, evaluation and extrapolation beyond the text.

7. One Poetry extract out of two, from the book Flamingo, to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, inference and appreciation. **(6 × 1 = 6 Marks)**
8. One Prose extract out of two, from the book Vistas, to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, evaluation and appreciation. **(4 × 1 = 4 Marks)**
9. One prose extract out of two from the book Flamingo, to assess comprehension, interpretation, analysis, inference and evaluation. **(6 × 1 = 6 Marks)**
10. Short answer type questions (from Prose and Poetry from the book Flamingo), to be answered in 40-50 words each. Questions should elicit inferential responses through critical thinking. Five questions out of the six given, are to be answered. **(5 × 2 = 10 Marks)**
11. Short answer type questions, from Prose (Vistas), to be answered in 40-50 words each. Questions should elicit inferential responses through critical thinking. Any two out of three questions to be done. **(2 × 2 = 4 Marks)**
12. One Long answer type question, from Prose/Poetry (Flamingo), to be answered in 120-150 words. Questions can be based on incident / theme / passage / extract / event as reference points to assess extrapolation beyond and across the text. The question will elicit analytical and evaluative response from the student. Any one out of two questions to be done. **(1 × 5 = 5 Marks)**
13. One Long answer type question, based on the chapters from the book Vistas, to be answered in 120-150 words, to assess global comprehension and extrapolation beyond the text. Questions to provide analytical and evaluative responses using incidents, events, themes, as reference points. Any one out of two questions to be done. **(1 × 5 = 5 Marks)**

Question Paper Design

Section	Competencies	Total marks
Reading Skills	Conceptual understanding, decoding, Analyzing, inferring, interpreting, appreciating, literary, conventions and vocabulary, summarizing and using appropriate format/s.	22
Creative Writing Sills	Conceptual Understanding, application of rules, Analysis, Reasoning, appropriacy of style and tone, using appropriate format and fluency, inference, analysis, evaluation and creativity.	18
Literature Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text	Recalling, reasoning, critical thinking, appreciating literary convention, inference, analysis, creativity with fluency.	40
	TOTAL	80
Internal Assessment	Assessment of Listening and Speaking Skills	10
	☐ Listening	5 + 5
	☐ Speaking	
	☐ Project Work	10
	GRAND TOTAL	100

Chapter-wise Weightage and Trend Analysis of CBSE Past 6 Years' Papers

CHAPTERS	2020	2022	2023	2024	2025
Literary Passage	12	8	10	12	12
Case Based Factual Passage	8	6	10	10	10
Notice	-	-	5	4	4
Advertisement/Poster Making	4	-	-	-	-
Debate/Speech Writing	10	-	-	-	-
Formal/Informal Invitation and Reply	-	3	5	4	4
Letter to Editor/Application for Job	6	5	5	5	5
Article/Report Writing	10	5	5	5	5
The Last Lesson	6	-	2	2, 5*	2, 6
Lost Spring	2	-	2	6	2, 5*
Deep Water	2	-	6	2	5*
The Rattrap	6	2	2, 5	-	-
Indigo	2	2, 4	5	5*	-
Poets and Pancakes	4	-	-	6	6
The Interview	-	-	6	-	-
Going Places	-	-	2	2	2
My Mother at Sixty-Six (Poetry)	4	-	6	6	-
Keeping Quiet (Poetry)	2	-	-	2, 5*	2, 6, 5*
A Thing of Beauty (Poetry)	-	2, 4	2	2	2, 5*
A Roadside Stand (Poetry)	-	-	6, 2	6, 5*	2, 6
Aunt Jennifer's Tigers (Poetry)	-	2	-	2	-
The Third Level	2	-	4, 2	-	2
The Tiger King	6	-	2	4, 2	2
Journey to the End of the Earth	6	-	5	4	2, 5
The Enemy	2	-	-	2, 5	5
Should Wizard Hit Mommy (Rationalized)	2	-	-	-	-
On the Face of It	2	2	4, 2	5	4
Evans Tries an O-Level (Rationalized)	4	-	-	-	-
Memories of Childhood					
❑ The Cutting of My Long Hair	-	-	5	2	4
❑ We Too are Human Beings					

*The marks allotment mentioned above is chapter-wise and includes internal choice questions as well. Therefore, the total might not match the Maximum Marks of the respective Previous Year Paper.

**For the year 2021, the exam was not conducted

CONTENTS



Upcoming CBSE SQPs/
APQs can be accessed
through this QR

CBSE SOLVED PAPER 2025	i-xiv
CBSE SOLVED PAPER 2024	1-18
CBSE SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER	19-36
CBSE ADDITIONAL PRACTICE QUESTION	37-55

READING SKILLS

1. READING COMPREHENSION

I. LITERARY PASSAGE

II. CASE BASED FACTUAL PASSAGE



59-92



CREATIVE WRITING

1. NOTICE

95-100

2. FORMAL/INFORMAL INVITATION AND REPLY

101-109

3. LETTER TO EDITOR/APPLICATION FOR JOB

110-126

4. ARTICLE WRITING

127-131

5. REPORT WRITING

132-136



LITERATURE

Flamingo

1. THE LAST LESSON	139-145
2. LOST SPRING	146-152
3. DEEP WATER	153-158
4. THE RATTRAP	159-166
5. INDIGO	167-172
6. POETS AND PANCAKES	173-179
7. THE INTERVIEW	180-185
8. GOING PLACES	186-191



Poetry

1. MY MOTHER AT SIXTY-SIX	192-197
2. KEEPING QUIET	198-203
3. A THING OF BEAUTY	204-209
4. A ROADSIDE STAND	210-213
5. AUNT JENNIFER'S TIGERS	214-218

Vistas

1. THIRD LEVEL	219-223
2. THE TIGER KING	224-228
3. JOURNEY TO THE END OF THE EARTH	229-233
4. THE ENEMY	234-239
5. ON THE FACE OF IT	240-245
6. MEMORIES OF CHILDHOOD	246-251
CHAPTER MIX: LONG ANSWER QUESTIONS	252-267
MOCK TEST-1	269-275
MOCK TEST-2	276-282

CBSE SOLVED PAPER 2025

Time allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- (i) This question paper comprises 13 questions. All questions are compulsory.
- (ii) The question paper contains **THREE** sections -
Section - A: Reading Skills
Section - B: Creative Writing Skills
Section - C: Literature
- (iii) Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number and part thereof in your answer sheet.
- (iv) Separate instructions are given with each question / part, wherever necessary.
- (v) Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

SECTION - A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the text given below:

12 M

- (1) Having a sense of humour might mean having the ability to entertain other people by making them laugh, but it can also mean having a quick wit that is frequently employed to criticize other people with snide comments. Some might define the sense of humour as the ability to see humour in everyday life or as appreciating the cleverness of puns and other wordplay, and may think it entirely possible to possess a good sense of humour without ever having those around them become aware of it.
- (2) In any case, a sense of humour is a socially valued trait that almost all of us would prefer to have more, rather than less, of - akin to the way that we think about intelligence or good looks. A person with an undeveloped sense of humour lacks a social skill that puts him or her at a severe disadvantage in the hurly-burly of everyday social life.
- (3) Freud thought of humour as an outlet for forbidden impulses, and philosophers ranging from Aristotle to Descartes believed that we, are amused by something when it makes us feel superior to other people.
- (4) Evolutionary psychologists believe that humour, along with other creative abilities, such as art and music, evolved as an honest signal of intelligence and genetic quality. The value of such a skill in defusing tense, aggressive situations and in managing alliances and friendships should not be underestimated either.
- (5) Schmoozing with a bunch of new people at a cocktail party is an opportunity to engage in light hearted banter, and other people are grateful when someone is skillful enough to turn a stiff and awkward situation into fun. Cracking jokes, making witty remarks, and engaging in tongue-in-cheek observations about the social world can be like fishing for other minds that connect naturally with one's own. In other words, humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength.
- (6) Observing the performance of other people in such situations tips you off as to who you might like to get to know better - and who might be best left behind, wallowing in indignation and blank stares. In short, a sense of humour is the Swiss Army Knife of social skills. Perhaps it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools - each exquisitely designed for a unique social purpose.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage:

(i) How does the author prove in paragraph 1 that sense of humour is a double edged sword?

Ans. The author proves that humour is a double-edged sword by explaining that while it can entertain and make people laugh, it can also be used to hurt others through sarcastic or hurtful comments.

(ii) Cite evidences from the passage to prove that sense of humour is a valuable tool to make someone's life better.

Ans. The passage outlines the value of humour in many ways. It helps in easing tense situations (paragraph 4), fosters social connections (paragraph 5), and serves as a versatile social skill, useful in various social contexts (paragraph 6).

(iii) Complete the following sentence suitably with reference to paragraph 3.

One significant advantage of humour is that it helps one _____.

Ans. defuse tense, aggressive situations and in managing alliances

(iv) Provide ONE textual evidence with reference to paragraph 5, how a good sense of humour can be a great ice breaker.

Ans. Paragraph 5 clearly mentions, "Humour can turn a stiff and awkward situation into fun, which serves as an ice breaker."

(v) Select the correct option from those given in brackets to fill in the blank:

According to evolutionary psychologists, people with a sense of humour can _____ (trigger / lighten) tense situation.

Ans. lighten

(vi) Choose the correct option:

".... humour can be a device for connecting people who are operating on the same wavelength."

By the phrase 'same wavelength' the author refers to

(a) people of age group

(b) people who belong to same line of profession.

(c) people having similar interests and attitudes.

(d) people who are working in the same organisation.

Ans. (c) people having similar interests and attitudes.

(vii) Complete the analogy with one word from paragraph 6:

advantage : benefit :: _____ : anger

(a) situation

(b) stare

(c) indignation

(d) arsenal

Ans. (c) indignation

(viii) In the line perhaps it is indeed a single instrument, but it contains an arsenal of tools..... What does the phrase 'arsenal of tools' refer to?

Ans. The phrase "arsenal of tools" refers to the various ways in which a sense of humour serves multiple purposes in social interactions.

(ix) Provide ONE textual evidence from the text which states lack of sense of humour may prove to be a handicap in one's life.

Ans. Paragraph 2 clearly highlights the fact that "A person with an undeveloped sense of humour lacks a social skill, putting them at a severe disadvantage in everyday social life."

(x) An undeveloped sense of humour shows lack of a social skill that puts him or her at a disadvantage.

Choose the correct option (A) or (B) which reaffirms the idea conveyed in the above extract.

(a) Sense of humour elevates the status of a person in the Social circle.

(b) People with sense of humour are not taken seriously in the society.

Ans. (a) Sense of humour elevates the status of a person in the social circle.

2. Read the passage carefully :

10 M

(1) This report presents findings from the Youth Aspirations in India Survey in which 5,764 youth between the ages of 15 and 30 were asked about their employment, education, and skilling aspirations.

(2) Indian youth valued higher education. 50 percent of respondents aspire to attain a post-graduate degree, 24 percent a PhD, and 21 percent a bachelor's degree. Only 2 percent of respondents hope to attain a college or vocational diploma as their highest form of education.

- (3) Respondents have a strong preference for attaining higher education degrees. At the same time, there is an awareness of changing skills requirements and an interest in augmenting their skills. 76 percent of youth report being very interested in pursuing a skills development programme. 70 percent of youth identified more employment opportunities as the main motivation for wanting to pursue skills development training.
- (4) A study related to their job preference reveals their strong desire for job security and opportunities for career advancement. It is evident from the following data:

Percentage	Preference
49	Public Sector
23	Private Sector
17	Entrepreneurship

- (5) In the context of technological adoption and digitization, jobs and tasks, along with the competencies required to execute them, are changing. 86 percent of youth feel very or moderately up to date with changes in skills requirements. Yet, 39 percent of youth feel very prepared or prepared for their ideal job, while 16 percent of youth feel either not prepared or very unprepared for their ideal job.
- (6) Female respondents' education and employment aspirations match, if not exceed, those of male respondents. Yet, female respondents face discriminatory biases in hiring, have less paid work experience than their male counterparts, and face greater barriers in pursuing skills development opportunities. 60 percent of female respondents, for example, report having no paid work experience, compared to 54 percent of male respondents. In addition, 15 percent of female respondents report personal biases such as marital status, gender, age, or family background as a main barrier to employment compared to 9 percent of male respondents. While more female respondents report being very interested in participating in a skills development programme, only 19 percent have enrolled in a programme, compared to 26 percent of male respondents.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage:

- (i) As per the survey, Indian youth is broadly focussed on 1
- (a) skill development and entrepreneurship. (b) private sector jobs and technology.
(c) higher education and career opportunities. (d) vocational diploma and public sector jobs.
- Ans.** (c) higher education and career opportunities.
- (ii) With reference to paragraph 3, what is the latest trend among Indian youth in preparing themselves for the job market? 1
- Ans.** The emerging trend among Indian youth in preparing for the job market is their growing interest in pursuing skills development programmes, as they seek to improve their skill set and enhance employment opportunities.
- (iii) With reference to the table, state one for entrepreneurship being the last preference among Indian youth. 1
- Ans.** Entrepreneurship is the least preferred choice (17%) as youth prioritize job security and career advancement, with public (49%) and private sector (23%) jobs being more favorable options.
- (iv) Cite two evidences from the text to show that gender bias is still a hindrance in the progress of women in society. 2
- Ans.** 1. 60 percent of female respondents report having no paid work experience, while 54 percent of male respondents share the same situation.
2. 15 percent of female respondents mention personal biases, such as marital status, gender, age, or family background, as a major barrier to employment, compared to 9 percent of male respondents.
- (v) Complete the following sentence suitably. 1
- The driving force for the Indian youth to join a skill development programme is _____.
- Ans.** more employment opportunities
- (vi) Paragraph 5 uses words 'competencies' and 'adoption'. Classify the following sentences which talks about 'competency' and which talks about 'adoption'. 1
- Sentence-1: Ria embraced new technology to gain global, market for her paintings.
Sentence-2: Ria displays her artistic skill through her paintings.
- Ans.** 1. Adoption
2. Competency
- (vii) Cite two evidences from the text to show adapting that Indian youth is itself to the needs of the job market. 2
- Ans.** 1. 76% of youth report a high interest in pursuing skill development programmes to adapt to the evolving job market.
2. 86% of youth feel well-prepared or moderately up to date with changing skill requirements for their ideal job.

(viii) Cite two evidences from the text to show adapting that Indian youth is itself to the needs of the job market.

The main road blocks to employment opportunities for females are:

- | | |
|-------------------------|----------------------------|
| (i) people of age group | (ii) lack of interest |
| (iii) marriage | (iv) lack of opportunities |
| (v) over qualification | (vi) family background |
| (a) (i) & (ii) | (b) (iii) & (iv) |
| (c) (ii), (iii) & (v) | (d) (iv) & (v) |

Ans. (c) (ii), (iii), & (v)

SECTION-B

Creative Writing Skills

(18 marks)

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

3. Attempt ANY ONE of the two (A) or (B) in about 50 words.

(A) Your school is organizing a road safety awareness workshop for students of class IX - XII. As the head boy of your school, draft a notice informing the students about the workshop. Include other necessary details. You are Ashna/Ashish. Put your notice in a box.

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

NOTICE
ABC School
Road Safety Awareness Workshop

March 11, 2025
Dear Students (Class IX - XII),
Date: March 11, 2025
Time: 2:00 PM
Venue: Main Auditorium
All students of Class IX to XII are invited to attend a workshop on road safety. Please confirm your attendance with your class teacher by March 18. Let's work together for safer roads!
Sincerely
Ashna
Head Girl

OR

(B) Your school is organizing an Inter-House Science Model-Making Competition. As President of the Science Club, draft a notice to inform all House members from IX - XII about the competition and specify the number of registrations invited per house. Include other necessary details. You are Mitali/Mukesh. Put your notice in a box.

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

NOTICE
ABC School
Inter-House Science Model-Making Competition

March 11, 2025
Dear Students (Class IX - XII),
The Science Club is organizing an Inter-House Science Model-Making Competition. Each house can register a maximum of 5 participants.
Date: March 18, 2025
Time: 10:00 AM
Venue: Science Lab
Register with your House Captain by **March 15, 2025**. Models will be judged on creativity, functionality, and scientific relevance. Let's make this event a success!
Sincerely
Mukesh
President, Science Club
ABC School

4. Attempt ANY ONE of the two (A) or (B) in about 50 words.

4 M

- (A) Draft an invitation card on behalf of the Principal of J.B. Bhatia Public School for the launch of 'Yoga for Life' programme in the School. Mention a compelling highlight of the programme along with other necessary details.

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

Invitation to 'Yoga for Life' Programme J.B. BHATIA PUBLIC SCHOOL Dear Students, We invite you to the launch of 'Yoga for Life' on March 5, 2025, at 9:30 AM in the School Auditorium. Join us for an exclusive session with Mr. Ravi Sharma, a renowned yoga expert, to promote wellness. Warm Regards Dr. Ahluwalia Principal, J.B. Bhatia Public School

OR

- (B) You are Mrs. Savita Manjrekhar, a professor in English. You are invited to be one of the judges for the inter-school debate competition by the Principal of J.M. Public School, Cochin. Write a formal letter expressing your inability to accept the invitation.

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

Mrs. Savita Manjrekhar
Professor in English,
Xavier College,
Cochin, Kerala

March 26, 2025

The Principal
J.M. Public School,
Cochin, Kerala

Dear Sir/Madam,

I hope this message finds you well. I am honored by your invitation to be a judge for the inter-school debate competition. Unfortunately, due to prior commitments, I am unable to accept the invitation. I sincerely regret not being able to participate, as I know the event will be a great success.

I wish the participants all the best and hope to contribute in the future.

Sincerely

Mrs. Savita Manjrekhar

5. Attempt ANY ONE of the two (A) or (B) in about 120-150 words.

5 M

- (A) You are Ajay of 36, N.J. Colony, Pune. You read the advertisement and wish to apply for the post advertised. Write this job application along with your bio-data.

Bloom Public School, Bhopal Requires	
Hockey Coach -	Graduates with B.P.Ed degree preferred. Minimum 4 years experience.
Skills -	Well versed in defence techniques, knowledge of physical and psychological performance development. Ability to foster team culture and promote sportsmanship. Prepare students for state/national championships.
Write to The Principal, Bloom Public School, Bhopal	

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Organisation- 1 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

Ajay
36, N.J. Colony,
Pune

March 26, 2025

The Principal
Bloom Public School,
Bhopal

Subject: Application for the Post of Hockey Coach

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to apply for the post of hockey coach at your esteemed institution, as advertised. I am a graduate with a B.P. degree and have four years of experience in coaching hockey at various schools. I possess in-depth knowledge of defense techniques, physical and psychological performance development, and am adept at fostering team culture and promoting sportsmanship.

I have also prepared students for state and national championships and am confident that my skills align with your requirements. Please find my bio-data attached for your reference.

I look forward to the opportunity to contribute to the growth of sports at Bloom Public School.

Sincerely

Ajay

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Ajay
36, N.J. Colony,
Pune - 411001
Phone: +91 98765XXXXX
Email: ajay.email@gmail.com

Educational Qualification:

B.P.Ed (Bachelor of Physical Education) – [DY Patil Vidyapeeth, Pune], [2018]

Skills:

- In-depth knowledge of hockey defense techniques and strategies
- Expertise in physical and psychological training for athletes
- Leadership and team-building skills
- Ability to prepare students for state/national tournaments

Experience: Hockey Coach – [St. Mary's School], Pune (4 Years)

- Coached hockey teams, focusing on defense, physical fitness, and psychological development
- Led the team to district and state-level championships

Languages: English, Hindi

Hobbies:

- Training and fitness development
- Watching and analyzing sports
- Mentoring young athletes

Ajay

(Signature)

OR

- (B) Social literacy is increasingly recognized as a crucial 21st century skill for young individuals. Write a letter to the editor of a local daily discussing the benefits of providing social literacy education to children. Also, suggest effective ways to raise awareness about the importance of this education among parents. You may use some of the given cues along with your own ideas to draft the letter. You are a counsellor, Reena Sharma of 36, M.V. Apartments, Pune.

- What is social literacy ?
- What is the role of school in imparting social literacy to young students ?
- What are the benefits of social literacy?
- How is social literacy connected to career advancement ?

Ans. * *Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Organisation- 1 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M*

Reena Sharma
36, M.V. Apartments,
Pune

March 26, 2025

The Editor
The Times Daily
Pune

Subject: Importance of Social Literacy for Children

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to highlight the growing importance of social literacy as a crucial 21st-century skill for children. Social literacy helps individuals understand and navigate social systems, improving their communication, collaboration, and problem-solving abilities. Schools play an essential role in imparting this education, as it fosters responsible and empathetic citizens. The benefits of social literacy include better interpersonal relationships, the ability to work in diverse teams, and enhanced career prospects. Socially literate children are also better prepared for challenges in a fast-evolving world. To raise awareness among parents, schools can organize workshops and distribute informative materials, emphasizing the long-term benefits of teaching children to engage positively with society.

I hope this letter serves as a reminder of the significant role, schools & communities can play in fostering these essential skills for the next generation.

Sincerely

Reena Sharma

6. Attempt ANY ONE of the two (A) or (B) in about 120-150 words

5 M

(A) Write an article on the commercialisation of festivals, analyzing the reasons for commercialisation and its impact on the younger generation. You may use some of the given cues along with your own ideas. You are Vinita Yadav of XII B.

- impact of globalization on celebration of festivals.
- sanctity & essence of festivals.
- role of Media in commercializing festivals.
- Suggest ways in which individuals and communities can work together to preserve tradition and culture in the celebration of festivals.

Ans. * *Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Organisation- 1 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M*

Commercialization of Festivals

By Vinita Yadav, XII B

The younger generation, influenced by media, tends to focus more on material aspects such as shopping, gifts, and entertainment, rather than the core cultural rituals. Commercialization also distorts the social purpose of festivals, making them more about buying products than connecting with family and community.

Festivals, which were once celebrated with deep cultural significance and traditional values, are now increasingly commercialized. The impact of globalization has brought in a new wave of consumerism, turning festivals into opportunities for profit. The essence and sanctity of these festivals are often lost as markets, advertisements, and the media dominate the celebrations.

To preserve the sanctity of festivals, individuals and communities must work together. Efforts can include promoting traditional rituals, educating the youth about the cultural importance of festivals, and encouraging sustainable practices over consumerism. This way, we can ensure that the true spirit of festivals remains alive.

OR

- (B) You are Suraj, reporter of The Times of India. You are sent to cover the Mango Festival organized at the farmer's market. Write a comprehensive report detailing the activities at the festival. Include descriptions of the events, participation details, the overall impact of these activities on the local community. You may organize your report by following -
Who - What - When - Why - How.

Ans. * Format - 1 M, Content - 2 M, Organisation- 1 M, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1 M

Mango Festival at Farmer's Market
By Suraj, Reporter, The Times of India

On March 25, 2025: The Mango Festival at the Farmer's Market celebrated the rich mango harvest and local agriculture. The event, organized by the Farmer's Market Association, attracted a diverse crowd of farmers, residents, and visitors. The festival featured mango tasting sessions, a mango recipe competition, and stalls showcasing various mango varieties including organic and rare types. Local chefs also held live demonstrations, showcasing creative uses of mango in cooking. Held from 10:00 AM to 6:00 PM, the festival promoted local produce and contributed to the community's economy by boosting mango sales. The event highlighted sustainable farming and fostered stronger connections between local farmers and the urban population.

This initiative provided a platform for the local community to celebrate and support local agriculture while learning more about sustainable farming practices.

SECTION-C

Literature, Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text

(40 Marks)

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the given two of the given two (A) or (B) :

6 × 1 =

- (A) It is in the news that all these pitiful kin
Are to be bought out and mercifully gathered in
To live in villages, next to the theatre and the store.
Where they won't have to think for themselves anymore,
While greedy good-doers, beneficent beasts of prey,
Swarm over their lives enforcing benefits
That are calculated to soothe them out of their wits,
And by teaching them how to sleep they sleep all day
Destroy their sleeping at night the ancient way.

(A Roadside Stand)

- (i) The expression 'It is in the news' Suggests
(a) It is good news for the roadside stand owners.
(b) An important decision has been taken by the government.
(c) The roadside stand owners have protested against the government.
(d) That the news was not there in the newspaper

Ans. (b) an important decision has been taken by the government.

- (ii) Read the Assertion and the Reason below, with reference to the given extract.

Assertion : The poet complains that the rural people are exploited by the people in power.

Reason : The rural people reposed blind faith in the false promises of the people in power.

Choose the correct option regarding their relationship.

- (a) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true and the Reason is the correct explanation.
(b) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.
(c) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.
(d) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

Ans. (a) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true and the Reason is the correct explanation.

(iii) Complete the following suitably:

In the line that are calculated to soothe them out of their wits", the phrase 'soothe them out of their wit' refers to _____.

Ans. the false promises and supposed benefits offered by those in power, intended to make the poor forget their struggles and blindly accept their circumstances

(iv) Bring out the irony in the expression "they won't have to think for themselves".

Ans. The irony lies in the fact that while the government promises to improve their condition by taking decisions on their behalf, it takes away their independence and ability to make their own choices, turning them into passive dependents.

(v) Select the correct option from those given in brackets, to fill in the blank.

The poet uses the expression 'greedy good-doers' to _____ (criticize / appreciate) the intention of the powerful people.

Ans. criticize

(vi) Complete the following suitably.

The tone of the poet in the above extract is _____.

Ans. sarcastic and critical, highlighting the exploitation of the poor and exposing the false promises made to them

OR

(B) If we were not so single-minded

about keeping our lives moving,

and for once could do nothing

perhaps a huge silence

might interrupt this sadness

of never understanding ourselves with death.

Perhaps the Earth can teach us

as when everything seems dead

and later proves to be alive.

Now I'll count up to twelve

And you keep quiet and I will go.

(Keeping Quiet)

(i) Complete the following suitably.

The poet uses the expression 'single minded' to refer to _____.

Ans. people's focus on material progress and continuous activity without taking time for self-reflection or inner calm

(ii) Why does the poet refer to silence as a welcoming interruption?

Ans. The poet refers to silence as a welcoming interruption because it provides a break from the constant rush of life, allowing for reflection and self-awareness.

(iii) Read the Assertion and the Reason below, with reference to the given extract.

Assertion: The poet personifies Earth as a teacher.

Reason: We learn from the Earth that pausing doesn't mean the end.

Choose the correct option regarding their relationship.

(a) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.

(b) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, but the Reason is not the correct explanation of the Assertion.

(c) The Assertion is true, but the Reason is false.

(d) The Assertion is false, but the Reason is true.

Ans. (a) Both the Assertion and the Reason are true, and the Reason is the correct explanation of the Assertion.

(iv) Complete the following suitably.

By the expression keeping our lives moving" the poet refers to _____.

Ans. the constant rush of daily activities, where people stay occupied with their work and goals without taking a moment to pause and reflect

(v) Choose the correct option:

The intention of the poet in the above extract is

(a) to make us aware of the importance of Earth.

(b) to criticize our single mindedness.

(c) to highlight the reason for our sadness.

(d) to highlight the importance of sustaining peace and silence.

Ans. (d) to highlight the importance of sustaining peace and silence.

(vi) What is the significance of the last line of the extract 'you keep quiet and I will go'?

Ans. The poet highlights the value of silence and self-reflection. By saying, "You keep quiet and I will go," he implies that once people reach a state of peace and introspection, he will step away, allowing them to continue their personal journey of self-discovery.

8. Read the two extracts given below and answer the questions for ANY ONE. of the given two (A) or (B) :

4 × 1 =

(A) When I heard this, I didn't want to laugh any more, and I felt terribly sad. How could they believe that it was disgusting one of us held that package in his hands, even though the Vadai had been wrapped first in a banana leaf, and then parcelled in paper? I felt so provoked and angry that I wanted to touch those wretched Vadais myself straight away. Why should we have to fetch and carry for these people. I wondered. Such an important elder of ours goes meekly to the shops to fetch snacks and hands over reverently, bowing and shrinking, to this fellow who just sits there and stuffs them into his mouth. The thought of it infuriated me.

(*Memories of Childhood*)

(i) I felt terribly sad'. The reason for the speaker's sadness is because it was an act of.

Ans. discrimination and untouchability, where people of lower caste are not allowed to touch food meant for upper-caste individuals.

(ii) Choose the correct option:

'The thought of it infuriated me' with reference to the above line, what do you think is the impact of the incident on the speaker?

(a) The speaker was sympathetic and helpless.

(b) The speaker was angry and condemning.

(c) The speaker was excited to see the incident.

(d) The speaker was very impressed and motivated.

Ans. (b) The speaker was angry and condemning.

(iii) Complete the sentence suitably:

"I wanted to touch those wretched Vadais myself"

The above expression indicates the speaker's _____.

Ans. defiance and anger against discrimination.

(iv) Select the correct option from those given in brackets, to fill in the blank:

"The incident made the speaker realize that the discrimination was _____." (dehumanizing/elevating)

Ans. dehumanizing

OR

(B) Mr. Lamb : When I go down the streets, the kids shout Lamey Lamb'. But they will come into the garden, into my house; it's a game. They're not afraid of me. Why should they be? Because I'm not afraid of them, that's why not.

Derry : Did you get your leg blown off in the war?

Mr. Lamb : Certainly

Derry : How will you climb on a ladder and get the crab apples down, then ?

Mr. Lamb : Oh, there's a lot of things I've learned to do and plenty of time for it. Years. I take it steady. (*On the Face of it*)

(i) Complete the following suitably :

Years. I take it steady'. The above line speaks of the speaker's _____.

Ans. patience and perseverance

(ii) Derry, how will you climb on a ladder ? What does Derry hint at in the above query ?

Ans. Derry is hinting at Mr. Lamb's physical disability (his missing leg) and questioning how he manages to do everyday tasks despite this limitation.

- (iii) When I go down the streets, the kids shout Lamey Lamb.' The attitude of the speaker expressed in the above line is
- his habit of finding fault.
 - he is timid and faint hearted.
 - his acceptance of reality and positive attitude.
 - his indifferent and careless attitude.

Ans. (c) his acceptance of reality and positive attitude.

- (iv) Fill in the blank suitably :

Mr. Lamb's handicap has not _____ his attitude towards life.

Ans. affected

9. Read the two extracts given below and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the given two (A) or (B) : 6 × 1 = 6

(A) Those were the days of mainly indoor shooting, and only five percent Or the film was shot outdoors. I suppose the sets and studio lights needed the girls and boys to be made to look ugly in order to look Presentable in the movie. A strict hierarchy was maintained in the make-up department. The chief make-up man made the chief actors and actresses ugly, his senior assistant 'second' hero and heroine, the junior assistant the main comedian and so forth. The players who played the crowd were the responsibility of the office boy. (Even the make-up department of the Gemini Studio had an 'office boy').

On the days when there was crowd-shooting, you could see him mixing his paint in a giant vessel and slapping it on the crowd players. The idea was to close every pore on the surface of the face in the process of applying make-up. (*Poets and Pancakes*)

- (i) What does the writer mean by the phrase indoor shooting in the first line of the extract ?

Ans. The phrase "indoor shooting" refers to filming that takes place inside a studio, utilizing artificial lighting and set designs instead of shooting outdoors.

- (ii) Pick up one sentence from the extract that reflects the sarcastic tone of the writer.

Ans. "I suppose the sets and studio lights needed the girls and boys to be made to look ugly in order to look presentable in the movie."

- (iii) The hierarchy in the make-up department puts the 'office boy' in the _____ (lowest / top) rung of the ladder.

Ans. lowest

- (iv) Complete the following suitably:

On the days when there was a 'crowd-shooting'. By the phrase crowd-shooting, the author refers to _____.

Ans. the shooting of scenes involving a large number of junior artists or extras

- (v) Choose the correct option:

"..... mix his paint in a giant vessel and slapping it on the crowd players."

- author's intention to degrade the office boy's role in the make-up department.
- the office boy's lack of seriousness.
- author's sarcastic and humorous writing style.
- author's dislike of the office boy.

Ans. (c) author's sarcastic and humorous writing style.

- (vi) Choose the correct option:

What does the following line from the extract showcase?

"A strict hierarchy was maintained in the make-up department."

- The office boy took all the decisions in the make-up department.
- A system of ranks according to importance of work was followed.
- Everyone was given an equal share of work in the department.
- Nepotism was prevalent in the make-up department.

Ans. (b) A system of ranks according to the importance of work was followed.

OR

(B) My Last French Lesson ! Why, I hardly knew how to write ! I should never learn any more ! I must stop there, then ! Oh, how sorry I was for not learning my lessons, for seeking birds 'eggs or going sliding on the Saar ! My books, that had seemed such a nuisance a while ago, so heavy to carry, my grammar, and my history of the saints, were old friends now that I couldn't give up and M. Hamel, too; the idea that he was going away, that I should never see him again, made me forget all about his ruler and how cranky he was.

Poor man ! It was in honour of this last lesson that he had put on his fine Sunday clothes, and now I understood why the old men of the village were sitting there in the back of the room. It was because they were sorry, too, that they had not gone to school more. It was their way of thanking our master for his forty years of faithful Service and of showing their respect for the country that was theirs no more.

(The Last Lesson)

(i) Choose the correct option:

What is the tone of the speaker in the expression I hardly knew how to write how sorry I was for not learning my lessons?

- (a) confused
- (b) regretful
- (c) surprised
- (d) happy

Ans. (b) regretful

(ii) Choose the correct option:

The speaker refers to 'seeking birds' egg and 'sliding on the Saar' as

- (a) part of his routine
- (b) his daily routine
- (c) source of distraction from learning
- (d) fun time with friends

Ans. (c) source of distraction from learning

(iii) What is reflected through the shift in the speaker's perception of his books through his expression of calling them his old friends' rather than considering them as nuisance'?

Ans. The shift in perception reflects the speaker's newfound appreciation for education and his regret for not valuing his lessons and books earlier.

(iv) Select the correct option from those given in brackets to fill in the blank:

"It was because they were sorry too.."

They were sorry for _____ (not following the government order / not learning their language)

Ans. not learning their language.

(v) What is inferred from the expression the country that was theirs no more?

Ans. The phrase refers to the loss of the regions of Alsace and Lorraine to the Prussians, symbolizing the end of French rule and the beginning of German control.

(vi) What does M. Hamel's ruler reflect about his image?

Ans. M. Hamel's ruler symbolizes his strict and disciplined approach to teaching, highlighting his authority and traditional methods. However, it also contrasts with the deep respect and emotional connection the students and villagers now have for him, particularly as this marks the end of his teaching career and their realization of his significance.

10. Answer ANY FIVE of the following six questions, in about 40-50 words:

5 × 2 = 10

* Content - 1 M, Expression - 1 M

(i) "One of these days you're going to walk yourself into a load trouble," her father said aggressively. What do you learn about Sophie's father's from these line?

Ans. Sophie's father is portrayed as practical and concerned. His comment reflects his frustration with Sophie's unrealistic dreams and her tendency to exaggerate. He believes that her imagination will eventually get her into trouble, showing his concern for her well-being and his practical approach to life.

(ii) 'A thing of beauty is a joy forever'. Explain with reference to the poem.

Ans. "A thing of beauty is a joy forever" means that beautiful things provide lasting happiness and comfort. Their beauty never fades, offering a constant source of joy. Beauty brings solace and hope, lifting our spirits despite the struggles and hardship of life.

(A Thing of Beauty)

(iii) How did Franz plan to turn the commotion in the classroom to his favour?

Ans. Franz planned to turn the commotion in the classroom to his favor by using the noise and bustle to slip into his seat unnoticed. However, he realized that the usual noise was absent, making it difficult for him to avoid attention. The unusual quietness made him feel more nervous and self-conscious.

(The Last Lesson)

(iv) How do the expressions 'polished traffic' and a stand that 'pathetically pled' depict the contrasting worlds that co-exist in the poem 'A Roadside Stand'?

Ans. The expression "polished traffic" shows the rich, city people who pass by in fancy cars without caring. "A stand that pathetically pled" shows the poor villagers asking for help through their small shop. These phrases show the sharp contrast between the rich and the poor in the poem.

(v) What I want should not be confused'. What clarification does Pablo Neruda give to his readers? (Keeping Quiet)

Ans. Pablo Neruda clarifies that his request for stillness is not about complete inactivity or death. He urges for a pause in our usual rush to allow introspection and reflection. The goal is to stop momentarily, not to cease living, but to find deeper understanding and connection.

(vi) 'But the game he is watching so intently is out of his reach.'

What are the factors that have made their game inaccessible to Saheb?

(Lost Spring)

Ans. Saheb finds the tennis game out of his reach due to the social and economic barriers he faces. As a ragpicker, he lacks the financial resources and social standing to participate. The game represents a world of privilege and opportunities that remain inaccessible to someone living in poverty and deprivation, like Saheb.

11. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in 40-50 words each:

2 × 2 = 4

* Content - 1 M, Expression - 1 M

(i) What is so ironic about Sam reaching the third level?

Ans. The irony of Sam reaching the third level is that, as Charley's psychiatrist, Sam had initially dismissed the idea of the third level as a "waking dream wish fulfillment," attributing it to Charley's desire to escape the modern world's stress. However, despite his skepticism, Sam ends up embracing this very fantasy, finding himself in the past era that he once considered a mere escape from reality.

(ii) What image of the Tiger King is revealed in the diamond ring episode?

Ans. The diamond ring episode reveals the Tiger King's extravagant and reckless nature. In an attempt to impress the British officer's wife, he orders fifty diamond rings without any concern for the cost. This episode showcases his excessive spending and his readiness to go to great lengths to maintain his power and influence.

(iii) "In that short time, we've managed to create quite a rukus." What does Tishani Doshi refer to by 'rukus'?

Ans. In the phrase "In that short time, we've managed to create quite a rukus," Tishani Doshi refers to the significant environmental consequences of human activity over a short period. In just 12,000 years, human population growth and rapid industrialization have led to increased competition for resources and environmental problems such as higher carbon dioxide levels and global warming. This has severely disrupted the planet's delicate balance.

12. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 120-150 words:

1 × 5 = 5

(A) Where there is a will, there is a way.' The above saying aptly describes the character of Douglas from 'Deep Water' and Mukesh from 'Lost Spring'. Compare and contrast their characters in terms of their courage, determination, and the pursuit of their goals.

Ans. Douglas from Deep Water and Mukesh from Lost Spring both embody courage and determination in their respective struggles. Douglas, as a child, faced a deep fear of water after a traumatic near-drowning incident. However, his determination to overcome this fear led him to take swimming lessons. Through persistent practice and overcoming his panic, he eventually conquers his terror of water. Similarly, Mukesh, born into a family entrenched in the bangle-making industry in Firozabad, dreams of becoming a motor mechanic despite the poverty and limitations around him. Unlike his family, who has resigned to their fate, Mukesh shows courage by pursuing his dreams, even if it means walking long distances to learn his craft. Both characters display resilience—Douglas conquering his fear and Mukesh fighting against the generational constraints imposed by poverty and tradition. Their courage and determination make them examples of the saying, "Where there's a will, there's a way."

OR

(B) Kamala Das in Keeping Quiet' and Keats in 'A Thing of Beauty' depict nature as a source of inspiration and strength to man. Analyse both the poems in terms of the above perspective.

Ans. In Keeping Quiet by Pablo Neruda and A Thing of Beauty by John Keats, nature plays a crucial role in providing inspiration and strength to humanity. Neruda in Keeping Quiet calls for a pause, where humans can connect with nature's stillness to reflect on their actions and find peace. This stillness, much like the quietness of the earth, provides an opportunity for self-understanding and reconciliation. Keats, on the other hand, in A Thing of Beauty celebrates nature's beauty as a constant source of joy and solace. The natural elements like the sun, moon, and trees are seen as eternal, offering relief from the struggles of life. Both poems suggest that nature, whether through quiet reflection or the enduring beauty it offers, strengthens the human spirit and provides a sense of connection to life.

13. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in 120-150 words:

- (A) The element of dilemma, between humanity and Patriotism elevates the character of Dr. Sadao in 'The Enemy'. Support your answer with evidence from the text.

Ans. Dr. Sadao in The Enemy experiences a dilemma between his humanity as a doctor and his patriotism. When an American soldier is washed ashore, wounded, Dr. Sadao is faced with the choice of saving him or turning him over to the authorities as a prisoner of war. His medical duty compels him to help the soldier, despite the man being his enemy. However, his sense of national loyalty creates a conflict, as harboring an enemy could lead to his arrest or dishonor. This internal struggle between his compassion for the wounded soldier and his duty to his country elevates Dr. Sadao's character, as he ultimately decides to save the man's life. His decision reflects the complexities of choosing between personal morality and national loyalty, highlighting the tension between his role as a healer and his responsibility as a citizen during wartime.

OR

- (B) How did Tishani Doshi's visit to Antarctica as part of the Students on Ice Programme make her realise the importance of preserving the Earth?

(Journey to the End of the Earth)

Ans. Tishani Doshi's visit to Antarctica as part of the Students on Ice Programme profoundly highlighted the Earth's fragility and the urgent need for preservation. Witnessing retreating glaciers, collapsing ice shelves, and the simplicity of the Antarctic ecosystem made the abstract threat of global warming very real. She observed how even minor environmental shifts, such as changes in the microscopic phytoplankton, can ripple through the entire ecosystem. The pristine Antarctic environment, which lacks human interference, offers a clear perspective on the delicate balance of nature. Doshi's experience was full of awe-inspiring and opening moments, reinforcing the metaphor that taking care of small things can lead to the well-being of the bigger picture. This experience effectively emphasized the collective responsibility humans have towards the planet's future, helping her realize the importance of preserving Earth for future generations.

CBSE SOLVED PAPER 2024

Time allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

Read the instructions very carefully and strictly follow them:

- (i) This question paper comprises **13** questions. All questions are compulsory.
- (ii) The question paper contains **THREE** sections -
Section - A: Reading Skills
Section - B: Creative Writing Skills
Section - C: Literature
- (iii) Attempt all questions based on specific instructions for each part. Write the correct question number and part thereof in your answer sheet.
- (iv) Separate instructions are given with each question / part, wherever necessary.
- (v) Adhere to the prescribed word limit while answering the questions.

SECTION - A

Reading Skills

(22 marks)

1. Read the text given below:

12 M

- (1) Five enterprises received approval and grants for prototype development of sustainable educational toys.
- (2) The government authorities, educational institutions and EdTech start-ups are planning to introduce state-of-the-art, made-in-India educational toys that not only throw light on Indian values and civilisations, but also help in developing children's critical thinking, and decision-making skills.
- (3) "One such enterprise is working on different types of projects that can teach children how electromagnets and magnetic fields work. These projects can resolve a lot of issues in many schools in tier two and three cities, that don't have proper infrastructure. Another is working on an excavation site to teach children about ancient Indian civilizations. It has implanted a few artifacts at the site, which the children will have to find so that they are able to learn how to preserve and label artifacts. Another startup has proposed to create miniaturized labs for schools in tier 2 and 3 cities where children can learn concepts of Physics. "We will ensure that these prototypes are developed within a year and then the production can be scaled up," says the senior manager of the project talking about the importance of indigenously-built educational toys.
- (4) Playtime is vital for the cognitive development of children and toys are an essential component that helps enhance specific cognitive abilities and skill sets. "Well-designed toys ignite students' curiosity, increase focus and can be very beneficial in helping them master a skill and enhance understanding. These can be in the form of visuals, auditory aids, kinesthetic, or a mixture of all three." says HOD, Early Childhood Education.
- (5) Toys offer an engaging avenue to teach mathematical, verbal, problem-solving skills. "Toys that engage students in experiential learning enhance their special awareness and fine motor skills. Those designed for two or more players help students develop better social skills as they learn to negotiate, settle differences, etc., with their peers."
- (6) Experiential gadgets and toys enable students to learn faster and retain lessons longer. "A child's interest is piqued when he is taught in a contextual framework as opposed to rote learning. The Indian education system has been witnessing several innovations with the development of toys and gadgets that can be used and felt in person or through VR platforms across subjects, be it Science, Technology, Math or Engineering.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage:

(i) By tier 2 and tier 3 cities the author refers to

- (A) Metro cities
- (B) Cities with huge population
- (C) Underdeveloped cities
- (D) Cities with less population

(i) (C) Underdeveloped cities.

(ii) Complete the sentence with evidence from the text.

The made-in-India educational toys serves dual purpose of _____.

(ii) throwing light on Indian values and civilizations and helping in developing children's critical thinking and decision-making skills.

(iii) The author's point of view that can be inferred from the above passage is that _____.

- (A) educational toys are the booming business.
- (B) educational toys are meant to entertain children.
- (C) educational toys will replace teachers.
- (D) educational toys will make education more pragmatic.

(iii) (D) educational toys will make education more pragmatic.

(iv) Complete the following sentence appropriately:

Educational toys enhance the personality of children by _____.

(iv) engaging them in experiential learning that develops their social skills, mathematical, verbal and problem-solving skills.

(v) Read the five headlines (a)-(e), given below:

- (a) Sustainable Educational Toys are Developmentally Appropriate.
- (b) Sustainable Educational Toys Promote Free play.
- (c) Sustainable Educational Toys - Free and Widespread.
- (d) Sustainable Educational Toys - Experiential Learning.
- (e) Sustainable Educational Toys - Hinder Interaction with people.

Identify the option that displays the headline that DOES/DO NOT correspond with what the passage highlights.

- (A) only (e)
- (B) (a) and (b)
- (C) (c) and (e)
- (D) only (d)

(v) (A) only (e)

(vi) What evidences do you gather from the passage to state that educational system is revolutionized by educational toys? Answer in about 40 words.

2

(vi) Educational toys engage students in learning through interactive, experiential activities that focus on cognitive, emotional, and social development. Well-designed toys spark curiosity, improve focus, and aid skill mastery and understanding, utilising visuals, auditory aids, kinesthetic elements, or a blend of all three.

(vii) Explain in about 40 words, how education at grassroot level is benefitted by these projects.

2

(vii) Education at the grassroots level benefits from these projects as they bring advanced educational resources to underdeveloped areas, enhancing learning through hands-on, innovative toys that focus on practical skills and knowledge.

(viii) As opposed to learning by heart, experiential toys

1

(A) ignite interest

(B) challenge the teachers

(C) replace textbooks

(D) confuse learners

(viii) (A) ignite interest

(ix) Playing is usually considered a distraction. Is it justified on the part of the narrator to assert that playing is an important aspect of education? Write your answer in about 40 words.

2

(ix) Yes, it is justified as play is essential for cognitive development and learning, enhancing children's abilities and skills through engaging and interactive experiences that foster deeper understanding and retention of knowledge.

10 M

2. Read the text given below:

- (1) People below the age of 20 and above the age of 50 are more likely to believe fake news. Those relatively new to the use of the internet still do not grasp the concept of fake information over these platforms, reveals a new survey 'Countering Misinformation in India' This survey has been conducted jointly by Internet and Mobile Association of India (IAMAI).
- (2) At least 40% of the respondents believed in 'misinformation' received over social media if it came with leading backgrounds and evidence, while 34% of them believe the information when it is shared by a trustworthy organization.
- (3) The dominant factor that drives people to forward such information is their belief that it might benefit others and help in their safety. In fact, that was the response of almost 50% of the respondents. This was compounded by the fact that at least 20% of the respondents expressed their lack of trust in conventional media thus their faith in contents shared by common people over social media.

- (4) But even then, newspapers still remain the top source of information for most. At least 53% of the respondents trust w generally perceived as neutral media and only 29% trust technology and social media platforms.
- (5) However, what was surprising was that almost 45% of the respondents did not even know about the existence of fact-check organization and most did not even know that journalists had to verify data before they let it out/ Only 26% of the respondents believe that it is the responsibility of the media to curb or identify fake news. Many respondents also put the responsibility of identifying such fake news on an individual.
- (6) The survey has found that first time or early users of the Internet platforms are more susceptible to fake news than o There is a need for building capacities and creating a National Civic Digital Literacy Strategic Plan.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage:

- (i) Select the option that comes under conventional media:

(A) Instagram (B) Newspaper
(C) Facebook (D) E-mail

(i) (B) Newspaper

- (ii) Select the correct option:

One factor that prompts people to believe fake news is that

(A) it supports their point of view (B) they are biased
(C) it is from a reliable site (D) it has more 'likes' and 'shares'

(ii) (C) it is from a reliable site

- (iii) What according to the passage are the intentions of people who share information?

(iii) The dominant factor that drives people to share information is their belief that it might benefit others and help in their safety.

- (iv) Why is it important for journalists to give authentic background and evidence in their reporting?

(iv) The inferred reason for journalists spreading misinformation, as suggested by the passage, is a public misunderstanding of journalistic processes and the necessity of verifying information.

- (v) Complete the sentence appropriately:

The threat faced by the new entrants in social media is _____.

(v) that they are more susceptible to fake news.

- (vi) Explain your understanding of the difference between 'misinformation' and 'fake news'.

(vi) Misinformation refers to false or inaccurate information, as suggested by the passage, is a public misunderstanding of journalistic processes and the necessity of verifying information.

(vii) As per your inference drawn from para (1), which category of people fall as victims to fake news?

2

(vii) People below the age of 20 and above the age of 50 are most likely to fall as victims to fake news, particularly those who are new to use of the Internet and do not fully grasp the concept of fake information on these platforms.

(viii) What is the blame game that goes on in fixing the onus of identifying fake news?

2

(viii) The blame game involves respondents believing that it is the media's responsibility to curb or identify fake news, while many also put the responsibility on individuals to identify fake news on their own, leading to a lack of clear accountability.

SECTION-B

Creative Writing Skills

(18 Marks)

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

3. Attempt ANY ONE of the following two, in about 50 words.

4

(a) Bharat Public School, I.P. Nagar, has recently constructed a Science Park, a dedicated area where specific equipments based on principles of Science are setup.

As Rashi Kapoor, President of Science Club, draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of the same. Mention relevant details

(a) BHARAT PUBLIC SCHOOL, I.P. NAGAR
NOTICE

May 25, 2024

SCIENCE PARK OPENING!

We are thrilled to announce the opening of our new Science Park at Bharat Public School. Explore and learn with the exciting new science-based equipment. Come and see how fun science can be! The Science Club will also be organizing weekly activities and challenges to make our learning journey even more engaging.

Date: June 5, 2024

Time: 10 AM onwards

Venue: School Grounds

Rashi Kapoor

President, Science Club

OR

- (b) You are the President, RWA Silver Oak Society. Draft a notice for the society notice board informing residents about appointment of security guards at Gate Nos. 2, 3 & 4 and an increase of ₹ 1,000 in the annual maintenance charges to the expenditure. Mention relevant details.

4. Attempt ANY ONE of the following two in about 50 words.

- (a) You are a student counsellor of N.J. Public School. You are invited by S.M. International School, Kala Puram, to address XII students on Goal Setting & Time Management. Write a formal letter of reply accepting the invitation and confirming presence at the stated time, include relevant details.

(a)

N.J. Public School
Delhi

25th May, 2024

The Principal
S.M. International School
Kala Puram

Subject: Acceptance of Invitation

Dear Sir,

Thank you for inviting me to speak on Goal Setting & Time Management on June 15, 2024 to address the students of class XII. I am delighted to accept and look forward to contributing to the students' success.

Yours sincerely
Alisha
Student Counsellor

OR

- (b) You are Mr. Anmol Gupta. You are planning to celebrate your sister's silver jubilee wedding anniversary. Draft the invitation card to be sent to relatives and friends, sharing all relevant details.

5. Attempt ANY ONE of two, in about 120-150 words.

- (a) You are Mahesh / Mrinal of 36, M.K. Avenue, Pratap Nagar. You are a Commerce graduate. You saw the given advertisement in a newspaper and wish to apply for the position advertised. Write a letter along with a detailed bio-data, expressing your interest in the advertised post.

S.K. GLOBAL BANK
We're hiring
Management Trainees

Qualification : Graduation in any Subject
Experience : 0 - 2 yrs.
Skills : Project management, Communication skills, Customer service skills

Apply with bio-data to The Manager, S.K. Global Bank,
45, Bannerghatta Road, Pratap Nagar

OR

- (b) You have recently come across a report stating that crime against the elderly is up by 22% in AB Nagar. Senior citizens especially those living alone are exposed to crimes like robbery, murder etc. As a concerned citizen, write a letter to the editor of a local daily expressing your concern and suggesting ways to protect them. Use the following cues along with your own ideas to draft the letter.

- Volunteer your services
- Environment to be made secure
- Not to leave old people alone
- Be in touch with them
- Regular police check

(b) 1545, Sector 45

AB Nagar.

25th May, 2024

The Editor

The Times of India

AB Nagar.

Subject: Urgent need to protect our elderly citizens

Dear Sir,

Through the columns of your esteemed newspaper, I would like to express my deep concern regarding the recent report on the 22% increase in crimes against the elderly in AB Nagar. It is disheartening to learn that our senior citizens, especially those living alone, are vulnerable to such heinous acts like robbery and even murder.

As a community, we must act to ensure their safety. I propose we start by volunteering our services to check in on elderly neighbours regularly, providing them with both company and a sense of security. Additionally, enhancing the security infrastructure in neighbourhoods with high populations of elderly residents could deter potential criminals.

It is also crucial that we do not leave our elderly to live in isolation. Regular social interactions can not only improve their spirits but also ensure that they have someone to reach out to in times of need. Frequent police patrols and checks in these areas would also serve as a strong deterrent to criminal activities targeting them.

It is time for us to come together as a community to protect and support our elderly, ensuring AB Nagar is safe for all its residents.

Yours sincerely,
Nisha

6. Attempt ANY ONE of the two, in 120-150 words.

- (a) You are Anuj, a student of Class XII. Whenever you are stressed, you listen to music and get relaxed. You strongly believe that music destresses you and refreshes your body and mind.

Based on your experience, write an article on 'Music as Therapy' for a health magazine highlighting the healing power of music. Use the following cues along with your own ideas to compose this article:

- music establishes connection with self
- music helps in self-expression
- comforts body, mind & soul
- improves one's mood

(a) Music as Therapy: A Student's Perspective
By Anuj, Class-XII

In the hustle of our daily lives, stress becomes an unwelcome companion for many, including students like myself. During these times, music emerges not just as a background score but as a therapeutic balm, healing and soothing the weary soul.

Music has a unique way of establishing a deep connection with one's inner self. It allows me to reflect, understand, and align my thoughts, often leading to personal insights and emotional release. This connection provides a safe space for introspection and self-awareness.

Each song provides a medium for expressing feelings that words alone cannot convey. Whether it's the lyrical depth of a ballad or the energetic beats of a dance track, music offers a form of expression that is both personal and universal.

The comfort that music provides transcends the mere act of listening. It encompasses an emotional embrace, easing anxiety, and fostering a peaceful state of mind. For me, music is a sanctuary where the mind rests, the body relaxes, and the soul rejuvenates.

The power of music to uplift spirits is phenomenal. A good tune can turn gloom into joy, altering my mood almost instantly. It's not just about the notes and the rhythm; it's about the experience that can magically transform a bad day into a good one.

In conclusion, music is much more than a mere diversion. It is a potent therapeutic tool that heals, inspires, and revives. As we navigate the complexities of life, let us turn to music not only for entertainment but for comfort and recovery. It's a remedy that's readily available, and all you need to do is listen.

OR

- (b) Your school recently conducted an Art exhibition in which students from all classes participated. Students presented various paintings, sculpture etc. Parents and visitors congratulated the students on their efforts.

As a student editor, write a report on the exhibition to be published in your school magazine. Use the cues given below along with your own ideas to compose this report :

- date, venue, time
- participants
- types of painting, sculpture
- theme, if any.
- visitors' feed back

SECTION-C

Literature, Text Book and Supplementary Reading Text

(40 Ma

7. Read the following extracts and answer the questions on ANY ONE of the given two.

(a) Sometimes I feel myself I can hardly bear

The thought of so much childish longing in vain,

The sadness that lurks near the open window there,

That waits all day in almost open prayer.

For the squeal of brakes, the sound of a stopping car,

Of all the thousand selfish cars that pass,

Just one to inquire what a farmer's prices are

And one did stop, but only to plow up grass

In using the yard to back and turn around;

And another to ask the way to where it was bound; (*A Roadside Stand*)

(i) Select the option that has the same literary device as in 'The sadness that lurks near the open window there'.

(A) Lucy moved across the room like a warship sailing into battle.

(B) Art washes away from the soul the dust of everyday life.

(C) The water-wraith was shrieking.

(D) The pen is mightier than the sword.

(ii) They prayed for the stopping of a car. When one car finally stopped, it brought _____ to the people of the roadside stand.

(A) help

(B) happiness

(C) disappointment

(D) cash flow

(iii) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line, '.....childish longing in vain'.

(iv) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The emotion of the poet reflected in the above extract is _____.

(v) The expression 'selfish car' suggests that _____.

(vi) Based on the rhyme scheme evident in the last two lines of the extract, which word would rhyme with last line?

brass

reply

sound

OR

(b)but soon

put that thought away, and

looked out at Young

Trees sprinting, the merry children spilling

out of their homes, but after the airport's security check,

standing a few yards away, I looked again at her, wan, pale

as a late winter's moon and felt that old

familiar ache, my childhood's fear, (*My Mother at Sixty-six*)

(i) Select the correct option.

The impact of 'merry children' on poet's mind _____.

(A) caused anxiety

(B) created a sense of longing

(C) brought comfort

(D) reminded her of her own childhood

(i) (B) created a sense of longing

(ii) The tone of the poet expressed in the above lines is

(A) sadness and helplessness

(B) excitement and eagerness

(C) appreciation and gratitude

(D) anger and anxiety

(ii) (A) sadness and helplessness

(iii) The words 'wan, pale' indicate the mother's _____.

(iii) old age and fragility

(iv) Complete the following sentence appropriately.

The poet looked at her mother again to _____.

(iv) have a look at her one last time before leaving.

(v) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line 'felt that old familiar ache'.

(v) The poet often feels this pain, a deep sadness and fear about her mother's mortality and the inevitability of aging.

(vi) 'put that thought away'.

What is the intention of poet that can be inferred from the above line?

(vi) The poet's intention was to put away the painful thought of her mother's ageing and declining health and the possibility of losing her mother.

8. Read the two extracts given below and answer the questions on ANY ONE.

4

(a) The reason the programme has been so successful is because it is impossible to go anywhere near the South Pole and not be affected by it. It's easy to be blasé about polar ice caps melting while sitting in the comfort zone of our respective latitude and longitude, but when you can visibly see glaciers retreating and ice shelves collapsing, you begin to realise that the threat of global warming is real.

Antarctica, because of her simple eco-system and lack of biodiversity, is the perfect place to study how little changes in the environment can have big repercussions. (*Journey to the End of the Earth*)

(i) As per the given extract, the reason for the success of the programme is

- (A) the participation of young students.
- (B) the journey to Antarctica.
- (C) the exposure to reality.
- (D) it was impossible to go near south pole.

(ii) Complete the following sentence.

The warning that can be inferred from the above extract is _____.

(iii) State whether the statement given is TRUE or FALSE with reference to the extract.

Global warming is a threat to human survival.

(iv) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line "It's easy to be blasé about polar ice caps melting while sitting in the comfort zone".

OR

(b) From that day onwards it was celebration time for all the tigers inhabiting Pratibandapuram.

The State banned tiger hunting by anyone except the Maharaja. A proclamation was issued to the effect that if anyone dared to fling so much as a stone at a tiger, all his wealth and property would be confiscated.

The Maharaja vowed he would attend to all other matters only after killing the hundred tigers. Initially the king seemed well set to realise his ambition. (*The Tiger King*)

(i) Select the correct option:

'... he would attend to all other matters only after killing hundred tigers'. This reflects Tiger King's

(A) courage

(B) determination

(C) selfishness

(D) kindness

(i) (B) determination

(ii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

From that day onwards it was celebration time for all the tigers. The above statement is ironical in the sense

(ii) because they were now protected from all hunters except the Maharaja.

(iii) '... if anyone dared to fling so much as a stone at a tiger, all his wealth and property would be confiscated'. What trait of king is reflected in the above line?

(iii) ruthlessness.

(iv) State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE.

The King's ambition is to save people from the tigers.

(iv) False

9. Read the two extracts given below and answer the questions on ANY ONE.

(a) "Why do you do this?" I ask Saheb whom I encounter every morning scrounging for gold in the garbage dumps of neighbourhood. Saheb left his home long ago. Set amidst the green fields of Dhaka, his home is not even a distant memory. There were many storms that swept away their fields and homes, his mother tells him. That's why they left, looking for gold in the big city where he now lives. "I have nothing else to do," he mutters, looking away.

"Go to school," I say glibly, realizing immediately how hollow the advice must sound.

"There is no school in my neighbourhood. When they build one, I will go." (Lost Spring)

(i) Choose the correct option.

The expression 'scrounging for gold' refers to

(A) searching for gold items.

(B) looking for something that can fetch money.

(C) rummaging the garbage.

(D) digging to find food to eat.

(i) (C) rummaging the garbage.

(ii) The influence of nature in Saheb's life was that it

(A) brought prosperity

(B) yielded food for them

(C) gave them home

(D) brought disaster

(ii) (D) brought disaster.

(iii) Complete the sentence with an appropriate word.

Saheb's conversation with the narrator draws _____ of readers towards Saheb.

(iii) empathy.

- (iv) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line "..... realizing how hollow the advice must sound".

(iv) One inference that can be drawn from the line "realizing how hollow the advice must sound" is that the advice to go to "school" given by the narrator is impractical or irrelevant for Saheb because there is no school in his neighbourhood. This highlights the disparity between the narrator's understanding of Saheb's situation and the reality of Saheb's life circumstances.

- (v) The expression 'when they build one, I will go' indicates Saheb's _____ to go to school.

(v) willingness

- (vi) State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE.

'... his home is not even a distant dream' states that Saheb sees his home often in his dream.

(vi) False

OR

- (b) Then the poet spoke. He couldn't have addressed a more dazed and silent audience - no one knew what he was talking about and his accent defeated any attempt to understand what he was saying. The whole thing lasted about an hour; then the poet left and we all dispersed in utter bafflement - What are we doing? What is an English poet doing in a film studio which makes Tamil films for the simplest sort of people? People whose lives least afforded them the possibility of cultivating a taste for English poetry. The poet looked pretty baffled too, for he must have felt the sheer incongruity of his talk about the thrills and travails of an English poet. His visit remained an unexplained mystery. (*Poets and Pancakes*)
- (i) Choose the correct option:
The reason for the bewilderment of the audience is
(A) unknown identity of the visitor.
(B) that the speaker had not been introduced to them.
(C) the visit of an English poet to a Tamil film studio.
(D) that they did not understand English.
- (ii) By "thrills and travails" the author refers to
(A) joy and happiness
(B) interest and aspiration
(C) excitement and pain
(D) shocks and surprises
- (iii) Explain one inference that can be drawn from the line, "He could not have addressed a more dazed and silent audience".
- (iv) The failure of the speaker to connect with the audience with reference to the extract is his _____.
- (v) What information in the extract reveals the fact that the people have no exposure other than to their own circle?
- (vi) State whether the following statement is TRUE or FALSE.
The audience were enthralled by the poet's impressive speech.

10. Answer ANY FIVE of the following six questions, in about 40-50 words:

5 × 2 =

- (i) Explain the inference that can be drawn from the line: "Will they make them sing in German, even the pigeons?"
(The Last Lesson)

(i) Franz wonders if even the pigeons will have to sing in German. This shows how deeply the change affects everything. He feels like the new ruler will change every part of life, even the ~~own~~ natural sounds of birds. This thought also shows Franz's worry about losing his own culture and language. It's like he's saying that everything familiar, even birds' songs, might be taken over by the foreign rule, making his world unrecognizable.

- (ii) "Father laughed, but there was terror in my heart." What does the above statement speak of the father? (Deep Water)

(ii) In an incident at a beach in California, when the narrator was three or four years old he was knocked down by the waves. The statement "Father laughed, but there was terror in my heart" suggests that while the father did not seem to think the situation was serious and laughed, the narrator as a 3 or 4 years old child was actually very ~~was~~ scared. This shows that the father may not have understood how scared his child felt, or he might have not taken the child's fear seriously.

- (iii) The tigers in the panel that she made
Will go on prancing, proud and unafraid.

What is the tone of the poet reflected in the above lines? (Aunt Jennifer's Tigers)

(iii) The tone of the poet in the lines "The tigers in the panel that she made / will go on prancing, proud and unafraid" is one of defiance and resilience. Despite the challenges Aunt Jennifer faces, the tigers she creates symbolize strength and fearlessness, contrasting with her own situation.

(iv) What is Pablo Neruda's complaint against fishermen? (*Keeping Quiet*)

(v) How and why does Keats relate 'mighty dead' to the 'Thing of Beauty'? (*A Thing of Beauty*)

(v) Keats relates the 'mighty dead' to a 'Thing of Beauty' by associating their grand deeds and legacies with beauty. This reference implies that the stories of the 'mighty dead' provide inspiration to us, just as natural beauty does. This evokes a sense of timeless admiration and ensures their remembrance is a continuous source of joy and inspiration.

(vi) 'Jansie, knowing they were both earmarked for the biscuit factory, became melancholy'.

What inference about Jansie's character is drawn from the above line? (*Going Places*)

(vi) The inference about Jansie's character from the line that she "became melancholy" upon realizing they were both earmarked for the biscuit factory is that she is realistic and perhaps a bit resigned to her fate. Unlike Sophie, who dreams of more glamorous pursuits, Jansie understands their limited options and feels saddened by the lack of opportunities to change their predetermined paths.

11. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in 40-50 words each:

2 × 2 = 4

(i) They decided that the Maharaja must not come to know that he had missed the target'. (*The Tiger King*)

Why did the hunters try to hide the truth from the king?

(ii) 'I must get rid of this man for your sake'.

How did Dr. Sadao act like a perfect husband? (*The Enemy*)

(ii) Yuni's statement, "I will have nothing to do with it", "I am a poor person and it is not my business", shows that she is cautious and wants to avoid trouble. She recognizes her lower social status and feels that getting involved in risky situations isn't her responsibility. Her words reflect a practical approach to her duties, focusing on self-preservation and avoiding problems that could harm her or her family.

- (iii) "I had been tossed about in the air like a wooden puppet" and now my long hair was shingled like a coward's..."
What inference about the life of Zitkala-Sa can be drawn from the above statement? (Memories of Childhood)

(ii) Annan was able to inspire Barna by explaining how education can be a powerful tool to confront and overcome societal injustices. His personal achievements and status as a respected individual despite societal challenges highlighted the importance and transformative power of education. This motivated Barna to pursue her own education more seriously, hoping to achieve dignity and respect just like her mother.

12. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 120-150 words:

- (a) Imagine you are Pablo Neruda of 'Keeping Quiet'. He advises Robert Frost in the context of his conflict and pain at the roadside stand owners. Pen down your advice in a letter to Robert Frost. You may begin,

Dear Frost,

You seem very pained at the plight of the roadside stand owners, and I would like to advise you...

OR

- (b) While M. Hamel talks of language being the key to nationalism. Gandhi tells the court it is a 'conflict of duties'. On the one hand, not to set a bad example as a law breaker, on the other hand, to render the humanitarian and national service. You are inspired and decide to write an article for a youth magazine urging the youth to dedicate themselves to the service of the nation.

You may begin like this,

Youth plays an important role in the progress of the nation.....

(b) Dear students,

The emotion of fear will always interfere and interrupt your path to success. It is like a roadblock that stops you from achieving your potential. In life, just as we see in stories from different places, fear can keep people from taking actions that could change their lives for the better. For instance, peasants in "Indigo" were so overwhelmed by fear that they couldn't even use law courts effectively. Similarly, in "Last Spring", the people of Ferozabad were trapped in a cycle of dependency and exploitation because fear kept them from forming a cooperative to stand against middlemen and politicians.

To overcome fear, the first step is understanding its root cause. Are you afraid of failure, judgement, or the unknown? Once you identify the source, you can tackle it head-on. Education and awareness can empower you just like they were meant to empower the peasants. By educating yourself, you can dismantle the fears that hold you back.

Remember, courage isn't about not having fears but about facing them courageously. Every small step you take toward confronting your fears is a step forward freedom. Just as education was seen as a way out for the oppressed in the stories, let knowledge and

continuous learning be your tools to break free from the chains of fear, leading you to a successful and fulfilling life.

Always strive to learn more, question more, and fear less. Let's not allow fear to dictate our lives but instead, use our understanding and courage to shape our destiny.
Thank you.

13. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in 120-150 words:

5

(a) Things out, shutting things in. (On the Face of It)

The above statement speaks about Mr. Lamb's open mindedness and large heartedness despite his disability. Inspired by his thought, you as a student leader, give a motivational speech to your class on how positive attitude and broad mindedness will help one succeed in life.

You may begin like this.

Good morning to one & all.

Being positive and open minded will definitely make you evolve and grow.....

(a) Dear Diary,

I do really thank my stars for bringing Mr. Larrh into my life. Today, I reflect on how much time I've wasted engulfed in self-pity and frustration because of my face. I used to think my appearance defined me, that it was all people saw and judged. But meeting Mr. Larrh changed everything. He taught me that it's not what I look like but what I do and think that defines me. He showed me that every person has scars; some are just more visible than others. His perspective on life, how he embraces each day with enthusiasm despite his own challenges, has inspired me. I regret the hours spent wallowing in my insecurities. Now, I see possibilities and opportunities for happiness and contribution that I had previously shut out because of my narrow focus on my looks. I'm grateful for this new outlook and am determined to live fully, just like Mr. Larrh.

Yours,

Serry

OR

- (b) "that if the man were whole I could turn him over to the Police But since he is wounded" (The Enemy)
The above statement clearly displays Dr. Sadao's commitment to his profession and compassion. Write an article in appreciation of Dr. Sadao's professional ethics and his ability to rise above prejudices.
You may begin like this. Dr. Sadao proved himself to be a man with great humanitarian values.....

□□□

CBSE SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER (2023-24)

ENGLISH CORE (Code No. 301)

CLASS-XII

Time allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

1. The Question Paper contains *THREE* sections-*READING, WRITING and LITERATURE*.
2. Attempt Question based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION-A: READING SKILLS (22 Marks)

Reading Comprehension Through Unseen Passages

1. Read the following text.

12 m

Arthur lay in his cabin, still trying to piece together the events of the last few hours. He had watched his home planet of Earth be demolished to make way for a hyperspace bypass, been saved by his friend Ford, and then whisked away on a ship that was powered by an "infinite improbability drive." It was all too much for him.

- 5 Just then, Ford stuck his head around the door.

"Hey, Earthman," he said, "come and have a look at this."

Arthur stumbled after him down a corridor and into the ship's control room. He gazed in amazement at the banks of controls and flashing lights. In the center of the room was a large console covered in buttons and switches, and in the middle of the console was a small, white mouse.

- 10 "What's that?" asked Arthur.

"That's the ship's computer," said Ford.

Arthur stared at the mouse. "That's a computer?" he said.

"Yup," said Ford. "Five-dimensional, biologically-based, super intelligent, and in the form of a white lab mouse. Pretty neat, huh?"

- 15 "I don't know," said Arthur. "I don't think I really understand anything anymore. Why is a mouse the ship's computer?"

"It's a long story," said Ford. "But the short version is that the mice built the Earth as a giant computer to figure out the Ultimate Question of Life, the Universe, and Everything. Then they ran out of money and had to destroy it to make way for a hyperspace bypass. So now they're using the Heart of Gold to

20 finish the calculation."

Arthur was about to say something, but at that moment the ship's intercom crackled to life.

"Good evening, Heart of Gold," said a smooth, computerized voice. "This is Eddie, your shipboard computer. I'm feeling a bit depressed today. Would you like me to sing you a song?"

"Oh, not again," groaned Ford.

25 "Eddie, would you mind shutting up?" said Arthur.

Arthur sighed and leaned back against the console, trying to make sense of everything. But as he closed his eyes, he heard a voice inside his head.

"Hello?" it said.

Arthur jumped, startled. "Who's there?" he said.

30 "It's me," said the voice. "Marvin."

"Marvin?" said Arthur. "Who's Marvin?"

"The Paranoid Android," said the voice.

Arthur looked around, but he didn't see anyone. "Where are you?" he said.

"I'm down here," said the voice.

35 Arthur looked down and saw a small, metal figure shuffling across the floor. It was about three feet tall, with a round head and a body that looked like it had been cobbled together from spare parts. Its eyes were a dull red, and its voice was a monotone.

"I've been waiting for someone to talk to me for over two million years," said Marvin.

Adapted - An excerpt from "The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy" by Douglas Adams/444 words

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

(i) Select the option that classifies Arthur's confusion about drastic events such as the destruction of his home planet and introduction of new technologies, correctly.

A. Routine and boredom

B. Adventure and excitement

C. Loss and change

D. Calm and relaxation

Ans. C. Loss and change

[Destruction of his home planet = loss and the introduction of new technologies = change]

(ii) What is the significance of the white lab mouse in the control room of the Heart of Gold spaceship?

A. It is the captain of the ship

B. It serves as the ship's computer

C. It is a pet of the crew

D. It is used for scientific experiments

Ans. B. It serves as the ship's computer

[It is mentioned in the text that the white lab mouse in the control room of the Heart of Gold spaceship is the ship's computer.]

(iii) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words to support the view that the writer's writing style is descriptive and humorous.

Ans. Descriptive

"In the center of the room was a large console covered in buttons and switches, and in the middle of the console was a small white mouse."

[This description provides a clear image of the setting and the unconventional form of the ship's computer.]

Humorous

"Oh, not again," groaned Ford.

[This line is humorous because it suggests that the ship's computer, Eddie, frequently offers to sing songs and annoy the crew. Ford's reaction of groaning implies that this is a common occurrence and that he's tired of it. The humour comes from the fact that a computer is attempting to sing a song, which is an unexpected and absurd situation.]

Note: Accept any other appropriate example identified from the text.

(iv) Complete the sentence appropriately with a characteristic or its description.
Based on the information given in the excerpt, one can infer that the mice who built the Earth are _____.

Ans. • highly intelligent/technologically advanced [they built the Earth as a giant computer]

• indifferent to the suffering of other beings [they ran out of money and had to destroy the Earth to make way for

hyperspace bypass.]

(v) Select the option that is similar in meaning to Ford's expression, "Pretty neat, huh?".

- A. Easy, isn't it? B. Could be worse, no? C. Impressive, yes? D. Too difficult for you?

1

Ans. C. Impressive, yes?

(vi) Explain, in about 40 words, why the name "The Paranoid Android" is considered ironic.

2

Ans. The name "The Paranoid Android" is ironic because-

- it is unexpected for a robot to exhibit human-like emotions such as paranoia.
- robots are often thought of as logical and unemotional, whereas the name "paranoid" implies irrational fear and anxiety.
- it plays with readers' expectations and stereotypes of robots.

(vii) In the line, "...a body that looked like it had been cobbled together from spare parts...", what comparison does the word "cobbled" refer to?

1

Ans. The comparison is with cobblers, who take scraps of leather and stitch them together to create a shoe, in the same way in which the body of Marvin was put together or 'cobbled', using spare parts. [The word "cobbled" here, implies a sense of roughness and unevenness, as if the body has been put together in a haphazard manner. It also suggests that the body is assembled together, rather than being a cohesive whole.]

(viii) How does the following, impact the reader, even though they know Marvin is just an android? "I've been waiting for someone to talk to me for over two million years," said Marvin. Answer in about 40 words.

2

Ans. The statement by Marvin, despite being an android, humanizes the character by evoking a sense of loneliness and isolation that is relatable to the reader. It also emphasizes the theme of the alienation and lack of communication between beings in the vastness of space.

This creates a sense of sympathy towards Marvin and also raises questions about the meaning and value of existence, regardless of whether one is organic or synthetic.

(xi) Read the five headlines (a)-(e), given below:

1

- (a) HUMANITY'S JOURNEY WITNESSED BY A DEPRESSED ROBOT
- (b) HITCHHIKING THROUGH SPACE: A COMICAL TAKE ON THE END OF THE WORLD
- (c) NEW STUDY FINDS ALIENS LIVING AMONG US
- (d) GROUNDBREAKING TECHNOLOGY WILL SOON ENABLE TIME TRAVEL
- (e) INTERGALACTIC TRAVEL VIA NEW INFINITE IMPROBABILITY DRIVE

Identify the option that displays the headline/s that DOES/DO NOT correspond with occurrences in the passage.

- A. Only (a) B. (b), (c) and (d)
C. Only (e) D. (a) and (e)

Ans. (B) (b) (c) and (d)

[[a] accurate -represents the main focus of the excerpt: Marvin, a depressed and paranoid android who precedes humanity; (b) incorrect- downplaying serious implications and though the passage does contain humorous elements, it also deals with weighty topics such as the destruction of Earth and the search for a new home; (c) incorrect- no mention of aliens; (d) incorrect- there is no mention of time travel in the excerpt. The technologies mentioned, such as the Heart of Gold spaceship and the Infinite Improbability Drive, are related to time travel; (e) correct- there is mention of a new technology, the Infinite Improbability Drive, that allowed for Arthur's quick travel across galaxies in a spaceship]

10 m

2. Read the following text.

1. In recent years, there has been a surge in both group and solo travel among young adults in India. A survey conducted among young adults aged 18-25 aimed to explore the reasons behind their travel preferences and recorded the percentage variation for 10 common points that influence travel choices.
2. Among those who prefer solo travel, the most common reason cited was the desire for independence and freedom (58%), followed closely by the opportunity for introspection and self-discovery (52%). Additionally, solo travellers appreciated the ability to customize their itinerary to their preferences (44%) and the chance to meet new people on their own terms (36%).
3. On the other hand, those who prefer group travel often cited the desire for socializing and making new friends (61%) as their primary reason. Group travel also provided a sense of security and safety in unfamiliar places (52%) and allowed for shared experiences and memories with others (48%). Additionally, group travellers enjoyed the convenience of having pre-planned itineraries and organized transportation (38%).
4. Interestingly, both groups had similar levels of interest in exploring new cultures and trying new experiences (40% for solo travellers, 36% for group travellers). Similarly, both groups valued the opportunity to relax and escape from the stresses of everyday life (36% for solo travellers, 32% for group travellers).

5. However, there were also some notable differences between the two groups. For example, solo travellers placed a higher priority on budget-friendly travel options (38%) compared to group travellers (24%). Conversely, group travellers were more likely to prioritize luxury and comfort during their travels (28%) compared to solo travellers (12%).
6. Overall, the survey results suggest that both group and solo travel have their own unique advantages and appeal to different individuals, based on their preferences and priorities.

Answer the following questions, based on given passage.

- (i) Infer two possible ways that the survey, mentioned in paragraph (1) could be beneficial.

Ans. Some possible ways: (Any 2/relevant)

- Help travel companies to tailor their services to meet the preferences and expectations of young adult travellers, leading to increased customer satisfaction and loyalty.
- Provide insights for the development of new travel packages and itineraries that cater to the specific needs and interests of young adult travellers.
- Enable the tourism industry to better understand the changing preferences and behaviours of young adult travellers, which can inform future marketing and promotional strategies.
- Can help policymakers and tourism boards to identify key trends and areas of growth in the tourism sector, and act accordingly.
- Allow researchers to gain a better understanding of the motivations and travel behaviours of young adults, which can inform academic studies and literature in the field.
- Can provide a benchmark for comparison with similar studies conducted in different regions or countries, helping to identify cross-cultural differences in travel preferences.
- Help young adults themselves to gain a better understanding of their own travel preferences and motivations, and make more informed travel decisions in the future.
- Can highlight the importance of certain factors in the decision-making process for young adult travellers, such as budget, safety, and cultural exploration, which can inform discussions and debates around the future of the tourism industry.

- (ii) Which travel choice point of the survey would influence tour operators to incorporate group dinners, social events, and shared accommodations in their itinerary?

- A. Freedom to customise itinerary
- C. Security and safety

B. Luxury and comfort

D. Desire for making new friends

Ans. D. Desire for making new friends

- (iii) What do the top choices in the survey, for traveling solo and in a group suggest about young adults?

Ans. The top choices in the survey, for traveling solo and in a group suggest that young adult travellers value independence and freedom when traveling alone and when traveling in a group, they value socializing and making new friends.

- (iv) Identify the solo traveller from the following three travellers:

- (a) Reshma- I don't want to keep hunting for rickshaws or taxis. A pre-booked vehicle is perfect.
- (b) Nawaz- I'm happy sharing a room in a hostel. I don't need hotel accommodation.
- (c) Deepak- I'm not worried about my well-being, even while exploring remote areas.

Ans. (b) Nawaz

[solo traveller-budget friendly; (a) group traveller- organised transport; (c) group traveller high focus on safety and security]

- (v) Which of the following is an example of an opportunity for self-discovery, as mentioned in paragraph 2?

A. Trying new cuisine

C. Purchasing local artifacts

B. Hiring a tour guide

D. Advance booking travel tickets

Ans. A. Trying new cuisine

[It allows an individual to explore new flavours and ingredients that they may not have been exposed to before, thus helping them discover more about themselves by way of likes/dislikes]

- (vi) How might the differences in budget priorities between solo and group travellers impact the types of accommodations and activities offered by the travel industry in India?

Ans.

- To cater to budget-conscious solo travellers, the industry may need to provide more affordable accommodation options such as hostels and budget hotels.
- For group travellers, the industry may need to focus on offering more luxury accommodations and experiences that cater to their desire for comfort and convenience.

(vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The similarities in the percentage of both solo and group travellers who are interested in exploring new cultures and trying new experiences may be due to _____.

Ans. Any one

- a shared desire for adventure
- a willingness to step outside of their comfort zones.
- the fact that that young adults in India are becoming more interested in cultural exchange and global understanding

(Any other relevant)

(viii) State TRUE or FALSE

The title, "Wanderlust: The Solo Travel Trend Among Young Adults in India", is appropriate for this passage.

Ans. FALSE

[The passage is not about solo travel trend but more of solo vs group travel debate among young adults in India]

SECTION-B: CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (18 Marks)

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purpose.

3. Attempt ANY ONE of two, in about 50 words.

(A) Bali High Public School has recently created *CureGreen*, a dedicated area for local medicinal herbs and shrubs, adjacent to the flower garden, on campus. As Rachel Tiwari, Captain of the Eco-Club, draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of classes XI-XII, about a guided walk through *CureGreen*, post assembly, on Friday, 10 July. Invite care-giver applications, for *CureGreen*.

OR

(B) You are the Secretary of the Neighbourhood Watch Scheme, Jastinapur, Sector D-3 Society. Draft a notice for the Society notice board, informing residents about the change of personnel, Head Security, Gate 2 and share necessary details. Also, include the news of installation of the much awaited security camera, on the Eastern periphery of the Society.

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

Name of Organisation	
NOTICE	
Date	Heading [details]
Signature Name (issuing authority) Designation	

- (A) → Correct format (as listed)
→ Drawing attention—students of XI-XII
→ Mentioning the event
→ Giving details -D,T,V
→ Inviting applications
→ Line with reference to the undersigned

- (B) → Correct format (as listed)
→ Drawing attention—residents
→ Stating the information
→ Giving details
→ Sharing awaited news
→ Line with reference to the undersigned

4. Attempt ANY ONE of two, in about 50 words.

(A) You are the Student Head, Cultural Affairs, at M.K. Sr. Sec. School. Your school is organising a 2-day Yoga camp over the weekend, for parents of the school students. Create an invitation, inviting the school parents for this Yoga camp. Share information about the camp organisers and include other necessary details.

OR

- (B) Smt. Leelavati Khatri, your grandmother, has received an invitation from her childhood friend, residing at a distance in the city. The invite is for the blessing ceremony and celebratory dinner, marking the birth of her granddaughter. Your grandmother wishes to attend the event but would need to be accompanied by a family member to assist her with her wheelchair. Compose an appropriate reply, accepting this invitation, on behalf of your grandmother.

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

(A) Card type-formal invite

- a single sentence presentation in third person/end line punctuations skipped
- Use the simple present tense
- answers the questions who, whom, when, where, what time and for what
- includes name and address of the organiser/host and name/s of special invitees (if any)
- No signatures

Layout usually pertains to the following

- Name of host/hosts
- Formal standard expression-cordial
- Purpose of invitation
- Date/time of event
- Venue (address)
- Name of special guest (if any)
- RSVP
- Contact detail/number

(B) Letter type-informal reply

5. Attempt ANY ONE of two, in about 120-150 words.

- (A) You are Damanjit Singh, a fresh graduate of film-making (BFA), from JTTI, Chandigarh. You saw the given advertisement in the newspaper and wish to apply for the position advertised. Write a letter to Mili Johar Arts, along with your bio-d expressing your interest in the advertised post.



Mili Johar ARTS

ASSISTANT DIRECTORS wanted

For Feature Film
Opportunity for aspiring Assistant Directors

WHO DO WE NEED?
Freshers, Experienced, both welcome

REQUIRED -Degree/ Diploma in Film Making
Skills : Camera handling, functional knowledge of Marathi,
exceptional communication skills and ability to multi-task

Please send your resumes to- The Johar House, Offices 05-06,
(latest by 23 July 2023) Dnyanesh Hill, Mumbai

OR

- (B) Despite being an essential component of road safety infrastructure, many people do not respect zebra crossings and fail to follow traffic rules, which results in hazardous situations on the roads. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, sharing your concern, and examining the reasons for such behaviour. Provide suggestions for spreading awareness of rules and etiquettes involved, and ways to ensure adherence. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this letter. You are Somu Baruah, a concerned city resident.

- For awareness -
 - general public/educational institutions
 - how? - In person/social media
- Dire consequences - self and others
- Adherence -
 - fines & penalties
 - revoking driving licenses
 - strengthening traffic police force - monitoring resources and technology

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 1, Organisation-1, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

Format

Sender's address, Date, Receiver's address, Subject and Salutation/Salutation and Subject, Letter, Complimentary close (largely accepted -*Yours truly* for letter to editor & in business circuits -*Yours sincerely*)

(A) Content

- Covering Letter
- Reference to the advertisement
- Conveying suitability for the position
- Submission of application
- Bio data as separate enclosure
- Profile of self
- Educational Qualifications (include advertised requirements)
- Work experience/s (if relevant)- only internship/part-time relevant here
- References
- Any other relevant information

(B) Content

- Lack of awareness of the significance of zebra crossings and traffic rules, ignorance of etiquettes involved, and the lack of enforcement of existing laws related to road safety.
- Increased risk of accidents, injuries, and fatalities, disruption of traffic flow, damage to public property, legal penalties and fines, and revocation of driving licenses.
- Public campaigns, educational programs in schools, colleges, and other public places, informative pamphlets, posters, and videos on traffic rules and etiquettes, and highlighting the consequences of not following traffic rules and respect for zebra crossings.
- Imposing penalties and fines for those who violate traffic rules and do not respect zebra crossings, attending road safety awareness classes, and revoking driving licenses if necessary. Strengthening traffic police and providing them with the necessary resources and technology to monitor and enforce traffic laws.

6. Attempt ANY ONE of two, in about 120-150 words.

5

- (A)** You are Sohail Hassan of class XII-B. Write an article for your school magazine, sharing the importance of young adults, as volunteers in one's local community, the need to do so and the benefits involved. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this article.

Importance for personal growth + community development
 Benefits - For self: new skills, experience, a sense of purpose
 For community: positive impact
 What are the ways one could get involved?

OR

- (B) The R.W.A (Resident Welfare Association), Nandipura -II, launched a volunteer programme for the young adults in and around the neighbourhood, on 18 January 2023. As Sunitha. J, the local correspondent of the neighbourhood newsletter, write a report covering this event. Support your ideas with outline cues given below, to craft your report.

- which volunteer programme? - purpose of the launch event - it's importance
- activities that took place - who attended?
- any key messages delivered?
- how were young adults encouraged to join the volunteer program?
- any resources and information provided to attendees?
- any insight into follow up activities planned?
- what impact is expected to be achieved in the community?

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Organisation - 1, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

(A)

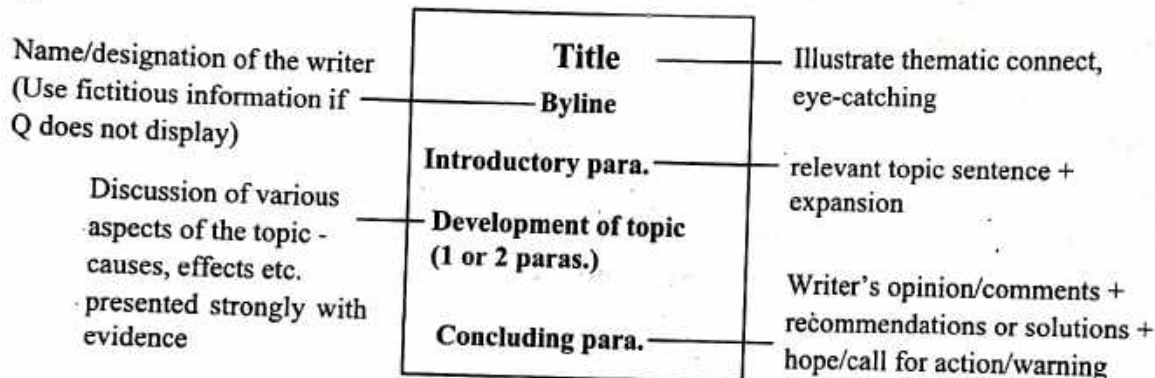
Format

- Title & By line

Organisation & Content:

Article Writing

The article should be crafted in this manner:



Note: An article is not boxed. A box has been used here, as a tool for clear illustration.

→ **Intro:**

- Volunteering in the local community -- a valuable experience for young adults --helps them develop new skills and interests ---benefits the community as a whole.

→ **Reasons to volunteer:**

- a great way to give back to the community --can make a positive difference in the lives of those around --create a sense of community and strengthen social bonds.
- can help develop new skills and interests -- gain practical experience in a variety of areas such as event planning, communication, and leadership--useful in future job applications and can also be personally fulfilling.
- provides opportunities for personal growth and self-reflection --helps gain a deeper understanding of own values and beliefs --can also learn more about the needs and challenges faced by others in their community.

→ **Conclusion:**

- Volunteering in one's local community is a rewarding experience that can benefit both the individual and the community --is important for young adults to get involved and make a positive contribution to the world around them

(B)

Report Writing

Format

- Headline & By line
- Reporting place and date
- Paragraphing organisation (Introductory paragraph + one or two Body paragraphs including event details + Concluding paragraph inclusive of witness accounts).



Organisation & Content:

The report should answer these questions

WHO? name of event, sponsor/organiser special guests, if any	WHERE & WHEN? date, time, place - town/city + venue	WHAT & HOW? events/programme details	WHAT DID THOSE PRESENT THINK? observations/ comments
---	--	---	---

- Reason **why** the programme was launched was
- Organised –by **whom**? **When**? **Who** attended?
- Event details –(refer to cues)
- Conclude including witness/participant account/s

SECTION-C: LITERATURE TEXTBOOK AND SUPPLEMENTARY READING TEXT (40 Marks)

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two, given.

6

(A) And such too is the grandeur of the dooms

We have imagined for the mighty dead;

All lovely tales that we have heard or read;

An endless fountain of immortal drink,

Pouring unto us from the heaven's brink.

(A Thing of Beauty)

(i) Which of the following themes is best represented in the given extract?

1

A. The beauty of nature

B. The power of imagination

C. The immortality of art and literature

D. The inevitability of death

Ans. C. The immortality of art and literature.

[The extract emphasizes the idea that the tales of the mighty dead are an "endless fountain of immortal drink" that pour down to us from the heavens, suggesting that these stories and legends are timeless and will never truly die. This theme speaks to the enduring power of art and literature to transcend time and space and to continue to inspire and move people long after their creators have passed away.]

(ii) State whether the given statement is TRUE or FALSE, with reference to the extract.

1

By referring to the dead as "mighty", the poet emphasizes their importance and the power they exerted on the people.

Ans. FALSE

[The dead are referred to as "mighty" in the poem because they have achieved greatness in their lifetime. They may have contributed to society in a significant way or achieved great things in their respective fields. It is not about the power they exerted on the people. By referring to them as "mighty," the poet emphasizes their importance and the positive impact or influence they have had on the world.]

(iii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

1

The "endless fountain of immortal drink" is an apt analogy for the tales of the mighty dead because _____.

Ans. ...just as a fountain constantly pours forth water, the tales of the mighty dead pour forth endless inspiration and wisdom for the living.

[The term "immortal drink" suggests that the stories are never-ending and that they have the power to nourish and sustain us in much the same way that water does.]

(iv) The use of the word "brink" in the extract suggests that the immortality that is being poured onto us is on the verge of overflowing. This creates a powerful image of _____.

1

Ans. abundance

[The use of the word "brink" in the poem suggests that the immortality that is being poured onto us is on the verge of overflowing. This powerful image suggests that the beauty and grandeur of the dooms are so great that they are overflowing from heaven. This image of abundance reinforces the idea that the beauty and grandeur of the dooms are endless and that there is an infinite supply of it.]

(v) Based on the poem rhyme scheme, evident in lines 2-5, of the given extract, which word rhyme with line 1?

1

said think tombs

Ans. tombs [rhymes with dooms, which is the last word of line 1]

(vi) Select the option that is NOT true about the lack of punctuation at the end of line 1 in the extract.

- A. Creates a sense of continuity and flow that connects the line with the second line.
- B. Encourages the reader to continue reading seamlessly without any pause.
- C. Creates a sense of anticipation and expectation for the reader.
- D. Encourages a revisit to the ideas in the preceding lines.

Ans. C. Creates a sense of anticipation and expectation for the reader

[the lack of punctuation at the end of the first line has a subtle yet significant impact on the poem, creating a sense of and continuity while also building anticipation and engaging the reader's imagination.]

OR

(B) ...I looked again at her, wan,
pale
as a late winter's moon and felt that
old
familiar ache, my childhood's fear,
but all I said was, see you soon,
Ammma,
all I did was smile and smile and
smile.....

(My mother at Sixty-six)

(i) What is the speaker's emotional state when looking at her mother?

- A. Confused and disoriented
- B. Nostalgic and longing
- C. Empathetic and understanding
- D. Fearful and apprehensive

Ans. D. Fearful and apprehensive

[The speaker mentions feeling an "old familiar ache" and "childhood's fear" when looking at her mother. This suggests a sense of fear or apprehension that is rooted in the speaker's past experiences with her mother.]

(ii) What does the use of the word "but" at the beginning of the line, 'but all I said..', suggest?

Ans. It suggests a contrast between the speaker's internal emotional response and her outward behaviour.

(iii) Select the word that WILL NOT complete the sentence appropriately.

The description of the mother as "wan, pale/as a late winter's moon" creates a vivid image of _____.

- A. vulnerability
- B. sensitivity
- C. frailty
- D. mortality

Ans. B. sensitivity

(iv) State whether the given statement is TRUE or FALSE.

The poetic device used in the line, 'pale as a winter's moon' is the same as the one used in the line, 'the winter wind wistful wailed at night'.

Ans. FALSE

[The poem's line holds a simile/metaphor whereas the other line is an example of alliteration - w sound]

(v) What message do these lines highlight, in the context of familial relationships, and the speaker's sense of anxiety and fear the prospect of losing her mother?

Ans. The poem highlights the importance of cherishing and appreciating the people we love, while we still can [quality time - life is transient and similar]

(vi) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The repetition of the word, 'smile' suggests that _____.

Ans. ...the speaker is trying to hold back her emotions and remain composed, despite the pain she feels at parting from her mother

8. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two, given.

A. Climate change is one of the most hotly contested environmental debates of our time. Will the West Antarctic ice sheet melt entirely? Will the Gulf Stream ocean current be disrupted? Will it be the end of the world as we know it? Maybe. Maybe not. Either way, Antarctica is a crucial element in this debate — not just because it's the only place in the world, which has never sustained a human population and therefore remains relatively 'pristine' in this respect; but more importantly, because it holds in its ice-cores half-million-year-old carbon records trapped in its layers of ice.

(Journey to the End of the Earth)

- (i) How does the absence of a human population in Antarctica make it significant in the climate change debate? 1
- Ans.** This makes it an important reference point for understanding the effects of human activities on the environment and the potential impacts of climate change. The absence of a human population in Antarctica means that the region is relatively pristine and has not been subject to the same levels of human impact as other areas of the world.]
- (ii) Why is "climate change" described as a "hotly contested" issue in the extract provided? 1
- This is so, because there _____.
- A. is universal agreement on the causes and implications of climate change
B. is a planned path ahead about how to address climate change
C. are differing views on the causes and implications of climate change
D. are minimal reports of fresh threats to climate change
- Ans.** C. are differing views on the causes and implications of climate change
- (iii) The analogy of a time machine is an appropriate analogy for the role of carbon records in the study of climate change because _____ 1
- Ans.** ... just like a time machine would allow us to observe past events, carbon records allow us to observe past climate conditions. [Carbon records allow us to study past climates by analysing the air bubbles trapped in ice cores. They provide a glimpse into the Earth's atmospheric conditions at the time the ice was formed and can help scientists understand how the climate has changed over time.]
- (iv) Give one reason why the writing style of the extract can be called factual and informative. 1
- Ans.** (Any one)
- ...because the writer presents information in a straightforward and objective manner.
 - ...because the writer applies a third-person point of view and avoids the use of personal opinion or emotional language.
 - ...because the writer uses a logical structure to present their argument.
- [starting with the importance of Antarctica as a relatively pristine location, and then moving on to explain the significance of the ice cores and carbon records found there].

OR

- (B) In other words, the Tiger King is dead.
- The manner of his death is a matter of extraordinary interest. It can be revealed only at the end of the tale. The most fantastic aspect of his demise was that as soon as he was born, astrologers had foretold that one day the Tiger King would actually have to die.
- "The child will grow up to become the warrior of warriors, hero of heroes, champion of champions. But..." they bit their lips and swallowed hard. When compelled to continue, the astrologers came out with it. "This is a secret which should not be revealed at all. And yet we are forced to speak out. The child born under this star will one day have to meet its death."
- (*The Tiger King*)
- (i) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1
- The author's purpose in using foreshadowing, is to _____.
- Ans.** (Any one)
- create a sense of approaching doom
 - use it as a tool to heighten the reader's curiosity and interest in the story
- (ii) In the given extract, what emotion were the astrologers feeling when they "bit their lips and swallowed hard"? 1
- A. Humiliation B. Disbelief C. Grief D. Unease
- Ans.** D. Unease
- [The use of this physical gesture indicates a sense of discomfort or unease, and implies that the astrologers were reluctant to reveal the prophecy. Humiliation or grief would be more strongly expressed in the text if they were the emotions being conveyed. Disbelief is also not the correct answer, as there is no indication that the astrologers doubted their prediction.]
- (iii) Which trait are the astrologers lauding when they say "warrior of warriors, hero of heroes, champion of champions"? 1
- Ans.** bravery/heroism/leadership
- [The astrologers are predicting that the child born under this star will be a great warrior and a champion, implying that the child will display exceptional courage and bravery in battle or in other challenges. This also suggests that the child will be a leader and will inspire others with their bravery and heroism. The use of these superlative phrases further emphasizes the astrologers' admiration for this trait and the importance they place on it in predicting the child's future.]

(iv) How is the line, "the most fantastic aspect of his demise", an example of contrast?

Ans. This is so because the word "fantastic" is usually associated with something positive or exciting, while the word "demise" suggests something negative or tragic.

[In this context, the use of "fantastic" to describe the Tiger King's death creates a contrast between the positive connotation of the word and the negative reality of the situation.]

9. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two, given.

(A) Usually, when school began, there was a great bustle, which could be heard out in the street, the opening and closing of desks, lessons repeated in unison, very loud, with our hands over our ears to understand better, and the teacher's great rapping on the table. But now it was all so still! I had counted on the commotion to get to my desk without being seen. Of course, that day everything had to be as quiet as Sunday morning. Through the window I saw my classmates, already in their places, and M. Hamel walking up and down with his terrible iron ruler under his arm. I had to open the door and look before everybody. You can imagine how I blushed and how frightened I was.

(The Last Lesson)

(i) List any two sensory details present in this extract.

Ans. (Any two)

- the sounds of the opening and closing of desks
- the loud lessons repeated in unison
- the teacher's ruler rapping on the table

(ii) Why does the protagonist feel anxious about entering the classroom on this particular day?

- A. The classmates have started the lesson
C. The classroom is too quiet

B. The teacher is in a bad mood

D. The protagonist is running late

Ans. A. The classmates have started the lesson.

[The protagonist sees through the window that the other students are already in their places, and this makes him feel anxious as he is trying to avoid being seen and is worried about being scolded by the teacher and embarrassed in front of his classmates. The fact that the other students have already started the lesson adds to his anxiety.]

(iii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The phrase "as quiet as Sunday morning" suggests that _____

Ans. ...the school was unusually quiet and still, as if it were a day of rest/holiday/school off, rather than a bustling school day.

(iv) Pick evidence from the extract that helps one infer that this was not the protagonist's first time being late to school.

Ans. The protagonist seems to have a plan for how to sneak into class without being noticed, suggesting that they may have been late before and have developed a strategy for avoiding punishment.

[The protagonist states: "I had counted on the commotion to get to my desk without being seen," which implies that they have been late before and have developed a strategy for avoiding punishment.]

(v) What does the term 'terrible iron ruler' indicate about M. Hamel?

Ans. The strictness and severity of M. Hamel's discipline.

(vi) Which of the following headlines best suggests the central idea of the extract?

A. The Fears of a Latecomer

C. The Rigidity of the School System

B. The Importance of Punctuality

D. The Anxiety of a Young Student

Ans. B. The Importance of Punctuality

[The extract revolves around the theme of punctuality and the consequences of being late. The protagonist is anxious and embarrassed about being late to school, highlighting the importance of being on time. The other options, such as A. The Fears of a Latecomer, C. The Rigidity of the School System, and D. The Anxiety of a Young Student, touch upon some of the themes in the extract but do not fully capture the central idea.]

OR

(B) Unaware of what his name represents, he roams the streets with his friends, an army of barefoot boys who appear like the morning birds and disappear at noon. Over the months, I have come to recognise each of them.

"Why aren't you wearing chappals?" I ask one.

"My mother did not bring them down from the shelf," he answers simply.

"Even if she did, he will throw them off," adds another who is wearing shoes that do not match. When I comment on it, he shuffles his feet and says nothing. "I want shoes," says a third boy who has never owned a pair all his life. Travelling across the country I have seen children walking barefoot, in cities, on village roads. It is not lack of money but a tradition to stay barefoot, is one explanation.

(Lost Spring)

- (i) What is the writer's purpose in allowing the boys to speak for themselves via dialogue, as opposed to only a writer's commentary? 1

Ans. (Any one)

- To give voice to their hopes, dreams, and struggles in a way that is immediate and relatable
- To add a sense of authenticity and realism to the story
- To make the experience more engaging and memorable for the reader

- (ii) The line, "It is not lack of money but a tradition to stay barefoot" can be best classified as: 1

A. A fact B. An opinion C. A theme D. A plot point

Ans. B. An opinion

[The line "It is not lack of money but a tradition to stay barefoot" is an opinion, since it is a subjective interpretation of the cultural practice of walking barefoot. The author is expressing her belief ("explanation"), in this extract.]

- (iii) Explain any one possible inference that can be drawn from the line, "an army of barefoot boys who appear like the morning birds and disappear at noon". 1

Ans. (Any one)

- The boys are barefoot, which suggests that they may come from poor or marginalized backgrounds and do not have access to proper footwear.
- The phrase "an army of barefoot boys" implies that the boys are a unified group, and that they have a sense of solidarity or shared identity.
- The comparison to "morning birds" suggests that the boys are lively and energetic, and that they move around quickly and unpredictably.
- The fact that the boys "disappear at noon" suggests that their time is limited or constrained in some way, and that they may need to return to their homes or other responsibilities.
- The use of the word "disappear" may also imply that the boys are overlooked or ignored by the wider society, and that they are not given the recognition or support that they need.
- The phrase "like the morning birds" could also imply that the boys are vulnerable, and that their carefree lifestyle may be disrupted by external factors such as poverty, exploitation, or violence.

- (iv) Identify the line from the text that bears evidence to the fact that the writer's association with the boys is not a recent one. 1

Ans. The line from the text: "Over the months, I have come to recognize each of them."

[This suggests that the writer has been observing and interacting with the boys for a prolonged period of time, and that she has developed a deeper understanding of their lives and circumstances. The phrase "over the months" indicates that the writer's relationship with the boys is ongoing and has developed gradually, rather than being a one-time encounter.]

- (v) Based on the context provided in the extract, select the most likely comment that the writer would have made, based on the boy's reaction to the mismatched shoes. 1

- A. "Why are your shoes mismatched? That's not a good look."
- B. "Don't worry about your shoes, you can wear a matching pair later."
- C. "I like your shoes. What matters is that they protect your feet."
- D. "Have you chosen to mismatch your shoes?"

Ans. C. "I like your shoes. What matters is that they protect your feet."

[The reason for this is that the writer's comment had been met with silence and the shuffling of feet by the boy, which suggests that he may feel embarrassed or uncomfortable about his footwear. Therefore, a comment that emphasizes the functional purpose of shoes and acknowledges their value in protecting one's feet would likely be more reassuring and positive.]

Option A ("Why are your shoes mismatched? That's not a good look.") could be seen as critical and potentially judgmental, and may not be well-received by the boy.

Option B ("Don't worry about your shoes, you can wear a matching pair later.") may not be practical or realistic, depending on the boy's circumstances.

Option D ("Have you chosen to mismatch your shoes?") may come across as sarcastic or dismissive, and may not effectively address the boy's feelings or needs.]

- (vi) Complete the sentence with ONE word. 1

The phrase "he answers simply", suggests that the boy's response to the writer's question about why he wasn't wearing chappals was _____.

Ans. straightforward/uncomplicated/direct/clear

The boy's simple answer implies that there may not be any hidden or complex reasons for his lack of footwear, and explanation for why he wasn't wearing chappals was as straightforward as his mother not bringing them down from the roof. The use of the word "simply" in this context emphasizes the directness and clarity of the boy's response, and suggests he may not have felt the need to elaborate or justify his situation further.]

10. Answer ANY FIVE of the following six questions, in about 40-50 words.

Content-1

- Full credit for appropriate inclusion of all content asked for
- Partial credit $\frac{1}{2}$ for relevant but incomplete content

Expression

- Full credit for effective organisation
- Partial credit $\frac{1}{2}$ for some semblance of organisation of ideas

Deduct $\frac{1}{2}$ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors)

The given detailed reference points can be drawn upon to structure the desired response:

(i) What can be inferred from Rajendra Prasad's recorded upshot of the lawyer consultations, at Motihari?

[Reference - The senior lawyer replied, they had come to advise and help him; if he went to jail there would be no advise and they would go home. What about the injustice to the sharecroppers, Gandhi demanded]
(Indigo)

- Ans. • that Gandhi's commitment to the cause of the peasants, despite being a stranger to the region, was exemplary and motivated the lawyers to continue their support.
- highlights the idea that the lawyers were conscious of the potential shame they would bring upon themselves if they deserted the peasants in their time of need.
 - suggests that Gandhi's moral authority and courage had a significant impact on those around him and helped to instill a sense of purpose and conviction in their own efforts to fight for justice and freedom.

(ii) Douglas uses sensory details to create a vivid image of the unfortunate experience in the pool. What might be the impact on the reader if the narration were more informative than sensory?
(Deep Water)

Ans. If more informative than sensory, the impact on the reader would likely be less emotional and engaging as:

- sensory details help readers connect with the experience being described on a deeper level.
- sensory details allow readers to visualize the scene in their minds and feel like they are a part of it.

Even though informative details may provide more factual information but can sometimes feel detached and impersonal, leaving readers feeling less connected to the story.

(iii) How does the setting of the remote forest location in 'The Rattrap' contribute to the overall tone and mood of the story?

Ans. Serves as a significant backdrop for the events that unfold in the story.

- creates a sense of isolation and desolation, emphasizing the loneliness and despair that the peddler experiences.
- the harsh winter conditions and the barren landscape add to the overall tone of melancholy and hopelessness.
- the forest also represents the metaphorical wilderness of the human soul, highlighting the struggles and temptations people face in their journey through life.

Therefore, the setting plays a vital role in establishing the mood and atmosphere of the story.

(iv) How might the message of the poem, 'Aunt Jennifer's Tigers' be different, if the following last four lines were omitted?

When Aunt is dead, her terrified hands will lie
Still ringed with ordeals she was mastered by,
The tigers in the panel that she made
Will go on prancing, proud and unafraid.

Ans. • If the last four lines were omitted, the poem would have a more sombre tone.

- Without the image of the tigers continuing to prance, the poem would end on a note of despair, with Aunt Jennifer's hands still ringed with the ordeals she was mastered by.
- The message of the poem would refer to the oppression and suffering of women, without any hope for liberation.

[By ending the poem on these lines, the author achieves a sense of hope and transcendence. The image of the tigers continuing to prance, proud and unafraid, suggests that there is a way to transcend the oppression and suffering of women, even if it is only through art. The poet suggests that art can provide a kind of liberation, even in the face of social and cultural constraints.]

- (v) Umberto Eco, with reference to "The Name of the Rose" says, "I think if I had written The Name of the Rose ten years earlier or ten years later, it wouldn't have been the same." What could he have meant?
(The Interview)

Ans. Umberto Eco suggests that the success of his book, "The Name of the Rose," was largely due to timing. He believes that if he had written the book ten years earlier or ten years later, it wouldn't have had the same impact.

- This could be interpreted as Eco recognizing the importance of cultural context and how the reception of a work of art is influenced by the historical, social, and political climate of its time.
- Eco might be suggesting that the themes and ideas he explored in his novel resonated particularly strongly with readers in the cultural moment in which it was published, and that this moment was fleeting.

Therefore, if he had written the book earlier or later, it might not have been as relevant or timely, and might not have captured the same level of attention and interest.

- (vi) What does the story of Subbu's success in the film industry reveal about the importance of loyalty, creativity, and versatility in this field?

(Poets and Pancakes)

Ans. Subbu's success in the film industry reveals that loyalty, creativity, and versatility are essential qualities for success in this field -

- Subbu was an extremely loyal employee who identified himself completely with his principal and turned his entire creativity to his principal's advantage.
- He was also a highly versatile and creative person who could be inspired to come up with numerous alternatives when given a problem to solve.
- Additionally, he had the ability to work well with others and was tailor-made for the film industry.

These qualities made him an invaluable asset to the Gemini Studios during its golden years.

11. Answer ANY TWO of the following three questions, in about 40-50 words.

2×2=4

Content-1

- Full credit for appropriate inclusion of all content asked for
- Partial credit ½ for relevant but incomplete content

Expression-1

- Full credit for effective organisation
- Partial credit ½ for some semblance of organisation of ideas

Deduct ½ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors).

The given detailed reference points can be drawn upon to structure the desired response.

- (i) How can we say that the vadai packet incident reveals that the writer lacked the cognitive and emotional maturity required to understand the implications of untouchability?

Ans. • At the time of the incident, the writer was only in the third grade, which means that she was likely around eight years old - children at that age are still developing their cognitive and emotional abilities - it is not uncommon for them to lack a full understanding of complex social issues like untouchability.

- The writer's shared that she had not, till then, heard people speak openly of untouchability - suggests that she may not have had a complete grasp of the issue's societal implications.
- It is possible that she understood that certain individuals were treated differently from others, but she may not have fully comprehended the scope of the problem.

- (ii) What does the play 'On the Face of It' suggest about the importance of empathy in overcoming prejudice and stereotypes?

Ans. The play highlights the damaging effects of prejudice and stereotypes on both the victim and the perpetrator. However, it also suggests that empathy and understanding can overcome these barriers.

Through the development of a relationship between the two characters, Derry and Mr. Lamb, we see how their initial assumptions about each other are challenged and ultimately broken down.

This underscores the importance of empathy in recognizing and overcoming prejudices, as it allows individuals to see beyond surface-level differences and connect on a deeper level.

- (iii) Answer the question in the context of the following lines from 'The Enemy'.

"Stupid Yumi," she muttered fiercely. "Is this anything but a man? And a wounded helpless man!" In the conviction of her own superiority she bent impulsively and untied the knotted rugs that kept the white man covered.

Explain the superiority Hana is convinced about.

- Ans. • In the given lines, Hana is expressing her frustration with Yumi, who is hesitant to help her with the wounded wh
 • By saying "Is this anything but a man? And a wounded helpless man!" Hana is highlighting the fact that the humans, regardless of their race or nationality.
 • She believes that their common humanity makes it their moral duty to help the wounded man.
 • In these lines, she is asserting her own intervention and belief in the importance of doing the right thing, even if against traditional values or societal norms.
 • This demonstrates her sense of moral superiority over Yumi, who is more concerned with following the strict rule society than with helping a fellow human being.

12. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 120-150 words.

Content-2

- Full credit for sustained, clear, well-developed personal response to the task that appropriately justifies any arguments
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the response clarity and relevance.

Expression-2

- Full credit for effective organisation -structure, relevant vocabulary and effective relay of ideas.
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the level of coherence and cohesion.

Accuracy-1

- Full credit for none to minimal errors.
- Partial credit of ½ for spellings and/or grammatical, largely accurate.
- No credit for error density causing impediment in understanding.

[Content, in suggested responses, may be above the recommended word limit, as it aims to share content points that can be drawn upon to structure the final desired response.]

(A) Imagine you are Pablo Neruda, the poet of *Keeping Quiet*.

What advice might you offer to Robert Frost, the poet of *A Roadside Stand*, in the context of his conflicted emotions displayed in the given lines

*The requisite lift of spirit has never been found,
 Or so the voice of the country seems to complain,
 I can't help owning the great relief it would be
 To put these people at one stroke out of their pain.*

Pen down your advice, in a letter to Frost.

You may begin this way:

Dear Robert

I recently read your poem, "A Roadside Stand," and...

You may end this way:

I hope this advice is helpful to you. Please let me know if there is anything else I can do to support you.

Warmly,

Pablo Neruda

Ans. Suggested response:

Dear Robert

I recently read your poem, "A Roadside Stand," and was struck by the conflicting emotions that you expressed towards the roadside stand. I understand that it can be difficult to make decisions when we are overwhelmed by our emotions.

In my own experience, I have found that taking a moment of stillness and reflection can be very helpful in gaining a deeper understanding of the situation and connecting with our own humanity and that of others. This is the message that I try to convey in my poem, "Keeping Quiet".

I would advise you to take a moment to be still and contemplative before making any decisions about the fate of the people at the roadside stand. By quieting your mind and being present in the moment, you may be able to understand their struggles and pain objectively, and gain a new perspective about your own place in the world too. I also feel that by breaking from your routine and taking a moment of stillness and reflection, you might gain a deeper understanding of the situation and make a more functional decision.

I believe that this moment of reflection could help you to see beyond your conflicting emotions. We are all human, after all, and before connecting with others, and resolving their issues, we must try to connect with our own selves to advice from a place of balance and calm.

I hope this advice is helpful to you. Please let me know if there is anything else I can do to support you.

Warmly

Pablo Neruda

OR

- (B) The different portrayals of women in the texts 'Aunt Jennifer's Tigers', 'Going Places', 'Lost Spring', and 'My Mother at Sixty-six', offer insights into the experiences of women in society.

You have been asked to address your peers and share-

→ the ways these portrayals highlight the diversity of the female experience.

→ the importance of understanding each individual woman's challenges and experiences.

Compose this draft, with reference to any three of these prescribed texts. listed above.

You may begin this way:

Good morning, everyone.

As I analysed the allotted texts...

You may end this way.

To conclude, I'd like to say that ...

Ans. Suggested response:

Good morning, everyone.

As I analysed the allotted texts, I noticed that though each portrayal of women was unique, they all offered varied insights into the experiences of women in society.

To begin with, Aunt Jennifer was portrayed as a victim of patriarchy, living in a world where women were expected to conform to societal norms and expectations and was unable to attain freedom and strength she desired, due to the limitations imposed upon her by society.

In contrast, Sophie was portrayed as ambitious and determined to break free from societal norms. She refused to be limited by her gender and sought to challenge the restrictions placed upon her. Sophie's mother, on the other hand, from a generation prior, had chosen to conform and sacrifice her individuality to societal expectations.

Similarly in "Lost Spring," the grandmother and daughter-in-law, in Firozabad, were portrayed as resilient in the face of poverty and the societal constraints of their caste. However, unlike Sophie's and Aunt Jennifer's need to find an outlet, they found ways to make the best of their situation, despite the limitations placed upon them.

When we analyse the portrayal of the aged mother, in "My Mother at Sixty-six," she is presented as vulnerable and in need of protection. Sadly, it does make one wonder about the unaddressed vulnerability of Sophie's mother and the grandmother in "Lost Spring". A point worth considering is that Kamala Das' mother's acceptance of her circumstances comes across as a voluntary decision, whereas that of the women in "Lost Spring" is akin to resignation.

These portrayals of women offer valuable insights into the experiences of women in our society -from victimization to the resilience in the face of poverty - and offer us important lessons about strength, vulnerability, and the need for empathy and respect.

To conclude, I'd like to say that as readers, we can learn from their experiences and strive towards a more equitable and just society. These characters, stress that it is important to recognise the complexities of each woman's experiences, and refrain from passing sweeping judgements as women are not a uniform group, but rather unique individuals.

3. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 120-150 words.

5

Content-2

- Full credit for sustained, clear, well-developed personal response to the task that appropriately justifies any arguments
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the response clarity and relevance

Expression-2

- Full credit for effective organisation -structure, relevant vocabulary and effective relay of ideas
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the level of coherence and cohesion

Accuracy-1

- Full credit for none to minimal errors
- Partial credit of ½ for spellings and/or grammatical, largely accurate
- No credit for error density causing impediment in understanding

[Content, in suggested responses, may be above the recommended word limit, as it aims to share content points that can be used upon to structure the final desired response.]

(A) In the story, 'The Third Level' by Jack Finney, Charley is obsessed with finding the third level. In an attempt to thrash out whether this obsession is a good quality or a harmful one, Charley's wife expresses her views in a diary entry.

As Louisa, Charley's wife, write this diary entry. Support your response with reference to the story.

You may begin this way:

I have been married to Charley for a few years now and I have always known him to be an intelligent man with an imaginative mind. However, his recent obsession with finding the Third Level has ...

Ans. Suggested response:

I have been married to Charley for a few years now and I have always known him to be an intelligent man with an imaginative mind. However, his recent obsession with finding the Third Level has left me quite worried. While he talks about excitement, I cannot help but wonder if it is a good quality or a harmful one.

On one hand, Charley's obsession displays his determination and persistence in achieving his goals. It shows that he is willing to go to great lengths to unravel the mysteries of life. His imagination and curiosity are admirable qualities that have always attracted me to him.

However, his obsession has caused him to become detached from reality. He is no longer able to differentiate between what is real and what is not. He spends all his time and money searching for a place that may not even exist. This could be harmful not only to himself but also to our family.

I understand that he feels overwhelmed by the stress and pressures of his present life and Sam indicated that he uses his obsession as a coping mechanism. I think this is harmful as it prevents him from addressing the underlying issues that are causing him stress.

Furthermore, Charley's obsession has caused him to neglect his responsibilities. He has been absent from work and has not been able to contribute financially to our household. His obsession is affecting our relationship, and I am afraid that if he continues on this path, it might lead to irreparable damage.

Finally, all I can say is, I believe that Charley's obsession with finding the Third Level may have started as a harmless curiosity, but it has now become a harmful one. I love him dearly and I hope that he realizes that his obsession is affecting not only himself but also those around him.

OR

(B) A grown up Zitkala-Sa, reflects on the incident about cutting of her long hair and is conflicted that she did not do enough to resist and surrendered easily. She also wonders if she could have tried something else to prevent the incident.

As the grown-up Zitkala-Sa, create a diary entry, expressing these thoughts and conclude by absolving yourself of any blame. You may begin like this:

I find myself reflecting on an event that happened many years ago...

(Memories of Childhood)

Ans. Suggested response:

I find myself reflecting on an event that happened many years ago, one that has continued to haunt me ever since. It is an incident where my long hair was forcefully cut off at the Carlisle Indian School. As I sit here today, I cannot help but feel conflicted about my actions that day.

On one hand, I am proud that I stood up for myself and refused to submit to their demands at first. I remember the first time they cut my belly as I declared that I would struggle before giving in. However, as time passed, my spirit wavered, and eventually I allowed them to cut my hair. Looking back now, I cannot help but feel that I gave in too easily, that I did not do enough to resist.

As I ponder over what I could have done differently, I realize that there might have been other options. Perhaps I could have sought help from my fellow students. Maybe I could have tried to escape or find another way out of the situation. But in that moment, I was so overwhelmed and confused that I could not think straight.

I know that I have blamed myself for this incident for far too long. But today, I choose to absolve myself of any blame. As a young girl, I was forced into a strange place. I was not given the chance to make my own choices, to decide what was best for me. I was a victim of a system that sought to strip away my identity and forced me to assimilate.

Today, I choose to forgive myself and honour the brave little girl who stood up for herself that day. I am grateful for her courage and strength, and I will continue to honour her memory by fighting for justice and equality for all.

□□□

CBSE ADDITIONAL PRACTICE QUESTIONS

ADDITIONAL PRACTICE QUESTIONS (2023-24)

ENGLISH CORE (Code No. 301)

CLASS-XII

Time allowed : 3 hours

Maximum Marks : 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS:

1. The Question Paper contains *THREE* sections-*READING, WRITING and LITERATURE*.
2. Attempt Question based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION-A: READING SKILLS (22 Marks)

Reading Comprehension Through Unseen Passages

1. Read the following text.

12 M

- (1) Apollo, the Greek god of music and healing, always maintained that he was the greatest musician in the world, until Marsyas, who was part animal and part human, played the flute. Apollo's jealousy and insecurity drove him to eventually slay Marsyas so that his status as the greatest musician remained unchallenged. One's usual imagination of a god is a being who is all-knowing and pure in every intention. What makes the Greek gods interesting is that they are shown as flawed beings who do not always act like 'Gods'.
- (2) In appearance, the gods resemble mortals, whom, however, they far surpass in beauty, grandeur, and strength; they are also more commanding in stature, height being considered by the Greeks an attractive feature in men or women. They resemble human beings in their feelings and habits, marrying and having children with them. They require daily nourishment to maintain their strength, and sleep to restore their energy. Their blood, a bright magical fluid called Ichor, never causes disease, and, when shed, produces new life.
- (3) The Greeks believed that the mental qualifications of their gods were much higher than those of men, but, nevertheless, displayed human passions like revenge, deceit, and jealousy. In mythological tales, the gods always punish the evil-doer and administer dire punishments to any mortal who dares to neglect their worship. They often visit mankind and partake of their hospitality, and in many tales, both gods and goddesses become attached to mortals. Although there were so many points of resemblance between gods and men, there remained the one great characteristic distinction: immortality. Still, the gods were not invulnerable, and were often wounded and suffered so much that they'd pray for death. The gods could transport themselves to incredible distances with the speed of thought.
- (4) They could be invisible at will, and could take the forms of men or animals as it suited their convenience. They could also transform human beings into trees, stones, or animals. Their robes were like those worn by mortals, but were perfect in form

and much finer in texture. Their weapons also resembled those used by mankind. They often used spears, shields, helmets and arrows. Most of these divinities lived on the summit of Mount Olympus, each having his or her own palace. Magazines and temples were erected to their honour, rich gifts were presented to them, and living creatures were sacrificed on their altars. (5) In Greek mythology, the gods take every opportunity to reveal and establish their divinity but also fall prey to human emotions. Perhaps the Greeks did so to help generations of readers reflect on important life lessons to avoid tragic downfalls.

- E. M. Berens
Source (edited): 'Myths and Legends of Ancient Greece and Rome' -
(448 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) '... they are shown as flawed beings who do not always act like 'Gods'. (paragraph 1)

Which of these are examples of the above statement?

- I. Gods getting attached and falling in love
- II. Gods punishing mortals for their wrongdoing
- III. Gods showing kindness and compassion to all
- IV. Gods deceiving everyone for their personal gain
- V. Gods killing a mortal out of jealousy and insecurity

Select the correct option.

- A. Only I and III B. Only II and V C. Only I, IV, and V D. Only II, IV, and V

Ans. C. Only I, IV, and V

[The descriptions in I, IV, and V exemplify the given statement as they show Gods as flawed and behaving like a human being.]

- (ii) Which of these would Apollo most likely say about Marsyas' musical ability?

- A. 'Why does everyone think he plays music well? It is obvious that he doesn't have talent.'
- B. 'Why is he challenging me like that? I wonder what is troubling him that I can heal.'
- C. 'How can an animal play the flute? Such creatures must know their place.'
- D. 'How dare he play better than me? I am supposed to be the best in the world.'

Ans. D. 'How dare he play better than me? I am supposed to be the best in the world.'

[The passage mentions that Apollo felt jealous and insecure after hearing Marsyas play. Therefore, he is likely to say something that shows how offended he is about not being the best musician in the world.]

- (iii) Why does the author begin the passage with a description of Apollo?

- A. to show that the Greek Gods have immense power and influence over the mortals
- B. to emphasise the point that the Greek Gods are based in interesting stories
- C. to highlight the point that the Greek Gods are more human-like in nature
- D. to state that the Greek Gods are also allowed to make mistakes

Ans. C. to highlight the point that the Greek Gods are more human-like in nature

[The author concludes paragraph 1 by making the point that the Greek Gods were 'flawed' and would not act like 'Gods' sometimes, or that they would behave like a human being would. This option best captures why the author begins the passage with Apollo's story.]

- (iv) What is ironic about Apollo being the one who slays Marsyas? Answer in about 40 words.

Ans. ♦ It is ironic as he is the god of 'healing' and he brought about destruction;

- ♦ The god of healing acted on an impulse that shows that he himself needed healing;
- ♦ The behaviour of the god is unexpected as he is supposed to show behaviours that would 'heal' mortals.

- (v) Based on your reading of paragraph 3, explain what 'invulnerable' means. Answer in one sentence.

Ans. ♦ It means to be immune.

- ♦ It means to be protected against harm or damage.
- ♦ It means to be safe.

- ♦ It means to be indestructible.
- ♦ It means to not be vulnerable.

Accept any one answer, or any other variations of the given responses.

(vi) In 40 words, state any two ways that the Greek gods are superior to human beings.

2

Ans. ♦ they are more beautiful and grand

- ♦ they are stronger and taller
- ♦ they have magical blood, Ichor
- ♦ they are more intelligent
- ♦ they are immortal
- ♦ they can transport themselves anywhere with a thought
- ♦ can be invisible at will or take any form they desire
- ♦ wear robes of finer texture
- ♦ have temples erected to them,
- ♦ have creatures sacrificed in their name
- ♦ they were given rich gifts

Accept any two points.

(vii) Complete the given sentence with ONE word.

From the fact that the Greek gods punish any mortal who neglects their worship, we can infer that they are _____. 1

Ans. ♦ vengeful/revengeful

- ♦ egotistical/egoistic
- ♦ conceited

Accept any other relevant inference.

(viii) Imagine that someone was born from Ichor. In which of these situations would the Ichor be most useful?

1

- a natural disaster that causes the earth to split apart
- a pandemic that has been caused by a contagious virus
- a war that requires transforming into another form quickly
- a competitive entrance exam that is very tough to qualify for

Ans. B. a pandemic that has been caused by a contagious virus

[Ichor, as described in the passage, never causes disease.]

Therefore, someone born of Ichor and having it flow through their veins would also not contract any disease. A pandemic caused by a contagious virus would, therefore, be a situation that such a creature would be able to survive successfully.]

(ix) What does the author mean by 'tragic downfalls' in paragraph 5? Give an example of a tragic downfall in current times in about 40 words.

2

Ans. Explanation:

- ♦ He is referring to the ugly consequences of our actions when we act based on an impulse or out of jealousy, insecurity, etc.
- ♦ He is referring to those actions that we do to others with the intention of causing harm, destruction, or taking revenge.
- ♦ These are those situations that we may regret but have no way of reversing as they have dire consequences.
- ♦ It means starting from a place where we are put on a pedestal and falling to a level where we are looked down upon.

(any one)

Example:

- ♦ A person breaks a friendship between two people because they feel jealous of how close the friends are. The person is shunned, as a result.
- ♦ One commits a serious crime, like theft or destruction, because one wants to take revenge on someone. One may go to jail, as a result.
- ♦ We agree to cause harm to someone else because a loved one asks this of us. As a result, we destroy someone's life who did no harm to us.

Accept any other valid response.

2. Read the following text.

- (1) ChatGPT has been gaining attention for how closely it mimics human-like responses. Created by OpenAI in 2022, the chatbot has been trained to have knowledge of worldly events and phenomena up till September 2021 and to interpret the context of texts to produce meaningful responses. The tool can provide answers on many topics, and often states disclaimers if it cannot answer a prompt accurately. Unlike a search engine, it cannot browse the internet for information. It also does not collect any personal information of users.
- (2) A survey was administered to understand the uses of ChatGPT in the fields of education, healthcare and research. The survey had 420 participants in the study of which 59 respondents were from the medical field, 118 respondents were students and 243 were from the research field, 70 respondents identified as administrative staff, and 173 people marked 'other' as their occupation. Of the 420 respondents, only 40% had used ChatGPT before. More medical trainees and students as well as research faculty had used ChatGPT as compared to medical staff and research faculty.
- (3) The survey asked about the viability of ChatGPT for its use within the fields of education, research, and healthcare. The following table summarises the responses.

Question	Statement	Number of respondents
Should ChatGPT be used in Education?	No, it should be banned.	11
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	226
	Yes, it should be actively incorporated.	183
Should ChatGPT be used in Research?	No, it should not be used at all.	6
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	75
	Yes, but it should only be used to brainstorm.	68
	Yes, as long as its use is transparently disclosed.	259
	Yes, disclosure is NOT needed.	10
Should ChatGPT be used in Healthcare?	No, it should not be used at all.	15
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	177
	Yes, it can be used for administrative purposes.	176
	Yes, it can be used for any purpose.	51

- (4) Based on the responses, there was a greater uncertainty around its use in healthcare and education, compared to using it in research. Regarding the use of ChatGPT in healthcare, a significant portion of respondents (42%) approved of using it for administrative purposes (for example, preparing patient profiles or reports) and a smaller population of respondents (12%) felt it could be used for any purpose.
- (5) The current application of ChatGPT and its future potential needs to be examined. It can help students understand texts and write more effectively, simplify medical information for patients and automate administrative tasks, and prepare a summary of information which otherwise would require hours of reading through various resources. However, its negative impact must also be considered before institutions approve its use.

- Multiple Authors

Source (edited): 'An exploratory survey about using ChatGPT in education, healthcare, and research' - (330 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) Complete the given sentence in ONE word.

Based on the summary table, the _____ number of respondents think that ChatGPT should not be used.

Ans. ♦ least

♦ minimum

♦ smallest

- (ii) The following was a prompt posted by a user in ChatGPT as their first question:
'What's my name?'

Based on information from the passage, which of these is most likely to be ChatGPT's response?

- A. 'Error 404: page not found.' B. 'Your name is user 1000004'.
C. 'Sorry, can you repeat the question?' D. 'Sorry, I don't have access to your data'.

Ans. D. 'Sorry, I don't have access to your data'.

[Paragraph 1 clearly states that ChatGPT gives human-like responses, does not collect personal information, and often gives disclaimers if it cannot answer a prompt appropriately. Since the question states that it is the 'first' question asked by the user, we can assume that no other details have been shared before. Therefore, THIS option correctly displays a response that applies all three features of ChatGPT.]

- (iii) Imagine that you have to write a news report on a major landslide that occurred in Manipur on 30 June, 2022. Would using only ChatGPT be useful for your project? State why or why not in 40 words.

Ans. ♦ No, using only ChatGPT would not be useful.

♦ Justification: ChatGPT only has information till September 2021.

♦ ChatGPT cannot browse the internet for information.

- (iv) The following are the profiles of some respondents from the survey. Based on the passage, which of these profiles is MOST LIKELY to be a part of the 40% who have used ChatGPT before?

- A. a manager in a hospital who has done 5 years of administrative work
B. a professor of Psychology who has 30 years of teaching experience
C. a college graduate who is studying in a 2-year Master's course
D. a 25-year-old teacher who is working in a public school

Ans. C. a college graduate who is studying in a 2-year Master's course

[The passage states that more medical trainees and students as well as research students of the survey have used ChatGPT. This means that the profile of a student is most likely to be a part of the 40% of users who have used ChatGPT.]

- (v) Which of these is true about the respondents of the survey?

- A. It had 118 respondents who were employed in the field of education.
B. It had 70 respondents who had administrative roles in educational institutions.
C. It had 173 respondents who were working in the field of research including students.
D. It had 59 respondents who were from the medical field including those who study medicine.

Ans. D. It had 59 respondents who were from the medical field including those who study medicine.

[The passage states that a total of 59 respondents of the survey were individuals from the medical field. The passage also states that medical trainees and students have used ChatGPT. Therefore, we can infer that the 59 respondents from the medical field include students.]

- (vi) Why do you think some respondents feel that ChatGPT should be banned in education? State a reason in 40 words.

Ans. ♦ Reason 1: students might use ChatGPT to do homework without using their own mind

♦ Reason 2: no way for teachers to check for plagiarism easily

♦ Reason 3: ChatGPT summarises information, which is a key skill for students to learn. Therefore, they should be encouraged to browse and collate information themselves, rather than having ChatGPT do so for them.

Accept any one relevant reason.

- (vii) Locate a detail from the passage that shows that we still do not know enough about ChatGPT. Answer in one sentence.

Ans. ♦ Detail 1: The last paragraph states that the application of ChatGPT needs to be examined.

♦ Detail 2: The last paragraph states that we need to consider its negative impact before institutions start using it.

♦ Detail 3: The summary table's statement 'I don't know; it is too early to make a statement' has a majority selection for Education and Healthcare.

Accept any one detail.

- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE.

More than half of the respondents think it is ok to use ChatGPT in research if one clearly states its contribution.

Ans. ♦ TRUE

(259 respondents selected the statement, 'Yes, as long as its use is transparently disclosed.' This is more than half of the 420 participants of the survey.)

SECTION-B: CREATIVE WRITING SKILLS (18 Marks)

Note: All Details Presented in the Questions are Imaginary and Created for Assessment Purposes

3. Attempt ANY ONE of two in about 50 words.

(A) Maruti Public School will be conducting an online course on news reading during the summer vacations for students XI and XII. In this course, students will learn to understand news reports, build the habit of reading the news regularly and will have a chance to interact with well-known journalists. As Rutwik Sen, Editor of the school magazine, draft a notice about 50 words for the school notice board, urging students to sign up. Mention any other relevant details required in the notice.

OR

(B) The Teen Well-Being Association of your society, EcoTech World, Sector 13, Chandigarh, will be holding free yoga sessions on Sunday mornings, in the common hall. As a member of the association, draft a notice in about 50 words informing young residents. Mention any other relevant details required for the notice.

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

Name of Organisation
NOTICE
Date
Hading [details]
Signature
Name (issuing authority)
Designation

- (A) » Correct format (as listed)
» Draws attention — students of XI & XII
» Mentions the event
» Gives details — date, time, venue
» Invites applications
» Adds line with reference to the undersigned

- (B) » Correct format (as listed)
» Draws attention — residents aged 12–18 years
» Mentions the event
» Gives details — date, time, venue
» Invites people to attend
» Adds line with reference to the undersigned

4. Attempt ANY ONE of two in about 50 words.

(A) You are a member of the Cultural Society at L.J. High School. Your school is organising a cultural programme aimed at spreading awareness about environmental conservation. The programme will have dance and song performances, poetry recitation, art exhibitions by the students throughout the day, in the school auditorium. In about 50 words, create an invitation for parents and school teachers to attend. Mention the relevant details required for an invitation.

OR

(B) You and your parents have received an invitation for your elder cousin's wedding to be held in Jaipur on 6th and 7th July. All of you would be delighted to attend. Draft a reply to your cousin accepting the invite and sharing your excitement while congratulating him.

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

(A) Card type formal invite

- » uses a single sentence presentation in third-person/skips end line punctuation
- » uses the simple present tense
- » answers the questions: who, whom, when, where, what time, for what

- » includes name and address of the organiser/host and name(s) of special invitees (if any)
- » avoids adding signatures

Layout mostly pertains to the following–

- » name of host(s)
- » standard formal and cordial expression
- » purpose of invitation
- » date & time of event
- » venue (address)
- » name of special guest(s) (if any)
- » RSVP
- » contact detail/number

(B) Letter type informal reply

- » uses a single sentence presentation/skips end line punctuation
- » uses the simple present tense
- » answers the questions: who, whom, when, where, what time, for what
- » includes name and address of the sender and the receiver
- » avoids adding signatures

Layout mostly pertains to the following–

- » name of host(s)
- » informal expression
- » purpose of invitation
- » date & time of event
- » mention of gratitude for the invitation
- » clear statement of acceptance or rejection of invitation
- » mention of any other details as required by the prompt

5. Attempt ANY ONE of two in about 120 – 150 words.

5

- (A) You are Sheena Singh, a recent graduate of High Horizon School. You came across the following advertisement about an internship in editing that you would like to apply for. Write a letter to Books Galore, expressing your interest in the position along with your resume.



Books Galore

We are a non-profit organisation that works with underprivileged children.
Our goal is not only to make reading possible, but also enjoyable!

SEEKING EDITORS

For the children's magazine
Internship for 3 months (May-July 2025) with a monthly pay

Your role:

- Edit children's entries (stories, poems, essays)
- Make sure content is free of grammatical errors
- Meet publishing deadlines for the magazine

Requirements:

- Senior Secondary Education Degree or above (Above 80% in Grade XII English Exam)
- Excellent command over the English language
- Positive attitude and willingness to learn

Send a sample of your writing and your resumé to: internhr@booksgalore.org
Deadline: 14th April, 2025

OR

- (B) Lifestyle diseases such as diabetes, obesity, hypertension, and heart diseases have increased in India. 53% of deaths are due to lifestyle diseases. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily about the issue and your understanding of the behind the same. Offer suggestions on how one can reduce their risk of having such diseases and on ways to cope with them. You may use the following cues to compose the letter. You are Shriya Rawat, a concerned citizen.

Consequences:

- leads to a poor quality of life mentally and physically
- increases the cost of health care
- can reduce life expectancy and cause early deaths

Solutions:

- follow a balanced diet
- incorporate some form of exercise that is sustainable
- get regular blood tests to check our health status

Ans. Format - 1, Content - 2, Organisation - 1, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1

(A) → Cover Letter

→ Reference to the advertisement

→ Conveying suitability for the position

→ Submission of application

Bio data as separate enclosure

→ Profile of self

→ Educational Qualifications (include advertised requirements)

→ Work experience/s (if relevant) - only internship/part-time relevant here

→ References

Any other relevant information

(B) → some reasons are: stressful lifestyles, poor decision-making, lack of adequate exercise or not having an exercise routine that is sustainable, getting enough good quality sleep.

→ some suggestions are: to have regular health check-up, to prioritise sleep over other aspects of life, to eat in a controlled manner, to schedule exercise regularly, to avoid consumption of unhealthy food and substances.

6. Attempt any one of two in about 120-150 words.

- (A) You are Sneha Hassan of Class XII. Write an article for your school magazine on the *Importance of Active Listening*. Explain on how good listening skills help one to gain multiple perspectives, be an effective team player, and contribute to an atmosphere of empathy and care. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this article.

Listening skills: listening and comprehending, paraphrasing, active body language like nodding, changing facial expressions, and sitting straight.

Effect on others: we feel heard and acknowledged, builds trust, others more likely to hear us, leads to more ideas being shared.

OR

- (B) Your school recently organised a workshop on Active Listening for students of Classes XI and XII on 21 January, 2024. Simran Kaur, a member of the organising committee, draft a report covering the event for your school's newspaper. Support your ideas with the outline cues given below to craft your report.

→ purpose of the workshop

→ who attended the workshop

→ activities that took place

→ key messages or takeaways from the workshop

→ post-workshop resources and information given to attendees

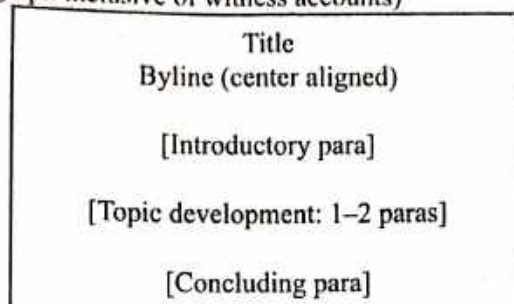
→ what impact the workshop would have on the students and their environment

Ans. **Format - 1, Content - 2, Organisation - 1, Accuracy of spelling and grammar - 1**
(A)

Article Writing

♦ **Format and Organisation**

- » **Headline and Byline**
- » **Reporting place and date**
- » **Paragraphing organisation** (introductory paragraph + one or two Body paragraphs including event details + Concluding paragraph inclusive of witness accounts)



- » Title (illustrate thematic content, eye-catching)
- » Byline (Name/designation of the writer — use fictitious info. if the Q does not display it)
- » Intro para (relevant topic sentence + expansion)
- » Topic development paras (discussion of various aspects of the topic — causes, effects, etc. presented with strong evidence)
- » Concluding para (writer's opinion/comments + recommendations or solutions + hope/call for action/warning)

→ **Intro:**

- ♦ Listening skills are important as they help one to learn more, to create an environment that is conducive to sharing, and encourage people to listen to our ideas.

→ **Ways to show and develop active listening:**

- ♦ paraphrase or clarify what other people have shared — this shows that one is listening to the points
- ♦ use body language to convey active listening — nod your head if you agree with a point; change your facial expressions to show appreciation, thinking, or to indicate when you are confused; sit straight to show attention
- ♦ have a favourable mindset — everyone can teach us something, showing respect leads to earning respect, do not listen to respond

→ **Conclusion:**

- ♦ Listening can be a great way to contribute meaningfully to discussions and make the environment welcoming for others.
- ♦ There are ways to develop active listening which includes certain actions, body language, and the right mindset.

(B)

Report Writing

♦ **Format and Organisation**

- » **Headline and Byline**
- » **Reporting place and date**
- » **Paragraphing organisation** (introductory paragraph + one or two Body paragraphs including event details + Concluding paragraph inclusive of witness accounts)

The report should answer these questions WHO? name of the event/sponsor/any special guests WHEN AND WHERE? date, time, venue, place WHAT AND HOW? purpose of programme and details WHAT DID THE ATTENDEES THINK? observations/comments from students
--

- Reason **why** the workshop was conducted
- organised — **by whom? for whom? when?**
- Event details (refer to the cues)
- Conclude by including witness/participant accounts

7. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given

(A) What I want should not be
confused
with total inactivity.
Life is what it is about;
I want no truck with death.
If we were not so single-minded
about keeping our lives moving,
and for once could do nothing,
perhaps a huge silence
might interrupt this sadness
of never understanding ourselves
and of threatening ourselves with death.

(Keeping Quiet)

(i) Which of these does the speaker imply through the following lines:

Life is what it is about;

I want no truck with death.

- A. Life is meant to be lived and death should not be the focus here.
- B. Life is meant to teach us lessons and near-death experiences are not always bad.
- C. Life is full of adventures and the fear of death should not stop us from exploring them all.
- D. Life is full of many choices and thoughts about death should not be a point of consideration.

Ans. A. Life is meant to be lived and death should not be the focus here.

[The speaker mentions that his suggestion of being completely still should not be confused with being dead. Life is what it is about implies that life is all about living. He wants nothing to do with death in his message.]

(ii) Complete the given sentence appropriately.

Based on the extract, silence would help humanity to _____.

- Ans. ♦ stop the collective sadness that stems from not understanding ourselves
♦ take the space needed to heal, which we are too busy to do otherwise
♦ lead more purposeful and meaningful lives

Accept any one relevant response.

(iii) What does the speaker mean when he describes people as 'single-minded'?

- A. People who only work towards understanding themselves.
- B. People who are driven by only one passion in their life.
- C. People who only focus on rushing through their life.
- D. People who can focus on only one task at a time.

Ans. C. People who only focus on rushing through their life.

[The speaker mentions 'single-minded' to say that people are limited in the kind of life they live as they only rush through life to keep it moving. This option captures the contextual meaning of this term appropriately.]

(iv) Justify the following statement as FALSE.

In the given extract, the speaker is ordering readers to do certain actions.

Ans. (Any one)

- ♦ The statement is false because the speaker is giving suggestions while presenting his theory about how silence can help humanity.
- ♦ It is false because the poet has used words like: 'If we were...', 'perhaps', 'might'
- ♦ It is false because the poet is expressing his views and thoughts and not noting down action points for humanity.

(v) Based on the extract, how do you think the speaker feels about humanity? Answer in one sentence.

Ans. ♦ is concerned about/cares for humanity

- ♦ wants better for humanity
- ♦ wants to support humanity

Accept any one relevant response.

- (vi) Observe how the lines in the poem break off at certain words. Give one reason why the poet has structured the lines in this manner. 1

Ans. ♦ The poet wants readers to pause on certain words so that his message is highlighted.

♦ The poet wants his message to be clear and concise.

Accept any one relevant reason.

OR

B. ... I saw my mother,

beside me,

doze, open mouthed, her face

ashen like that

of a corpse and realised with

pain

that she was as old as she

looked but soon

put that thought away, and

looked out at Young

Trees sprinting, the merry children spilling

out of their homes, ...

(My Mother at Sixty-Six)

- (i) Why does the poet compare her mother's face to a corpse? Answer in one sentence. 1

Ans. ♦ She makes this comparison because it highlights her mother's mortality/the ageing face reminds her that her mother will die someday.

♦ Her mother's face lacks colour due to old age, so it looks 'ashen' like a corpse would normally appear.

(any one)

- (ii) What effect does the phrase 'open mouthed' have on the poem? 1

A. It builds a mood of surprise and shock in the poem.

B. It reveals the speaker's fear of her own death and mortality.

C. It adds to the imagery of the speaker's mother appearing dead.

D. It highlights the speaker's attempt at hiding her emotions from her mother.

Ans. C. It adds to the imagery of the speaker's mother appearing dead.

[In the extract, 'open mouthed' is used to show how the mother is sleeping while connecting that to how she seems like an ashen corpse. Therefore, this phrase adds to the imagery.]

- (iii) Complete the given sentence appropriately. 1

The contrast present on the given extract is between _____.

Ans. ♦ the stillness of old age and the spirit of youth

♦ the reminder of mortality and the energy of youth/life

♦ the mood of doom and the mood of cheerfulness

♦ death and liveliness/being alive

(any one)

- (iv) State a reason for the following. 1

The speaker looks out of the window while travelling with her mother.

Ans. She looks out of the window because:

♦ she experiences the pain of realisation of her mother's mortality

♦ she is trying to distract herself from a sad thought

♦ it offers her a contrast from the mood of decay and sadness in the car to seeing the bubbly spirit of youth outside

(accept any variation of the given responses)

- (v) Which of these phrases uses the same poetic device as the following line from the extract? 1

looked out at Young Trees sprinting...

A. that restaurant is as nice as the Big Fish

C. that fluffy cloud crying with sadness

B. the pen became my highway to success

D. the tall trees with many branches



Ans. C. that fluffy cloud crying with sadness

[The given line is an example of personification wherein the 'young trees' are carrying out the human ability of 'sorrow'. In this option, an inanimate object (the cloud) has been attributed the human quality of crying out of sadness, which is an example of personification.]

(vi) Why do you think the poet has placed the word 'pain' on a separate line? Give a reason.

Ans. ♦ The line break forces the reader to focus on or pause on the speaker's feeling.

♦ It helps to highlight the speaker's emotion.

♦ It brings gravity to the situation that the speaker is describing with her mother.

♦ It adds sentimentality to the poem.

8. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two, given.

(A) The man ceased his mutterings, and then a third bell was tapped. Every one picked up his knife and fork and began to eat. But this eating by formula was not the hardest trial in that first day. Late in the morning, my friend Judewin gave me a warning. Judewin knew a few words of English; and she had overheard the paleface woman talk about cutting our long hair. Our mothers had taught us that only unskilled warriors who were captured had their hair shingled by the enemy. A

our people, short hair was worn by mourners, and shingled hair by cowards!

(Memories of Childhood: The Cutting of my Long Hair)

(i) Which of these can be inferred from the extract?

A. The speaker did not understand or speak English.

B. The speaker did not think highly of her own culture.

C. The speaker did not have any living family members.

D. The speaker did not know what a knife or fork were used for.

Ans. A. The speaker did not understand or speak English.

[The speaker mentions that her friend knew a bit of English because of which she understood what the white woman was going to do to them. Therefore, we can infer that she did not know or speak the language.]

(ii) How was the speaker feeling by the time the third bell rang? Why did she feel this way?

Ans. ♦ The speaker started crying because she felt confused and out-of-place.

♦ She couldn't understand the rituals and was probably feeling embarrassed.

♦ She was too scared to act because she was not able to do anything correctly.

(Any one)

(iii) Complete the given sentence appropriately.

The speaker compares her experience of eating to that of a trial because _____.

Ans. ♦ she was being watched and judged throughout

♦ it felt like a test of her survival

♦ it was as gruelling as a trial in court might have been

Accept any relevant interpretation.

(iv) Based on the extract, what would it mean to the speaker if her long hair was cut?

Ans. ♦ It would mean a loss of her culture/cultural identity

♦ It would bring her shame

♦ It would cut her roots to her culture and traditions

(Any one)

OR

(B) The presidents of the New York Central and the New York, New Haven and Hartford railroads will swear on a stack of timetables that there are only two. But I say there are three, because I've been on the third level of the Grand Central Station. Yes, I've taken the obvious step: I talked to a psychiatrist friend of mine, among others. I told him about the third level of mad, but he explained that he meant the modern world is full of insecurity, fear, war, worry and all the rest of it, and that just want to escape. Well, who doesn't? Everybody I know wants to escape, but they don't wander down into any third level at Grand Central Station.

(The Third Level)

(i) Complete the given sentence appropriately.

Unlike the two levels that have 'a stack of timetables' to prove their existence, the third level has _____.

- Ans. ♦ no actual proof/no physical evidence
♦ only the narrator's personal account of it
♦ its existence only in the narrator's imagination

Accept any relevant response.

(ii) Yes, I've taken the obvious step.

What is the narrator assuming that the reader is thinking when he says the above line?

- Ans. ♦ He is assuming that the reader thinks he might have gone mad.
♦ He is assuming that the reader might be questioning his sense of reality.
(Any one)

(iii) Which of these is an example of 'a waking-dream wish fulfillment' as described in the extract?

- A. Meenal loses her book and swears that it is her enemy who stole it.
B. Milind claims that he was petting his beloved dog whom he lost a few years ago.
C. Malini tells everyone that she saw a Cheetah though she herself knows it is a lie.
D. Mrinal thinks that he saw a spaceship in the sky which later turned out to be a normal aircraft.

- Ans. B. Milind claims that he was petting his beloved dog whom he lost a few years ago.

[The extract describes 'a waking-dream wish fulfillment' as experiences that one has while dealing with the misery of reality (like war, fear, insecurity, etc.). It may be a figment of one's imagination of what one actually wants in life. It is therefore something that is pleasant and something that is false. This option is the only example of a situation that shows someone's desire but which cannot be true.]

(iv) Based on the extract, what does the narrator think about the psychiatrist's opinion?

- Ans. ♦ The narrator does not agree with the opinion.
♦ The narrator thinks that escapism does not explain why he saw the third level because everyone wants to escape, but no one ends up on a third level at Grand Central Station.
♦ The narrator is not convinced by the explanation.

Accept any relevant inference.

9. Read the given extracts and answer the questions for ANY ONE of the two given.

(A) The old man was just as generous with his confidences as with his porridge and tobacco. The guest was informed at once that in his days of prosperity his host had been a crofter at Ramsjo Ironworks and had worked on the land. Now that he was no longer able to do day labour, it was his cow which supported him. Yes, that bossy was extraordinary. She could give milk for the creamery every day, and last month he had received all of thirty kronor in payment.

The stranger must have seemed incredulous, for the old man got up and went to the window, took down a leather pouch which hung on a nail in the very window frame, and picked out three wrinkled ten-kronor bills.

(The Rattrap)

(i) Based on the extract, which of these can we infer about the old man?

- A. He made more money at the creamery than as a crofter.
B. His occupation changed due to the limitations of old age.
C. His generosity increased as he became more prosperous in old age.
D. He preferred to earn by being his own boss rather than working under someone.

- Ans. B. His occupation changed due to the limitations of old age.

[The extract states that the old man was no longer able to do day labour 'now', i.e. when he was old. Therefore, it was the limitations of old age that made him switch from working as a crofter to earning money at a creamery.]

(ii) What is the author implying when she compares the old man's confidences with his porridge and tobacco?

- Ans. ♦ She wants to say that he parted with his porridge and his tobacco in a generous manner, just like he gave his secrets away.
♦ She is implying that the old man shared his secrets very easily.
♦ She means to convey that the old man was very trusting of the peddler.

(Any one)



(iii) Complete the given sentence appropriately.

Based on the extract, we can infer that being a crofter paid the old man _____.

- Ans. ♦ well/generously
♦ enough/sufficiently
(any one)

(iv) Which of these sentences uses 'supported' in the same way as the extract does?

- A. The pillars supported the thick ceiling that was made completely of stone.
B. Raman supported his friend's decision to find a job that pays her more money.
C. Lalitha supported her mother by sending some money home on a regular basis.
D. Few people supported the policy while the majority of the voters were against it.

Ans. C. Lalitha supported her mother by sending some money home on a regular basis.

[The word supported in the extract is being used to imply financial stability. The cow provided the old man with a income. The only option that captures this meaning is this option.]

(v) Why would the peddler have seemed 'incredulous'? State a reason.

- Ans. ♦ because the old man was showing him where all his money was;
♦ people do not usually reveal where they have kept their money;
♦ people do not usually trust strangers with such information
(Any one)

(vi) Justify any one trait of the old man that the extract reveals.

- Ans. ♦ The old man seems to be naive as he easily tells the peddler where all his money is.
♦ The old man is a generous man as he shares all his resources with the peddler freely.

Accept any other relevant trait with a logical justification.

OR

(B) So it is hardly surprising that opinions of the interview – of its functions, methods and merits – vary considerably. Some make quite extravagant claims for it as being, in its highest form, a source of truth, and, in its practice, an art. Others, celebrities who see themselves as its victims, might despise the interview as an unwarranted intrusion into their lives, or that it somehow diminishes them, just as in some primitive cultures it is believed that if one takes a photographic portrait of somebody then one is stealing that person's soul. V. S. Naipaul feels that, 'Some people are wounded by interviews and part of themselves.' Lewis Carroll, the creator of Alice in Wonderland, was said to have had 'a just horror of the interview and he never consented to be interviewed.'

(The Interview: Part I)

(i) Identify any one contrast in the extract and explain it in one sentence in your own words.

- Ans. ♦ The positive and negative opinions about the interview are being contrasted.
♦ The views of people who read interviews and those who get interviewed are being contrasted.

Accept any relevant response.

(ii) Based on V. S. Naipaul's quote, we can say that interviews _____.

- A. are forced upon people
B. are physically violent in nature
C. can build hostility and hatred
D. can be a traumatic experience

Ans. D. can be a traumatic experience

[The quote focuses on the negative experience of an interview, which is that it can wound people to the point of them losing a part of themselves. This option correctly paraphrases this as a conclusion.]

(iii) What is common between how celebrities feel about interviews and how primitive cultures viewed photographic portraits?

Ans. ♦ Both find it intrusive.

- ♦ Both think it somehow diminishes who they are.
♦ Both are not in favour of these ways of capturing someone's essence.

Accept any one of the responses.

(iv) Which of these uses 'just' in the same way as the following expression in the extract?
'a just horror of the interviewer'

1

- A. The just decision in the case against the criminal will empower us.
- B. I just need to buy one pencil so we can go shopping tomorrow.
- C. We will get back to you on this query in just a moment.
- D. The little girl looks just like her mother.

Ans. A. The just decision in the case against the criminal will empower us.

[The expression uses 'just' to mean 'fair' or 'reasonable'. This is the only option where 'just' has the same meaning as in the extract.]

(v) What makes an interview 'a source of truth'? State any one feature.

1

Ans. ♦ A feature of an interview is that we get information about the person from the person himself.

♦ An interview is usually done on-the-spot, which does not give us practiced responses.

♦ The interviewer asks the interviewee specific questions which the interviewee may not have disclosed otherwise.

Accept any other relevant response.

(vi) Complete the given sentence appropriately.

1

The author of the extract has a/an _____ tone while describing the interview.

Ans. ♦ neutral/balanced

♦ factual/objective

♦ matter-of-fact/unemotional

Accept any one correct response.

10. Answer ANY FIVE of the following six questions in about 40-50 words

5 × 2 = 10

Content - 1

→ Full credit for appropriate inclusion of all content asked for → Partial credit ½ for relevant but incomplete content

Expression - 1

→ Full credit for effective organisation → Partial credit ½ for some semblance of organisation of ideas

Deduct ½ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors).

(i) The author of 'Poets and Pancakes' is extremely observant of people and their behaviour. Support this statement with an example of a description he gives us about any one of the characters.

Ans. (Any one)

♦ The boy in the make-up department: the author realises that the make-up boy's frustration is directed towards a single person, how he might be entering his cabin because he thinks he doesn't do anything important

♦ Subbu: he traces his past and realises how his route to success may not have been easy, analyses that he is a social person who is welcoming, is unable to work independently, how he is able to be creative and describes his poetic abilities.

♦ The lawyer: analysing his character as someone who was neutral, reticent, cold

♦ The actress on set: her naivety while working on films, her temperament and an analysis of why she left films

(ii) Why does Sophie's father look at Sophie with disdain in the following scene from 'Going Places'?

"Sophie's met Danny Casey", Geoff said.

Ans. (Any one)

♦ Sophie's father is annoyed with her because he thinks that she makes up stories.

♦ He is irritated with her because she remains aloof from reality; he wants her to be practical and rooted in reality.

♦ He thinks lowly of Sophie because she always lies about things.

(iii) In the poem 'Aunt Jennifer's Tigers', why does the poet describe the tigers as 'bright topaz denizens of a world of green'?

Ans. ♦ She describes the tigers in this manner to show them as strong characters who are not afraid to show themselves to the world.

♦ She uses this description which has imagery to help readers paint a vivid picture of tigers that are clearly visible against a green background.

♦ She describes the tigers this way to create a contrast later in the poem between the tigers and how the women of her time behave in a world of men.

(Accept any other valid response.)

(iv) What were some strategies that helped the narrator to overcome his fear of water that overcame any major fear? Explain any two.

(Deep Water)

Ans. (Any two)

- (Any two)
- ◆ He is aware of when he became fearful and the reason behind it. Awareness can be a good starting step.
 - ◆ He takes the help of a coach/expert to learn the skill. If we learn the skill and understand how to do something, it can help us overcome our fear.
 - ◆ He talks back to the voice of fear by challenging it. If we identify the voice in us and are able to challenge it, we can stop fearing that thing.
 - ◆ He overcame his fear in bits and pieces by exposing himself to one thing at a time. If we break down the big fear into small tasks that we need to do/overcome, we can tackle fear in a systematic way.

(v) *A crisis brings out our true capacity for compassion and kindness.*
Support the above statement using M. Hamel from 'The Last Lesson' as an example. State any one detail from the text to support Hamel's compassion. (Any one):

Ans. The crisis of losing France to the Prussians brings out M Hamel's compassion. (Any one):

- ◆ He stops being strict and talks to all the students in his class in a gentle and understanding manner.
- ◆ He does not use the ruler in class to beat the students, but tries to impart as much knowledge as he can in the last lesson.
- ◆ He admits his own fault in why many students never learnt the language and feels apologetic for the choices he made as a teacher.
- ◆ He does not berate Franz when Franz is unable to recite in French. Instead, he understands why Franz is behind due to his family's limitations and being given chores by M Hamel.
- ◆ M. Hamel delivers the last lesson with patience that generates a lot of interest. He speaks about everything that he knows about the French language.
- ◆ M. Hamel chokes up by the end of the lesson and is unable to speak. He fixes his eyes on everyone in the class in an extremely sentimental and with a kind gaze.

(vi) Imagine that John Keats meets someone who is feeling sad. What advice would he give to such a person? State any one of beauty from 'A Thing of Beauty' and relate the advice to it.

Ans. (Any one)

- ◆ **Beauty is immortal:** There will always be beauty to find no matter what day and age we live in. You can find beauty in day and age too, which could give you happiness.
- ◆ **Beauty keeps giving:** Beauty's loveliness always increases. So invest in something (whether time or money) that you find beautiful and it will always give you returns in terms of joy.
- ◆ **Beauty can be found in many things:** Nature has a lot of beauty that it offers us. Spend time in a garden or a green place to observe and experience beauty. That would bring you peace and joy.
- ◆ **Beauty gives us joy:** It is a joy forever, so connect with beauty or try to find it in whatever situation you are. It is beautiful because it can change your mood from sad to happy.

11. Answer ANY TWO of the following three question, in about 40-50 words.

2x

Content - 1

→ Full credit for appropriate inclusion of all content asked for → Partial credit ½ for relevant but incomplete content

Expression - 1

→ Full credit for effective organisation → Partial credit $\frac{1}{2}$ for some semblance of organisation of ideas
 deduct $\frac{1}{2}$ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than 10%)

Deduct ½ mark from the overall score if the error density is high (more than a total of 2 spellings and/or grammatical errors).

(i) In the story, 'On the Face of It', what brings Derry and Mr Lamb together as friends? What can you conclude about friends from this?

Ans. (Any one)

- ◆ They talk about their personal experience of being bothered/bullied for something they have that is considered ugly in society. Therefore, having a common experience that feels unique to us can build a friendship.
- ◆ They share their philosophy about life and how people behave with each other. While their perspectives do not always match, talking about beliefs itself is something that can bring people closer.
- ◆ They challenge each other and do not behave in a polite manner with each other. Being who we really are and saying what we feel can build meaningful connections.

- (ii) How would a student's learning experience be enhanced in the 'Students on Ice' programme as compared to studying only in a classroom? Analyse any one point.

(Journey to the End of the Earth)

Ans. Accept any one relevant contrast.

- ♦ Students would see and experience the actual implications of human activity on the environment rather than just reading about it. It would make students more motivated to act responsibly.
- ♦ Students would have a life-changing experience at an unusual place like Antarctica which might make information and learning more memorable.

- (iii) With reference to 'The Enemy', describe any two ways in which Sadao's father influenced Sadao's life.

Ans. (Any two)

- ♦ Sadao's father was a proud Japanese citizen. This also made Sadao a loyal patriot of his own country.
- ♦ Sadao's father maintained that one's future is in one's own hands. This pushed Sadao to become a very accomplished medical practitioner.
- ♦ Sadao's father sent him to America to study medicine and surgery, and Sadao became a brilliant doctor as a result of that.
- ♦ Sadao's father was particular about his race. This influenced Sadao's decision to fall in love with Hana. He also only married her after his father blessed the union.
- ♦ Sadao's father had high expectations. In trying to meet those expectations, Sadao became a very accomplished doctor and a principled person.

12. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions in about 120-150 words.

5

Content - 2

- Full credit for sustained, clear, well-developed personal response to the task that appropriately justifies any arguments
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the response clarity and relevance

Expression - 2

- Full credit for effective organisation -structure, relevant vocabulary and effective relay of ideas
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the level of coherence and cohesion

Accuracy - 1

- Full credit for none to minimal errors → Partial credit of ½ for spellings and/or grammatical, largely accurate
- No credit for error density causing impediment in understanding

- (A) Imagine that Mahatma Gandhi from the text 'Indigo' visits Mukesh's town Firozabad as described in 'Lost Spring'. Gandhi sees how the poor bangle-makers are caught up in 'a vicious circle of the sahu-kars, the middlemen, the policemen, the keepers of law, the bureaucrats and the politicians.' True to his nature of being an activist and a social reformist, he decides to do something about it over a month.

As Mukesh, write a diary entry on the last day of Gandhi's one-month stay, elaborating on any two things that he did that transformed the people's lives in Firozabad.

You may begin this way:

Dear Diary,

Today marks a month of Mahatma Gandhi being in our town...

Ans. Suggested response:

Dear Diary,

Today marks a month of Mahatma Gandhi being in our town. I remember his first day. As soon as he had entered, he started talking to the people. He asked questions about the kind of wages we earn and what the authorities have done about our living conditions. Thereafter, he went to the local police station and the district court. Finally, he got a policy put in place to ensure a minimum basic wage for our work. Our families now earn enough to not only make ends meet, but also save money at the end of every month. Most of the families now have a permanent shelter.

We used to struggle for basic needs, but now, we can dream bigger. Maybe I will finally learn to drive a car, and one day, own a car too.

(Accept any other valid response.)

- (B) Observe the following lines from two different poems.

(Aunt Jennifer's Tigers)

*When Aunt is dead, her terrified hands will lie
Still ringed with ordeals she was mastered by.*

(The Roadside Stand)

*I can't help owning the great relief it would be
To put these people at one stroke out of their pain.*

There are many commonalities between the two poems. Imagine that you are interviewing Adrienne Rich and Robert Frost together. Ask them any two questions that would highlight two points of similarity between their poems, and create responses to each.

You may begin this way:

Interviewer:

Rich:

Frost:

Ans. Suggested response:

Interviewer: Thank you for joining us, Adrienne Rich and Robert Frost. My first question to both of you is – What are the central themes of your poems?

Rich: My poem highlights the oppression that women face at the hands of men, particularly as wives to their husbands. Women's freedom and rights are a social issue.

Frost: Yes, my poem is also centered on a social issue. It talks about the oppression of the country folk. They remain oppressed because of the privileged city folk's ignorance. Interviewer: Thank you for sharing. My next question is – What solutions do you both propose in your poems?

Rich: Well, I don't have a solution. I think women will die being oppressed. Men have been, and always will be, in the upper hand.

Frost: I agree. In my poem too, I state that the country folk would be at peace if they died. The city folk will always be in the upper hand. I, like Adrienne, don't have any hope for change.

(Accept any other valid response.)

13. Answer ANY ONE of the following two questions, in about 120-150 words.

Content - 2

- Full credit for sustained, clear, well-developed personal response to the task that appropriately justifies any arguments
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the response clarity and relevance

Expression - 2

- Full credit for effective organisation -structure, relevant vocabulary and effective relay of ideas
- Partial credit of 1 ½, 1 and ½ as per the level of coherence and cohesion

Accuracy - 1

- Full credit for none to minimal errors → Partial credit of ½ for spellings and/or grammatical, largely accurate
- No credit for error density causing impediment in understanding

- (A) Recall the story 'We too are Human Beings' from the text 'Memories of Childhood'. Imagine that Bama stops the man who was carrying the packet of vadais, and strikes up a conversation with him. She asks him a couple of questions. You may follow the given format and include the two questions in your conversation.
- Bama: Hi sir, I noticed that you were carrying that packet in a funny manner. Why were you doing so?
- Elderly man: ...

Bama: But that's terrible. How does that make you feel?

Ans. Suggested response:

Bama: Hi sir, I noticed that you were carrying that packet in a funny manner. Why were you doing so?

Elderly man: That may have looked funny to you, but I didn't really have a choice. People in our community often don't give us many choices. We belong to a caste whose people are considered 'untouchable'. The people of higher castes look at us as if we are polluted people. So, anything we touch also becomes 'polluted'. I was carrying the vadai packet by the string so that I don't pollute it with my touch.

Bama: But that's terrible. How does that make you feel?

Elderly man: Well, this has been my life since I was born. I do not know anything else. Yet, every time this happens, I feel deeply humiliated. I am made to feel small and I am rejected for something I cannot change. I hope things will be different when you are my age.

(Accept any other valid response.)

OR

- (B) The king in the story 'The Tiger King' was driven by the single purpose of staying alive based on the prophecy that the hundredth tiger would kill him. He hunted tigers out of fear.

Imagine that you are living in the King's times, and he has killed seventy tigers at this point. As someone who cares about animal welfare, write a letter to the king convincing him to stop hunting tigers.

You may begin this way:

My sincerest greetings to his majesty,

I am Rajan, a subject of your kingdom, and I am writing to you today because...

Ans. Suggested response:

My sincerest greetings to his majesty,

I am Rajan, a subject of your kingdom, and I am writing to you today because your relentless killing of tigers in our forest has pained me deeply. Animals feel pain and have a right to live just like you and I do, your majesty. God has created us as equals, so how can one species kill another for no real scientific reason?

I know that you have been doing this because of the astrologer's prophecy. However, I urge you to look to your rational side that had claimed, as an infant, that everyone must die one day. I must ask you this, then: does it matter how we die? If we must all meet our end one day, wouldn't you rather enjoy the time you have on earth, live meaningfully and compassionately instead of worrying about a future where you are dead?

I hope that you will, as our king, do right by all living creatures.

Your loyal subject,

Rajan

(Accept any other valid response.)



SECTION-A: READING SKILLS

Literary Passage **Case-Based Factual Passage**

CBSE Marking Scheme:

1 M (or 2 M) for a relevant answer

READING COMPREHENSION

1

Preview

Steps to attempt Reading Comprehension

1. **Quick Overview:** Start by quickly going through the passage to grasp the main idea. This will help in understanding the context.
2. **Read Questions first:** Look over the questions before you read in detail. This way, you know what information to focus on.
3. **Underline key points:** As you read, underline or highlight the main points or phrases. This will help when referring back for answers.
4. **Time Management:** Limit the time you spend on each passage and its set of questions. It's easy to get stuck on a difficult passage, but remember to move on and not waste too much time.
5. **Understanding Context:** Answers are often found within the context. If a specific line or word is difficult, read the sentences before and after for clarity.
6. **Word Meaning through Context:** If you come across an unfamiliar word, try to understand its meaning based on the context in which it's used.
7. **Answer in complete sentences:** Unless specified, answer in complete sentences using words or phrases from the passage.
8. **Be cautious with inferential questions:** Some questions might ask you to infer or deduce information. Be sure to base your inferences on information from the passage and not your personal knowledge.
9. **No personal opinions:** Stick to the information given in the passage. Your personal opinions or prior knowledge on the topic shouldn't influence your answers.
10. **Watch for tricky answers:** There might be options that seem correct but are slightly off in context or phrasing. Read all options before selecting your answer.
11. **Re-read if necessary:** If a particular section is complex or confusing, don't hesitate to re-read it for better understanding.
12. **Check Grammar and Spelling:** Ensure that your answers are grammatically correct, and watch out for spelling mistakes.
13. **Use process of elimination:** If you're unsure about a multiple-choice question, try eliminating the obviously incorrect answers first.
14. **Stay Calm and Composed:** If you find a passage challenging, stay calm. Panicking can disrupt your concentration. Take a few deep breaths and tackle the questions methodically.
15. **Review:** If time permits, go back and review your answers to ensure that you haven't missed out on anything and that all your responses align with the passage.

SOLVED EXAMPLE

Literary Passage

1. Read the following text.

- In the historically quiet town of Larksville, nestled between rolling hills and serene lakes, an unexpected and remarkable unfolded. On the morning of a chilly Tuesday in the heart of autumn, as golden leaves carpeted the town's cobblestone streets, the townsfolk awoke to an extraordinary sight. Every tree, from the towering oaks to the delicate cherry blossoms in the central park, was adorned with a shimmering, silvery fabric that glistened under the pale sunlight.
- From children on their way to school to the elderly on their morning walks, everyone paused, squinted, and gaped in amazement. The spectacle transformed the familiar central park into a place of enchantment. At first glance, many residents speculated that the town council had approved an avant-garde art installation overnight. Whispers and rumors spread, as curious onlookers gathered, trying to discern the artist behind the work.
- However, as Mrs. Lorna, a revered octogenarian and the oldest resident of Larksville, ambled closer with her walking stick to inspect, she released a soft, audible gasp, causing murmurs amongst the gathering crowd. The anticipation was palpable.
- It wasn't long before Jacob, a beloved local school teacher with a penchant for natural sciences, decided to gather samples. With a magnifying glass in one hand and a sample in another, he announced, "It's spider silk!" The realization met with astonishment and a few gasps. How could tiny spiders create something so vast and intricate in just a single night? The town's usual morning routines were disrupted, replaced by animated discussions and debates.
- By late afternoon, the spectacle had not only caught the town's interest but had also attracted the attention of the media. A news van, accompanied by scientists and nature enthusiasts, parked near the park's entrance. Among them was Dr. Amelia, a renowned arachnologist. As she addressed the growing crowd, she unveiled the rarity of the phenomenon. "This isn't just a spider's handiwork. The scale and intricacy suggest a harmonious effort by thousands, if not more." She pondered aloud the possibility of an undiscovered species being the genius behind the silk marvel.
- As dusk approached, the park, which usually saw a handful of visitors, was abuzz with activity. Children watched with wide-eyed wonder, artists tried to capture the beauty on their canvases, and many simply sat, taking in the unexpected beauty. Larksville's once-overlooked central park had now become a place of marvel, with its trees standing tall, draped in their own artwork, drawing admirers from far and wide.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) What emotion did the townsfolk of Larksville feel upon seeing the transformed park?

- (a) Bewilderment
(b) Indifference
(c) Curiosity and amazement
(d) Anger

Ans. (c) Curiosity and amazement

- (ii) Explain in about 40 words how the phenomenon impacted the daily routines of Larksville's residents.

Ans. The unprecedented phenomenon in Larksville's central park disrupted the town's usual routines. Instead of their regular activities, residents were drawn to the park, captivated by its transformed beauty. Animated discussions, shared speculations, and a collective sense of wonder became the order of the day, overshadowing their usual mundane tasks.

- (iii) Describe in about 40 words Dr. Amelia's contribution to the understanding of the remarkable event.

Ans. Dr. Amelia, an esteemed arachnologist, shed light on the unusual phenomenon. She highlighted the possibility that the shimmering fabric behind the shimmering fabric could be a yet-to-be-discovered species. By linking the vast and intricate web to the collective knowledge of countless spiders, she added depth to the understanding of the extraordinary occurrence.

- (iv) Why did Mrs. Lorna's reaction to the shimmering fabric on the trees draw attention?

- (a) She was the town's mayor.
(b) She was the oldest resident.
(c) She was a known artist.
(d) She was Dr. Amelia's assistant.

Ans. (b) She was the oldest resident.

- (v) How did Jacob come to his conclusion about the nature of the shimmering fabric?

- (a) He used a microscope.
(b) He took a sample to the lab.
(c) He used a magnifying glass.
(d) He conducted an online research.

Ans. (c) He used a magnifying glass.

- (vi) Describe in about 40 words the collective reaction of Larksville's residents to the unexpected transformation of the park. 2
- Ans. The Larksville residents were collectively captivated by the park's transformation. What was once a familiar setting became a source of wonder and intrigue. From children to elders, all were drawn to the spectacle, sharing speculations, marveling at the beauty, and engaging in animated discussions, making it a communal experience of amazement.
- (vii) Which term best describes the nature of the spiders' work on the trees? 1
- (a) Simple (b) Harsh
(c) Intricate (d) Crude
- Ans. (c) Intricate
- (viii) In what way did the event alter the general perception of Larksville's central park? 1
- (a) It became a feared place. (b) It was considered for demolition.
(c) It transformed into a place of marvel. (d) It was avoided by the residents.
- Ans. (c) It transformed into a place of marvel.
- (ix) Based on the events in the passage, which of the following headlines would be most accurate? 1
- (a) Larksville invaded by mysterious creatures (b) Residents of larksville fear mysterious silvery web
(c) Larksville's park transformed by spider artistry (d) New art exhibit unveiled in larksville park
- Ans. (c) Larksville's park transformed by spider artistry.

Case Based Factual Passage

I. Read the following text.

(10 m)

- Over the last decade, online shopping has seen tremendous growth among middle-aged people in the UK. A survey conducted among individuals aged 35-50 aimed to understand the reasons behind their online shopping habits and documented the percentage variation for 10 driving factors influencing their purchase decisions.
- For those preferring online shopping, the most common motivation was the convenience of shopping anytime and anywhere (62%). This was followed by the vast variety and choices available online (56%). Additionally, the ability to compare prices easily (48%) and access to exclusive online deals (42%) were also popular reasons.
- In contrast, individuals who preferred in-store shopping often cited the ability to physically examine products (65%) as the chief reason. Shopping in-store also gave a sensory experience, allowing one to feel, smell or try products (55%), and the instant gratification of taking home purchases immediately (50%). Furthermore, in-store shoppers valued the personal interaction with salespeople and getting advice (45%).
- Interestingly, both groups showed nearly equal interest in sustainable and eco-friendly shopping (40% for online shoppers, 39% for in-store shoppers). Also, both categories cherished the idea of supporting local businesses (38% for online shoppers, 37% for in-store shoppers).
- However, some differences were evident. Online shoppers leaned more towards hassle-free return policies (50%) compared to in-store shoppers (32%). On the other hand, in-store shoppers placed a higher value on a memorable shopping experience (44%) compared to online shoppers (28%).
- In conclusion, the survey indicates that both online and in-store shopping methods cater to different needs and preferences, resonating differently among the middle-aged populace in the UK.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Why might businesses benefit from the survey mentioned in the first paragraph? Provide two reasons. Answer in about 40 words. 2

Ans. The survey can help businesses understand consumer preferences, enabling them to tailor their services accordingly. It can also guide marketing strategies, targeting the specific needs of the age group surveyed.

- (ii) Which factor would make businesses offer tactile experiences in their physical stores? 1

- (a) Convenience of shopping (b) Access to exclusive deals
(c) Ability to physically examine products (d) Hassle-free return policies

Ans. (c) Ability to physically examine products

- (iii) What are the leading motivations for individuals choosing online shopping? 1

Ans. The leading motivations are the convenience of shopping anytime, anywhere, and the vast variety and choices available online.

- (iv) Identify the in-store shopper from the following:
- (a) Jane - "I enjoy flash sales online at midnight."
 - (b) Martin - "It's important for me to touch and feel a product before buying."
 - (c) Lucy - "I love availing online discount codes."

Ans. (b) Martin

- (v) Which of the following aligns with the sensory experience of in-store shopping?

- (a) Clicking on product reviews
- (b) Trying on a dress
- (c) Getting email notifications
- (d) Adding products to the online cart

Ans. (b) Trying on a dress

- (vi) How might the difference in the importance of return policies between online and in-store shoppers influence the services of businesses?

Ans. Recognizing this difference, online businesses might emphasize and promote hassle-free return policies to attract customers. In contrast, physical stores might focus more on providing an enriching shopping experience to ensure immediate satisfaction and reduce returns.

- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.

The nearly equal interest in sustainable shopping between both groups suggests that _____.

Ans. environmental consciousness and ethical shopping are significant priorities for the middle-aged demographic in the UK.

- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE.

The title, "Digital vs. Physical: Shopping Preferences of the UK Middle-Aged Demographic", is fitting for this passage.

Ans. TRUE

MISCELLANEOUS EXERCISE

Literary Passage

Passage-I

Read the following text.

(12 m)

1. In today's digital age, technology and social media have become an integral part of our daily lives. From the moment we wake up to the time we go to bed, we are constantly connected to our devices, scrolling through news feeds, liking posts, and sharing our thoughts and experiences with the world. It's a fascinating and sometimes overwhelming phenomenon that has completely transformed the way we communicate, interact, and perceive the world around us.
2. While technology and social media have undoubtedly brought numerous benefits, they also come with their fair share of drawbacks. On one hand, they have made it easier for us to connect with friends and family across the globe, share information instantly, and discover new ideas and perspectives. On the other hand, they have created a culture of constant comparison, fueled by the pressure to present a curated version of ourselves online. The quest for likes and validation can sometimes overshadow genuine connections and lead to feelings of inadequacy and loneliness.

3. In the realm of social media, everyone seems to be living their best lives, showcasing only the highlights and accomplishments. It's easy to fall into the trap of believing that everyone else has it all figured out, while we struggle with our own insecurities and challenges. We must remind ourselves that social media is a carefully crafted narrative, often leaving out the messy and imperfect moments that make us human. It's essential to cultivate a healthy balance between our online and offline lives, focusing on genuine connections and self-care.
4. Despite its pitfalls, technology and social media have also provided us with unprecedented opportunities for connection and collaboration. They have become powerful tools for social activism, allowing us to raise awareness about important social issues, mobilize communities, and effect positive change. From viral campaigns to fundraising efforts, the digital world has become a platform for amplifying voices and fostering meaningful dialogue across borders and cultures.
5. With the constant influx of information and the addictive nature of social media, it's crucial to prioritize our digital wellbeing. Setting boundaries, taking breaks from screens, and engaging in activities that nourish our minds and bodies are essential for maintaining a healthy relationship with technology. By being mindful of our online habits and consciously choosing how we engage with social media, we can create a more balanced and fulfilling digital experience.

6. In conclusion, technology and social media have revolutionized the way we connect, communicate, and navigate the world. They have opened up new opportunities for growth and connection, but also present challenges in terms of self-image and mental well-being. It's up to us to harness the power of technology while being mindful of its impact on our lives. By finding a healthy balance and using these tools consciously, we can make the most of the digital age and create a more connected and authentic world.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) In the digital age, technology and social media have predominantly affected which aspect of our daily lives? **1**
 - (a) Cooking
 - (b) Communication and interaction
 - (c) Gardening
 - (d) Travelling
- (ii) Which of the following is NOT mentioned as a benefit of technology and social media? **1**
 - (a) Connecting with distant friends and family.
 - (b) Immediate information sharing.
 - (c) Getting more sleep.
 - (d) Discovering new perspectives.
- (iii) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words, to highlight the downside of presenting only the best parts of our lives on social media. **2**
- (iv) Based on the information given in the passage, the digital world has served as a platform for _____. **1**
 - (a) Only showcasing personal achievements
 - (b) Amplifying voices and meaningful dialogue
 - (c) Promoting products
 - (d) Gaming
- (v) Which of these options best interprets the author's sentiment about the constant quest for online validation? **1**
 - (a) It is necessary for personal growth.
 - (b) It's harmless fun.
 - (c) It can lead to feelings of loneliness.
 - (d) It is the main reason for using social media.
- (vi) Why is it necessary to strike a balance between our online and offline lives? Answer in about 40 words. **2**
- (vii) In the passage, what does the term "digital well-being" refer to? **1**
 - (a) Repairing broken devices
 - (b) Health of digital devices
 - (c) Prioritizing our mental health in the digital realm
 - (d) Buying new devices
- (viii) How does the author suggest maintaining a healthy relationship with technology? Provide a response in about 40 words. **2**

- (ix) Identify the statement that DOES NOT align with the sentiments expressed in the passage: **1**
 - (a) Social media is a platform for genuine connection.
 - (b) Everyone has a perfect life as seen on social media.
 - (c) We must consciously decide how to engage with social media.
 - (d) Technology primarily causes negative impacts on our lives.

Passage-II

Read the passage given below:

(10 m)

1. When we think of the game of cricket, we come to the conclusion that it is primarily a game that depends on outstanding physical activities, good hand-eye co-ordination, speed, skill and strength. It provides entertainment and generates strong feelings of excitement. A good match of cricket or of any other game neither adds to the existing stock of human knowledge nor reveals any secret of existence. It does not carry any deep meaning but most people, particularly the lover of sports attach deep emotions and numerous meanings to it. Games are thought of as a metaphor for life. They are supposed to teach many lessons. In fact, more is said and written about a cricket match than about scientific findings or great philosophy.
2. This is because games, like a morality play, in which settings and rules are made by us, can easily make people test their fair and foul conduct, principles of reward and punishment, and emotions of joy and disappointment. They can make us experience the thrill of war without exposing us to its dangers. A man watching a cricket match on T.V. and munching popcorn is like a surrogate warrior. In fact, games provide us with a safe outlet for our aggressiveness. If games become aggressive, they lose the very purpose of providing entertainment and purging us of our aggressiveness. They can calm our impatience without creating any conflict.
3. Commentators, journalists, politicians and analysts can do a great favour to the competing teams by keeping the excitement within limits. The teams should play without being dominated by feelings of national honour and shame. Excellent performance of the players of both teams should be enjoyed and appreciated. Winning or losing in a game should not be taken seriously. A game is fun if it is played with true spirit of sportsmanship. **(CBSE, 2023)**

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below: **10 × 1 = 10**

- (i) Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate option:
Most people conclude that cricket is primarily a game because _____.
 - (a) it is played as a match
 - (b) it requires two teams
 - (c) it includes physical activity
 - (d) it depends only on skill and strength
- (ii) Comment on the writer's reference to that cricket does not reveal any secret of existence.

(iii) List two responses which watching a game of cricket gives rise to.

(iv) Select the option that conveys the opposite of 'destroy' from words used in the passage.

- (a) reveals (b) experience
(c) generate (d) purging

(v) The writer would not agree with the given statements based on paragraph 2, EXCEPT

- (a) Rules of any game are made by people.
(b) Watching a cricket match makes the viewer believe that he is fighting a battle?
(c) It is necessary for a game to be aggressive in order to build excitement.
(d) A game can test people's sense of fair judgement.

(vi) With reference to the passage, a spectator is compared to a 'surrogate warrior'.

Choose the option that best describes this phrase:

- (a) a spectator who is paid to watch.
(b) a spectator who is in pain while watching the match.
(c) a spectator who enjoys the match as an armchair soldier.
(d) a spectator who makes judgement about reward and punishment.

(vii) Why does the writer compare games to a morality play?

(viii) Complete the given sentence with an appropriate inference with respect to the following:

The writer says that games can calm our impatience without creating any conflict by _____.

(ix) The writer advises the players that games should not become aggressive because _____.

(x) Select the most suitable title for the above passage.

- (a) Excellent Performance by Cricketers
(b) The Benefits of Playing Cricket
(c) Cricket – The King of Games
(d) The True Spirit of Playing Games

Passage-III

Read the following text.

(12 m)

At the observatory on top of Mount Stellar, things were going haywire. Scientists were scurrying around as their instruments gave readings they had never seen before. A comet, previously unknown, was headed straight for Earth.

A young scientist named Neil looked at the screen and sighed, "Another day at the office, huh?" He turned to his colleague, Priya, who was frantically taking notes. "Any idea what this one's made of?" he asked.

Priya shook her head, "Not yet, but it's not any ordinary comet. It's changing directions in ways comets shouldn't."

Just then, the observatory's AI, named Orion, chimed in, "It appears to be responding to our signals." This made everyone stop in their tracks. Comets, after all, don't typically respond to signals.

Neil approached the main control and said, "Orion, communicating with it."

The AI complied, sending a series of complex mathematical equations. To everyone's surprise, they got a response: Earthlings. No need for alarm. Just passing by."

Neil was dumbfounded. "A sentient comet?!"

Priya, ever the curious one, asked, "Who are you?"

The comet responded, "I'm not a comet. I'm a celestial traveler. My name is Cosmo. I travel galaxies to observe. Your sun is interesting."

Neil tried to grasp the reality of the situation. "So, you're...?" Cosmo replied, "In a manner of speaking, yes."

The entire observatory buzzed with excitement. A celestial traveler was a groundbreaking discovery. The world needed to know. But first, the scientists had questions, lots of them.

As the day progressed, Cosmo shared stories of galaxies far away, of stars that sang, and of black holes that whispered secrets. It was a lot for Neil and Priya to take in, but they were up to the challenge.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

(i) At the beginning of the passage, why were the scientists at Mount Stellar observatory alarmed?

- (a) They detected an alien spaceship.
(b) Their instruments were malfunctioning.
(c) A previously unknown comet was heading for Earth.
(d) The observatory was about to close down.

(ii) How did the comet differentiate itself from other comets?

- (a) By its size and color
(b) By its ability to communicate
(c) By its speed
(d) By its tail

(iii) Based on the given passage, elaborate on the humor intended by the writer when Neil observes the approaching comet. Answer in about 40 words.

(iv) What is Orion's main function in the observatory?

- (a) A guard robot
(b) A maintenance machine
(c) A research assistant
(d) An advanced AI for communication

(v) The phrase "celestial traveler" implies that Cosmo is _____.

- (a) A well-known comet
(b) An astronaut from another planet
(c) An entity travelling through space for observation
(d) A messenger from a distant galaxy

(vi) Explain in about 40 words why the discovery of Cosmo is significant for the scientists.

(vii) What emotion best describes the scientists' initial reaction to the comet's unusual behaviour?

- (a) Indifference (b) Panic
(c) Curiosity (d) Anger

- (viii) Why did Neil and Priya find it challenging to understand Cosmo's stories? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (ix) Which of the following headlines best summarizes the events of the passage? 1
- Alien Spaceship Threatens Earth
 - Scientists Discover Sentient Comet
 - Observatory Reveals New Stars
 - The Secret Language Of Comets Unveiled
 - Neil And Priya: The Heroes Of Mount Stellar

Passage-IV

Read the passage given below:

(10 m)

- I know many friends of mine who drink coffee regularly but do not know that coffee exists in different forms other than instant coffee. There are many who swear by Flora cafe classic or Coco gold, which they consider as premium coffee. I may sound offensive but instant coffee is not the only way; in fact it's a very bad way of making coffee! Instant coffee cannot match up to brewed coffee's flavour nor does it have Arabica beans. It uses Robusta beans that are lower in flavour. Don't know the difference? ! Read on...
- That plant might be a genius! It created a chemical that would keep pests away. Fortunately for us and unfortunately for the plant - that plan did not work the way it was intended to. The chemical might have averted a few pest attacks, but attracted a far greater threat - human beings. The plant I am talking about is coffee and the chemical is caffeine.
- To begin from the beginning - coffee is from a more mature part of the tree - the seed - unlike other stimulants. The ripe berry is picked and de-pulped leaving us with a seed called 'green bean' or 'green coffee'. Green bean is uncharacteristically bland with a taste nowhere close to that of coffee, but it is valued for its higher antioxidant levels.
- It's an interesting phenomenon to see how this bland green bean turns to a flavourful coffee bean. Coffee bean is a seed and like any other seed, it is rich in proteins, fats and all necessary ingredients for giving birth to a new plant. When exposed to heat, the fats and carbohydrates in the bean turn into essential oils, which give the characteristic taste and aroma to the coffee bean. The degree of roasting depends on the need or purpose of use.
- These beans are ground so that the surface area of the bean is increased, which makes extraction easier. The bean can be ground or crushed but making the particles uniform will ensure equal extraction, or else the smaller particle will get over extracted and the larger one under extracted. Hence, the burr grinder is used to ensure that the coffee bean gets ground in a uniform way in which all particles are of similar sizes.
- Does under extraction give a lighter coffee and over extraction a stronger one? No. For a lighter or stronger coffee less or more coffee powder has to be used. Why? Under extraction will not get all the flavours of the coffee as the water runs too quickly. It will not get what you want - it will taste sour. Over extraction will bring out all unnecessary flavours rendering the taste bitter.

(CBSE, 2023)

On the basis of your understanding of the above passage, answer the questions given below: 10 × 1 = 10

- Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate option:
The author complained that his friends _____.
 - consumed only Flora classics
 - were not aware of different forms of coffee
 - were severely addicted to drinking coffee
 - considered Coco gold as premium coffee
- Comment on the writer's reference to the unique feature of coffee plant. (Paragraph 2)
- List the reason why the author refers to humans as 'great threat to coffee' plants.
- Select an option that conveys the same meaning as 'energiser' from words used in Paragraph 3.
 - bland
 - mature
 - antioxidant
 - stimulants
- Complete the given sentence with an appropriate inference with respect to the following:
Fats and carbohydrates turn into essential oils leading to _____.
- Comment on the writer's reference to the interesting phenomenon in paragraph 4.
- Over extraction does not give a stronger coffee. Based on your understanding of paragraph 6, list one method to get stronger coffee.
- The writer would not agree with the given statements based on paragraph five EXCEPT.
 - The burr grinder grinds coffee beans uniformly.
 - Less surface area makes extraction easier.
 - Grinding gives stronger aroma.
 - Good coffee is a mix of smaller and bigger particles.
- Why is it fair to say that the right degree of extraction of coffee is important?
- Select the most suitable title of the above passage.
 - The Art of Coffee Making
 - Benefits of Consuming Coffee
 - Green Coffee - The perfect antioxidant
 - The Coffee Addict

Passage-V

Read the following text.

(12 m)

- If you enjoy watching crime shows on TV, you know that fingerprints play a large role in identifying people. But you might be surprised to find out that using fingerprints for identification is not a new science. In fact, it is very old - dating back at least as far as 1885-1913 B.C.E. In Babylon, when people agreed to a business contract, they pressed their fingerprints into the clay in which the contract was written. Thumbprints have also been found on clay seals from ancient China.

2. In 14th century Persia, which is now Iran, a government doctor recognized that all fingerprints are different. In 1684, a British doctor, Nehemiah Grew, spoke about the ridged surfaces of the fingers. In 1686, a professor of anatomy (the study of the structure of the human body) named Marcello Malpighi, wrote about the ridges and loops in fingerprints. Malpighi's work was considered so important that a layer of skin found on the fingertips was named after him. This layer of skin is called the Malpighian layer. Although scientists had studied fingerprints, the value of fingerprinting in the identification of individuals did not become clear until later.
3. Sir William James Herschel is generally thought to be the first European to realize that fingerprints were unique to each person. In his work as chief magistrate in the Hoogly district in Jungipoor, India, Herschel asked people to put their handprints on contracts. Herschel believed that personal contact with the contracts made people more likely to honor their commitments, or to keep their promises. As he looked at more and more handprints, he began to see that all the handprints were different. He started to believe that fingerprints were unique, which means they are all different from each other, and permanent, which means that they do not ever change. To prove that they never change, Herschel kept track of his own fingerprints over his entire lifetime.
4. Dr. Henry Faulds, a British surgeon at a Japanese hospital, began studying the furrows (also called ridges) on fingertips in the 1870s. He published an article in a scientific journal about the use of fingerprints as a tool in identification. He also devised, or invented, a system of classifying fingerprints. He wrote Charles Darwin about his findings, but Darwin was getting too old to work on the findings. So, he promised to pass the information to his cousin, Sir Francis Galton. Using Henry Faulds' findings, Galton published a major book on classifying fingerprints based on arches, loops, and whorls. His work with Sir Edward R. Henry on fingerprint classification was the basis of a classification system which is still used by law enforcement agencies in English-speaking countries.
5. The Federal Bureau of Investigation (FBI) now uses a variation of the Galton- Henry system. Although the use of fingerprinting in identification originated in Britain, it has been developed in the United States. In 1924, two large fingerprint collections were combined to form the foundation of the Identification Division of the FBI. Within the Identification Division, the Integrated Automated Fingerprint Identification Systems (IAFIS) can search and find fingerprints anywhere in the United States within thirty minutes. The IAFIS can compare results with automated fingerprint systems in countries around the world. The IAFIS has the fingerprints of more than 250 million people on file.
6. About one in six Americans has fingerprints on file with the FBI. But not all the fingerprints are related to criminal investigations. People need to have their fingerprints taken for many other reasons. People have their fingerprints taken for employment, licenses, and adoption. For example, when people want to work for the government in classified, secret jobs, their fingerprints are checked to be sure they do not have a criminal background. When prospective parents adopt a child, their fingerprints are matched against those of all criminals for the safety of the child.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) Which statement accurately describes the historical use of fingerprints?
 - (a) Only used in Persia for identification.
 - (b) Modern science introduced by crime shows.
 - (c) Used in ancient Babylon for business contracts.
 - (d) Commonly used in everyday transactions in ancient China.
- (ii) In approximately 40 words, describe the key contribution of Dr. Henry Faulds to the study of fingerprints.
- (iii) Based on Sir William James Herschel's observations, can deduce that fingerprints are _____.
- (iv) What is the implied meaning of the statement, "To prove that they never change, Herschel kept track of his own fingerprints over his entire lifetime"?
 - (a) Herschel was obsessive about his findings.
 - (b) Herschel wanted empirical evidence.
 - (c) Fingerprints change as you age.
 - (d) Herschel had doubts about his theory.
- (v) Why is the Galton-Henry system significant in the context of this passage? Answer in about 40 words.
- (vi) In the context of the passage, what does the term "latent" stand for?
- (vii) Describe the capabilities of IAFIS as mentioned in the passage, in about 40 words.
- (viii) Identify the statement/s that accurately represent the reasons for fingerprinting in the U.S.:
 - (a) Solely for criminal investigations
 - (b) For employment, licenses, and adoption
 - (c) Only when traveling internationally
 - (d) To ensure people pay taxes
- (ix) Why might prospective parents need to have their fingerprints checked during the adoption process?
 - (a) To check financial stability
 - (b) To ensure they don't have a criminal background for the child's safety
 - (c) To confirm their marital status
 - (d) To evaluate parenting skills

Passage-VI

Read the following text.

1. Have you ever caught yourself scratching your ear, twitching your ear, tapping your foot or playing with your keys or pen? If you have, you are a sure fidgeter. And it is very likely that the habit has carried over from childhood when your wriggling probably exasperated—and sometimes amused—your parents and teachers. It is not a pleasant sight to see a grown-up person fidgeting; in fact, it is a distraction. Only recently, some doctors in Britain have discovered that only is fidgeting quite normal, it even does you good.

3. Almost everybody fidgets when hot, cold, hungry, thirsty or tired. Being kept waiting also brings us to fidgets. Most of this is normal but then with some this translates into exaggerated mannerisms, that is where we have a problem. When the British doctors wired up volunteers to an electric 'fidgetmeter', followed by a gruelling interview, some stayed almost completely still. Others made up to 57 movements in half a minute. Since the rate went up when disturbing topics were raised, it seemed that those who fidgeted more were the anxious types, needing to release nervous energy.
4. This is what led to the conclusion that fidgeting has its uses too—since it helps get rid of stress that could sometimes lead to headaches, muscle pain or even ulcers. Fidgeting is also believed to fight the flab. Add up all those little movements made by fidgeters during their waking hours and they burn up as much energy as a jog, the report said. While British doctors may feel that fidgeting is an expression of anxious behaviour, doctors here do not necessarily agree.
5. Meanwhile a former assistant professor in Los Angeles opines that fidgeting is a sign of "some underlying tension which is causing anxiety". While one cannot make generalised statements, some experts feel that pencil-suckers yearn for babyhood, teeth-grinders and fist clencher seem to be holding back their aggression, foot tappers wish to be on the move and people who scratch may wish to injure themselves.
6. A leading psychiatrist gives a positive side to the anxiety angle. According to him, "a bit of anxiety is not harmful since it induces one to do better. It often brings out the best in people—while meeting deadlines, submitting reports or at interviews and examinations." He gives the example of tennis players who play with "manageable anxiety", but warns that when the fidgets turn to restlessness, it might affect performance. Often, he says, a person suffering from a neurological illness ends up fidgeting deliberately, "mainly to distract his companion from his actual problem. It could be something as harmless as the shaking of the hand or twitching of the eye."
7. Refuting this, another psychiatrist insists that fidgeting in no way should be considered good. "It may be innocuous unless it is harming the fidgeter or annoying others, but, what fidgeting really reveals is a lack of confidence and even social phobia, besides, of course, anxiety. It, in fact, sends non-verbal messages to people who then treat the person accordingly — as nervous or anxious individuals," he adds. Unfortunately, fidgeters often find it hard to kick the habit, even when it's socially unacceptable.
8. While those fidgeting are themselves perturbed by the habit, efforts in controlling it could cause other problems, because, "the person could get hypertense or worried about being unable to tackle it and get more fidgety in the process." Experts, in the meantime, keep suggesting remedies or tricks to get out of fidgeting habits, like playing with a coin in your pocket or glove, or wearing a ring which you can rub without others noticing. In Greece, many taxi-drivers carry worry-beads which they click while waiting to combat fidgeting, while some stores in London's West End once sold pieces of polished stone designed for gently stroking with the thumb.

Dr James Buyers, a neurologist of London, hopes for a more lasting and practical solution. "Anything that will stop the speed of modern life for even half a minute will definitely be beneficial," he says.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) Read the four headlines (a)-(d), given below: 1
 - (a) The Curative Remedies for Fidgeting
 - (b) The Jury is Still Out on Fidgeting
 - (c) Tennis Players and Their Manageable Anxiety
 - (d) The Many Aspects of Fidgeting

Identify the option that displays the headline/s that DOES/DO correspond with occurrences in the passage.
- (ii) Explain, in about 40 words, some ways by which people who fidget can rid themselves of the habit with a lasting solution? 2
- (iii) Complete the sentence appropriately with a characteristic or its description. 1

Based on the information given in the excerpt, one can infer that the habit of fidgeting in a grown up person _____.
- (iv) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words to support the view that "a bit of anxiety is not harmful since it induces one to do better." 1
- (v) What are some commonalities noticed among various kinds of fidgeters? 1
 - (a) Pencil suckers
 - (b) Teeth grinder
 - (c) Foot tappers
 - (d) All of the above
- (vi) Select the option that is similar in meaning "When the British doctors wired up volunteers to an electric fidgetmeter", followed by a gruelling interview, some stayed almost completely still." 1
 - (a) He had complained of exhaustion after his gruelling schedule over the past week.
 - (b) They are always gruelling about everything.
 - (c) For many years he suffered the gruelling effects of cancer treatment.
 - (d) Both (a) and (b)
- (vii) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words to support the view "fidgeting has its uses too." 2
- (viii) What does Dr. James Buyers mean by "stopping the speed of modern life for even half a minute," and how does he believe it could bring about practical benefits? 2
- (ix) How does the author use the literary device of anecdotal examples to illustrate the concept of fidgeting and its development from childhood to adulthood? 1

Passage-VII

Read the following text.

(12 m)

Arthur lay in his cabin, still trying to piece together the events of the last few hours. He had watched his home planet of Earth be demolished to make way for a hyperspace bypass, been saved by his friend Ford, and then whisked away on a ship that was powered by an "infinite improbability drive."

It was all too much for him.

Just then, Ford stuck his head around the door.

"Hey, Earthman," he said, "come and have a look at this."

Arthur stumbled after him down a corridor and into the ship's control room. He gazed in amazement at the banks of controls and flashing lights. In the center of the room was a large console covered in buttons and switches, and in the middle of the console was a small, white mouse.

"What's that?" asked Arthur.

"That's the ship's computer," said Ford.

Arthur stared at the mouse. "That's a computer?" he said.

"Yup," said Ford. "Five-dimensional, biologically-based, super intelligent, and in the form of a white lab mouse. Pretty neat, huh?"

"I don't know," said Arthur. "I don't think I really understand anything anymore. Why is a mouse the ship's computer?"

"It's a long story," said Ford. "But the short version is that the mice built the Earth as a giant computer to figure out the Ultimate Question of Life, the Universe, and Everything. Then they ran out of money and had to destroy it to make way for a hyperspace bypass. So now they're using the Heart of Gold to finish the calculation."

Arthur was about to say something, but at that moment the ship's intercom crackled to life.

"Good evening, Heart of Gold," said a smooth, computerized voice. "This is Eddie, your shipboard computer. I'm feeling a bit depressed today. Would you like me to sing you a song?"

"Oh, not again," groaned Ford.

"Eddie, would you mind shutting up?" said Arthur.

Arthur sighed and leaned back against the console, trying to make sense of everything. But as he closed his eyes, he heard a voice inside his head.

"Hello?" it said.

Arthur jumped, startled. "Who's there?" he said.

"It's me," said the voice. "Marvin."

"Marvin?" said Arthur. "Who's Marvin?"

"The Paranoid Android," said the voice.

Arthur looked around, but he didn't see anyone. "Where are you?" he said.

"I'm down here," said the voice.

Arthur looked down and saw a small, metal figure shuffling across the floor. It was about three feet tall, with a round head and a body that looked like it had been cobbled together from spare parts. Its eyes were a dull red, and its voice was a monotone.

"I've been waiting for someone to talk to me for over two million years," said Marvin.

Adapted - An excerpt from "The Hitchhiker's Guide to the Galaxy" by Douglas Adams/444 words (CBSE SQP, 2023)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) Select the option that classifies Arthur's confusion about drastic events such as the destruction of his home planet and the introduction of new technologies, correctly. 1

- (a) Routine and boredom (b) Adventure and excitement
(c) Loss and change (d) Calm and relaxation

- (ii) What is the significance of the white lab mouse in the control room of the Heart of Gold spaceship?

- (a) It is the captain of the ship
(b) It serves as the ship's computer
(c) It is a pet of the crew
(d) It is used for scientific experiments

- (iii) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words to support the view that the writer's writing style is descriptive and humorous.

- (iv) Complete the sentence appropriately with a character or its description.

Based on the information given in the excerpt, one can say that the mice who built the Earth are _____

- (v) Select the option that is similar in meaning to the expression, "Pretty neat, huh?"

- (a) Easy, isn't it? (b) Could be worse, no?
(c) Impressive, yes? (d) Too difficult for you

- (vi) Explain, in about 40 words, why the name "The Paranoid Android" is considered ironic.

- (vii) In the line, "...a body that looked like it had been cobbled together from spare parts...", what comparison does the word "cobbled" refer to?

- (viii) How does the following, impact the reader, even though they know Marvin is just an android? "I've been waiting for someone to talk to me for over two million years," Marvin. Answer in about 40 words.

- (ix) Read the five headlines (a)-(e), given below:

- A. HUMANITY'S JOURNEY WITNESSED BY A DEPRESSED ROBOT
B. HITCHHIKING THROUGH SPACE: A COMEDY TAKE ON THE END OF THE WORLD
C. NEW STUDY FINDS ALIENS LIVING AMONGST US
D. GROUNDBREAKING TECHNOLOGY WILL SOON ENABLE TIME TRAVEL
E. INTERGALACTIC TRAVEL VIA NEW INFRASTRUCTURE IMPROBABILITY DRIVE

Identify the option that displays the headline/s that DO NOT correspond with occurrences in the passage.

- (a) Only A (b) B, C and D
(c) Only E (d) A and E

Passage-VIII

Read the following text.

1. During the tumultuous years of World War II, the world was gripped by a conflict that shaped the course of history. Countless lives were forever changed as nations clashed and ideologies clashed. In the midst of this chaos, stories of courage, sacrifice, and resilience emerged, painting a vivid picture of the human spirit in the face of adversity. From the battlefields to the home front, World War II became a crucible that tested the limits of humanity's capacity for good and evil.

2. The horrors of war are difficult to comprehend, but they are an integral part of understanding the impact of World War II. The relentless bombings, the brutal battles, and the atrocities committed against innocent civilians left scars that still resonate today. It was a time when ordinary people were forced to confront the darkest aspects of human nature, and the consequences were devastating. Yet, amidst the darkness, acts of heroism and compassion emerged, reminding us that even in the face of unimaginable cruelty, there is still hope for humanity.
3. World War II also gave birth to stories of resilience that continue to inspire generations. From the brave soldiers who fought on the front lines to the civilians who endured the hardships of rationing and uncertainty, the war brought out the best in people. These stories of ordinary individuals doing extraordinary things serve as a testament to the indomitable spirit of the human race. They remind us that even in the darkest times, there is always a glimmer of light that can guide us towards a better future.
4. While the battlefields were where the physical war was fought, the home front played a crucial role in supporting the war effort. Women stepped into traditionally male-dominated roles, factories churned out weapons and supplies, and communities rallied together to show their solidarity. The war became a catalyst for societal change, breaking down barriers and reshaping gender roles. It was a time of immense sacrifice and unity, as people from all walks of life came together for a common cause.
5. As we look back on World War II, it is essential to reflect on its lasting legacy. The war not only shaped the geopolitical landscape but also left an indelible mark on the collective consciousness of humanity. It serves as a reminder of the consequences of unchecked power, the importance of standing up for justice, and the resilience of the human spirit. By studying and understanding this period of history, we can strive to create a world where such conflicts are never repeated.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) What does the passage primarily focus on when discussing World War II? 1
 - (a) The war's impact on the geopolitical landscape
 - (b) The war's effect on the economies of nations
 - (c) The stories of courage, sacrifice, and resilience during the war
 - (d) The creation of new technological innovations during the war
- (ii) What emotion does the author aim to evoke by discussing the "horrors of war"? 1
 - (a) Joy and exhilaration
 - (b) Indifference and passivity
 - (c) Curiosity and wonder
 - (d) Compassion and understanding
- (iii) Describe the contrast presented in the passage about humanity's capacity during World War II. 2

- (iv) How did World War II influence societal norms, according to the passage? 1
 - (a) It led to a decrease in industrial production.
 - (b) It reaffirmed traditional gender roles.
 - (c) It acted as a catalyst for societal change, reshaping gender roles.
 - (d) It created disunity and chaos in societal structures.
- (v) Which phrase from the passage supports the idea that ordinary people played a significant role during World War II? 1
 - (a) "gripped by a conflict"
 - (b) "ordinary individuals doing extraordinary things"
 - (c) "geopolitical landscape"
 - (d) "consequences of unchecked power"
- (vi) In light of the passage, what is the "glimmer of light" referred to? 2
- (vii) What was the primary role of the home front during the war, as described in the passage? 1
 - (a) To act as a refuge for the soldiers
 - (b) To support the war effort through various means, including women taking on new roles and factories producing supplies
 - (c) To protest against the war and demand peace
 - (d) To oversee the battles and strategize for victory
- (viii) How does the author perceive the legacy of World War II? 2
- (ix) Based on the passage, which of the following headlines aligns with the main theme discussed? 1
 - (a) THE ECONOMIC BOOM OF THE POST-WAR ERA
 - (b) WWII: A TAPESTRY OF BRAVERY, SACRIFICE, AND HUMAN SPIRIT
 - (c) THE ART AND LITERATURE OF THE WAR YEARS
 - (d) TECHNICAL INNOVATIONS DURING THE 1940s

Passage-IX

Read the following text:

(12 m)

The sun had just set, casting long shadows across the quiet town of Willowbrook. It was a picturesque evening, and the townsfolk were going about their evening routines, seemingly undisturbed. However, an air of mystery loomed over Willowbrook, as whispers of a hidden treasure had been circulating for generations.

The legend spoke of an ancient map, said to reveal the location of a treasure chest filled with riches beyond imagination. For centuries, adventurers and treasure hunters had combed through the town, searching for clues that would lead them to this fabled fortune.

One such treasure hunter was Samuel, a rugged explorer known for his daring escapades. He had heard the tales of Willowbrook's treasure from his grandfather and had spent years deciphering cryptic riddles left behind by those who had come before him. Samuel had finally pieced together the final clue that pointed to the heart of Willowbrook's forest.

As the moon rose high in the sky, Samuel set out with a lantern in hand, venturing deep into the dense woods. The night was still, save for the rustling leaves and the distant hoots of owls. Each step brought him closer to the culmination of his life's work.

Hours passed, and Samuel reached a clearing marked by a massive, ancient oak tree. There, buried beneath its gnarled roots, was a chest adorned with intricate engravings. His heart raced as he lifted the chest from its resting place. With trembling hands, he unlocked it, revealing a dazzling array of jewels, gold coins, and priceless artifacts. Samuel had finally found Willowbrook's treasure.

However, Samuel was not alone in the forest. News of his quest had spread, attracting a band of rival treasure hunters led by the enigmatic Elena. She and her crew emerged from the shadows, surrounding Samuel.

"You thought you could claim the treasure all for yourself?" Elena sneered, her eyes gleaming with greed.

Samuel knew he had a choice to make. Would he share the treasure with these unexpected rivals or protect his discovery at all costs? As tensions rose in the moonlit forest, the fate of Willowbrook's legendary treasure hunt hung in the balance.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) The mood in Willowbrook during the evening can best be described as: 1
 - (a) Chaotic and bustling
 - (b) Peaceful and routine
 - (c) Noisy and festive
 - (d) Gloomy and silent
- (ii) Why did Samuel venture into the forest? 1
 - (a) He wanted to hunt for game.
 - (b) He was following the ancient map.
 - (c) He sought to uncover the hidden treasure.
 - (d) He was chasing after someone.
- (iii) Describe in about 40 words, the appearance of the treasure chest Samuel discovered. 2
- (iv) The term "daring escapades" suggests that Samuel is: 1
 - (a) Fearful and hesitant.
 - (b) Bold and adventurous.
 - (c) Careful and meticulous.
 - (d) Shy and reserved.
- (v) What was Elena's reaction to Samuel's discovery? 1
 - (a) She congratulated him.
 - (b) She showed indifference.
 - (c) She confronted him with greed.
 - (d) She offered to help him carry the treasure.
- (vi) Why is the oak tree in the clearing significant in the narrative? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (vii) In the context of the passage, the term "enigmatic" refers to Elena as being: 1
 - (a) Playful and light-hearted.
 - (b) Mysterious and puzzling.
 - (c) Friendly and open.
 - (d) Aggressive and confrontational.
- (viii) How does the emergence of Elena and her crew heighten the tension in the story? Describe in about 40 words. 2

(ix) Which of the following titles best summarizes the passage?

- (a) Willowbrook's Untold Secrets
- (b) Samuel's Moonlit Journey
- (c) Elena: The thief of Willowbrook
- (d) The Legendary Treasure of Willowbrook
- (e) The Mysterious oak Tree: Willowbrook's Guardian

Passage-X

Read the following text.

1. There is a time when everyone has to face grief. When a dear to oneself dies, one is left in a state in which grief shock overcome ordinary life. One is left in a situation where one feels there is nothing one can do. Grief and mourning are always associated with death. It also happens with other types of losses. It could be the loss of one's job, loss of one's home or the loss of a close friend.
 2. The best people able to cope with these are those who come from cultures that have strict, formal and intensive mourning rituals. In India, we have diverse rituals which now are being discarded. But these help in surmounting the crisis. Near and dear ones come to share the grief and appraise with their words of solace.
- In a modern society, one is expected to act as if nothing has happened, but research has shown that mourning is an essential part of coming to terms with loss. There is a time when one has to give up one's grief and re-enter the mainstream of life. Mourning in itself passes through several phases. Firstly, it is in the nature of shock and disbelief. A feeling of numbness overtakes. The brain is not in a position to creep in.
3. Here, the affected person displays odd behaviour. There is difficulty in activities like eating and sleeping. One may remain in this stage for weeks, months and sometimes years. In the next phase, one experiences relief from pain and negative feelings. This leads to the positive side. Then one must make alternative arrangements or replacement. One is ready to cope with the situation. One knows one cannot recover what one has lost, but is conscious of the loss. One accepts the loss and is ready for the alternative.
 4. On passing through all the stages of grief it seems time has passed like a river under the bridge. This shows that mourning has been successful. One cannot forget the loss. One comes to terms with the reality.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) "rejoin the main stream of life". Pick the option that best explains the meaning of 'stream' is NOT the same as it is in the passage:
 - (a) After meeting her estranged sister she experienced a new stream of emotions inside her.
 - (b) Since there was no internet, I couldn't stream the video.
 - (c) You can always see a stream flowing in the mountain valley.
 - (d) When her dog died she sat with tears streaming down her face.

- (ii) Which people are able to cope with the loss better? 1
- (iii) Highlight two reasons, using evidence from the text, that suggest why mourning rituals are beneficial during the grieving process. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (iv) Choose the option that best captures the central idea of the passage from the following: 1
- (a) "When you are sorrowful, look again". – Khalil Gibran
- (b) "There is no grief like the grief that does not speak". – Henry Wadsworth Longfellow
- (c) "The only cure for grief is action". – George Henry Lewes
- (d) "Tears are the silent language of grief". – Voltaire
- (v) How would a person affected with grief behave in general in our society? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (vi) According to the passage, what is the general expectation in modern society after experiencing a loss? 1
- (a) To conduct mourning rituals
- (b) To rejoin the mainstream of life immediately
- (c) To find alternatives and replacements
- (d) To remember and discuss the loss regularly
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately based on the text. 1
- Grief can arise not only from the death of a loved one but also from _____.
- (viii) Explain in about 40 words, the significance of the phrase "time has passed like a river under the bridge" in the context of the grief process. 2
- (ix) Based on your understanding of the passage, choose the option that lists the correct sequence of the phases of grief: 1
- (I) The person has difficulty in activities like eating and sleeping.
- (II) The person recollects the old moments and the memory of guilt creeps in.
- (III) This leads to the positive side.
- (IV) The person is ready to cope with the situation.
- (V) A feeling of numbness overtakes.
- (a) (IV), (II), (I), (III), (V) (b) (I), (III), (II), (V), (IV)
- (c) (IV), (I), (V), (III), (II) (d) (V), (I), (II), (IV), (III)

Passage-XI

Read the following text. (12 M)

In 1908, when he had just turned sixty, came the ultimatum. "Mr. Chipping, have you ever thought you would like to retire?" Chips stared about him in that book-lined study, startled by the question, wondering why Ralston should have asked it. He said, at length: "No—umph—I can't say that—umph—I have thought much about it—umph—yet."

"Well, Mr. Chipping, the suggestion is there for you to consider. The Governors would, of course, agree to your being adequately pensioned."

Abruptly Chips flamed up. "But—umph—I don't want—to retire. I don't—umph—need to consider it."

"Nevertheless, I suggest that you do."

"But—umph—I don't see—why—I should!"

Ralston said, icily: "Since you force me to use plain words, Mr. Chipping, you shall have them. Your methods of teaching are slack and old-fashioned and your personal habits are slovenly."

"But—" Chips began, in sheer bewilderment.

"Mr. Chipping—since you decline to give way, there can't very well be any alternative. I aim to make Brookfield a thoroughly up-to-date school. I understand, Mr. Chipping, that your Latin and Greek lessons are exactly the same as they were when I began here ten years ago?" Because they are dead languages is no reason why they should be dealt with in a dead educational technique."

Chips stayed on. In 1911 Ralston left. Then came the War years. There was a lot of war talk—the trouble between Austria and Serbia. 1917. 1918. Chips lived through it all. He sat in the headmaster's study every morning, handling problems, dealing with complaints and requests. On Sundays in Chapel, it was he who now read out the tragic list.

One day he got a letter from Switzerland, from friends there; it was heavily censored, but conveyed some news. On the following Sunday, after the names and biographies of old boys, he paused a moment and then added: —

"Those few of you who were here before the War will remember Max Staefel, the German master. He was in Germany, visiting his home, when war broke out. Those who knew him will be sorry to hear that he was killed last week."

He was a little pale when he sat down afterward, aware that he had done something unusual. He had consulted nobody about it, anyhow; no one else could be blamed. Later, outside the Chapel, he heard an argument: —

"On the Western Front, Chips said. Does that mean he was fighting for the Germans?"

"I suppose it does."

"Seems funny, then, to read his name out with all the others. After all, he was an ENEMY."

"Oh, just one of Chips's ideas, I expect. The old boy still has 'em."

(CBSE APQ, 2023)

[Adapted from: *Goodbye Mr. Chips* by James Hilton (Text link – The Last lesson); 450 words]

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

(i) What does the phrase *book-lined study* indicate about Mr. Chipping's character? 1

(ii) Infer any two of feelings of Mr. Chipping, apparent from the given lines:
"No—umph—I can't say that—umph—I have thought much about it—umph—yet." 1

(iii) Comment on the undercurrent of the conversation with reference to the following:
Chips flamed up – Ralston said, icily... 2

(iv) Which of the following qualities best describe Ralston, as per the text? 1

A. anxious	B. short-tempered
C. condescending	D. vengeful
E. pessimistic	
(a) A and C	(b) B and C
(c) A, C and D	(d) B and E

(v) Why was Chips's reaction to Ralston's "plain words", that of, "sheer bewilderment"? 2

(vi) Complete the sentence appropriately.

When the writer shares that 'it was he who now read out the tragic list', he means to convey that Mr. Chipping.

(vii) Complete the sentence with the MOST likely reason. 1

A heavily censored letter was common because _____

(viii) Read the following statement:

Max Staefel had a long history of friendship with Chips and had shown no animosity toward the school or its students.

Rationalise, in 30-40 words, why the above statement, if true, weakens the conclusion that Chips was wrong in reading out Max Staefel's name at the chapel service? 2

(ix) Select the option that best describes the tone of the speaker in the following:

Oh, just one of Chips's ideas, I expect.

- (a) exasperated (b) surprised
(c) inquisitive (d) dismissive

Passage-XII

Read the following text.

(12 M)

1. Millions of people in the United States are affected by eating disorders. More than 90% of those afflicted are adolescents or young adult women. Although all eating disorders share some common manifestations, anorexia nervosa, bulimia nervosa, and binge eating, each have distinctive symptoms and risks. People who intentionally starve themselves (even while experiencing severe hunger pangs) suffer from anorexia nervosa.
2. The disorder, which usually begins around the time of puberty, involves extreme weight loss to at least 15% below the individual's normal body weight. Many people with the disorder look emaciated but are convinced they are overweight. In patients with anorexia nervosa, starvation can damage vital organs such as the heart and brain. To protect itself, the body shifts into slow gear: Menstrual periods stop, blood pressure rates drop, and thyroid function slows. Excessive thirst and frequent urination may occur. Dehydration contributes to constipation, and reduced body fat leads to lowered body temperature and the inability to withstand cold. Mild anemia, swollen joints, reduced muscle mass, and light-headedness also commonly occur in anorexia nervosa.
3. Anorexia nervosa sufferers can exhibit sudden angry outbursts or become socially withdrawn. One in ten cases of anorexia nervosa leads to death from starvation, cardiac arrest, other medical complications, or suicide. Clinical depression and anxiety place many individuals with eating disorders at risk for suicidal behaviour.
4. People with bulimia nervosa consume large amounts of food and then rid their bodies of the excess calories by vomiting, abusing laxatives or diuretics, taking enemas, or exercising obsessively. Some use a combination of all these forms of purging. Individuals with bulimia who use drugs to

stimulate vomiting, bowel movements, or urination are in considerable danger, as this practice increases the risk of heart failure. Dieting heavily between episodes of binge purging is common.

5. Because many individuals with bulimia binge and purge to secret and maintain normal or above normal body weight, they can often successfully hide their problem for years. But anorexia nervosa patients—even those of normal weight—can damage their bodies by frequent binge eating and purging. In rare instances, binge eating causes the stomach to rupture. Purging may result in heart failure due to loss of vital minerals such as potassium. Vomiting can cause the esophagus to become inflamed and glands near the cheeks to become swollen. In anorexia nervosa, bulimia may lead to irregular menstrual periods. Psychological effects include compulsive stealing as well as possible indications of obsessive-compulsive disorder, an illness characterized by repetitive thoughts and behaviours. Obsessive compulsive disorder can also accompany anorexia nervosa. As with anorexia nervosa, bulimia typically begins during adolescence. Eventually, half of those with anorexia nervosa will develop bulimia. The condition occurs most frequently in women but is also found in men.

6. Binge-eating disorder is found in about 2% of the general population. As many as one-third of this group is male. It also affects older women, though with less frequency. Research shows that binge-eating disorder occurs in about 30% of people participating in medically supervised weight control programs.
7. This disorder differs from bulimia because its sufferers do not purge. Individuals with binge eating disorder lose control of themselves when eating. They eat large quantities of food and do not stop until they are uncomfortably full. Most sufferers are overweight or obese and have a history of weight fluctuations. As a result, they are prone to the serious medical problems associated with obesity, such as high cholesterol, high blood pressure, and diabetes.
8. Obese individuals also have a higher risk for gallbladder disease, heart disease, and some types of cancer. Usually they have more difficulty losing weight and keeping it off than do people with other serious weight problems. Like anorexic and bulimic sufferers who exhibit psychological problems, individuals with binge-eating disorder have high rates of simultaneous or occurring psychiatric illnesses, especially depression.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) What age group is most affected by eating disorders in the United States?
(a) Middle-aged men
(b) Elderly women
(c) Adolescents or young adult women
(d) Children below ten
- (ii) Which disorder involves individuals intentionally starving themselves despite feeling intense hunger?
(a) Binge-eating disorder
(b) Anorexia nervosa
(c) Bulimia nervosa
(d) Obsessive-compulsive disorder

- (iii) Share evidence from the text, in about 40 words, that supports the idea that individuals with anorexia nervosa have a distorted body image perception. **2**
- (iv) Complete the sentence based on the provided passage. **1**
People with bulimia nervosa often resort to _____ to rid their bodies of excess calories after consuming large amounts of food.
(a) excessive sleeping
(b) social interactions
(c) vomiting or abusing laxatives
(d) intensive studying
- (v) Choose the option that best describes the physical consequence of binge-eating for those with the disorder. **1**
(a) They are always underweight.
(b) They experience frequent weight fluctuations and are prone to obesity-related problems.
(c) They have regular body weight and no health issues.
(d) They always experience dehydration.
- (vi) Explain, in about 40 words, why binge-eating disorder is different from bulimia nervosa. **2**
- (vii) In the line, "They eat large quantities of food and do not stop until they are uncomfortably full", what does the term "uncomfortably full" suggest? **1**
(a) They eat just the right amount.
(b) They eat till they are slightly full.
(c) They overeat beyond normal satiety.
(d) They eat very little food.
- (viii) How does the revelation that "half of those with anorexia nervosa will develop bulimia" impact the reader's understanding of the progression of eating disorders? Answer in about 40 words. **2**
- (ix) From the headlines below, select the one/s that accurately reflects the contents of the passage: **1**
(A) Understanding the link between Obesity and Psychological disorders
(B) The hidden tragedy of eating disorders in the USA
(C) Modern diet trends and their impact
(D) Exploring the psychological dimension of binge-eating
(E) A guide to maintaining a healthy body image

Identify the option with the correct headline/s:

- (a) Only (A) (b) (B) and (D)
(c) (A), (C), and (E) (d) Only (E)

Passage-XIII

Read the following text.

(12 M)

1. Apollo, the Greek god of music and healing, always maintained that he was the greatest musician in the world, until Marsyas, who was part animal and part human, played the flute. Apollo's jealousy and insecurity drove him to eventually slay Marsyas so that his status as the greatest musician remained unchallenged. One's usual imagination of a god is a being

who is all-knowing and pure in every intention. What makes the Greek gods interesting is that they are shown as flawed beings who do not always act like 'Gods'.

2. In appearance, the gods resemble mortals, whom, however, they far surpass in beauty, grandeur, and strength; they are also more commanding in stature, height being considered by the Greeks an attractive feature in men or women. They resemble human beings in their feelings and habits, marrying and having children with them. They require daily nourishment to maintain their strength, and sleep to restore their energy. Their blood, a bright magical fluid called Ichor, never causes disease, and, when shed, produces new life.
3. The Greeks believed that the mental qualifications of their gods were much higher than those of men, but, nevertheless, displayed human passions like revenge, deceit, and jealousy. In mythological tales, the gods always punish the evil-doer and administer dire punishments to any mortal who dares to neglect their worship. They often visit mankind and partake of their hospitality, and in many tales, both gods and goddesses become attached to mortals. Although there were so many points of resemblance between gods and men, there remained the one great characteristic distinction: immortality. Still, the gods were not invulnerable, and were often wounded and suffered so much that they'd pray for death. The gods could transport themselves to incredible distances with the speed of thought.
4. They could be invisible at will, and could take the forms of men or animals as it suited their convenience. They could also transform human beings into trees, stones, or animals. Their robes were like those worn by mortals, but were perfect in form and much finer in texture. Their weapons also resembled those used by mankind. They often used spears, shields, helmets, bows and arrows. Most of these divinities lived on the summit of Mount Olympus, each having his or her own palace. Magnificent temples were erected to their honour, rich gifts were presented to them, and living creatures were sacrificed on their altars.
5. In Greek mythology, the gods take every opportunity to reveal and establish their divinity but also fall prey to human impulses. Perhaps the Greeks did so to help generations of readers reflect on important life lessons to avoid tragic downfalls. **(CBSE APQ, 2023)**

—E. M. Berens

Source (edited): 'Myths and Legends of Ancient Greece and Rome' - (448 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) '... they are shown as flawed beings who do not always act like 'Gods'. (paragraph 1)

Which of these are examples of the above statement? **1**

- I. Gods getting attached and falling in love
II. Gods punishing mortals for their wrongdoing
III. Gods showing kindness and compassion to all
IV. Gods deceiving everyone for their personal gain
V. Gods killing a mortal out of jealousy and insecurity

Select the correct option.

- (a) Only I and III (b) Only II and V
(c) Only I, IV, and V (d) Only II, IV, and V

(ii) Which of these would Apollo most likely say about Marsyas' musical ability? 1

(a) 'Why does everyone think he plays music well? It is obvious that he doesn't have talent.'

(b) 'Why is he challenging me like that? I wonder what is troubling him that I can heal.'

(c) 'How can an animal play the flute? Such creatures must know their place.'

(d) 'How dare he play better than me? I am supposed to be the best in the world.'

(iii) Why does the author begin the passage with a description of Apollo? 1

(a) to show that the Greek Gods have immense power and influence over the mortals

(b) to emphasise the point that the Greek Gods are based in interesting stories

(c) to highlight the point that the Greek Gods are more human-like in nature

(d) to state that the Greek Gods are also allowed to make mistakes

(iv) What is ironic about Apollo being the one who slays Marsyas? Answer in about 40 words. 2

(v) Based on your reading of paragraph 3, explain what 'invulnerable' means. Answer in one sentence. 1

(vi) In 40 words, state any two ways that the Greek gods are superior to human beings. 2

(vii) Complete the given sentence with ONE word.
From the fact that the Greek gods punish any mortal who neglects their worship, we can infer that they are _____ 1

(viii) Imagine that someone was born from Ichor. In which of these situations would the Ichor be most useful? 1

(a) a natural disaster that causes the earth to split apart

(b) a pandemic that has been caused by a contagious virus

(c) a war that requires transforming into another form quickly

(d) a competitive entrance exam that is very tough to qualify for

(ix) What does the author mean by 'tragic downfalls' in paragraph 5? Give an example of a tragic downfall in current times in about 40 words. 2

Case Based Factual Passage

Passage-I

Read the following text.

(10 M)

1. In the year ended December 2016, 3.5 million overseas visitors arrived in New Zealand. But how many visitors are in New Zealand on any given day of the year? The question has practical importance. Visitors to New Zealand create demand for goods and services, including transportation, accommodation, and tourist activities. They also have an

impact on local infrastructure. Knowing how many visitors are in New Zealand on any given day might be important for civil defence or flu pandemic planning.

2. The following data explores the seasonal fluctuations in visitors to New Zealand and New Zealand residents travelling overseas. This is based on short-term trips - those travelling for less than 12 months.

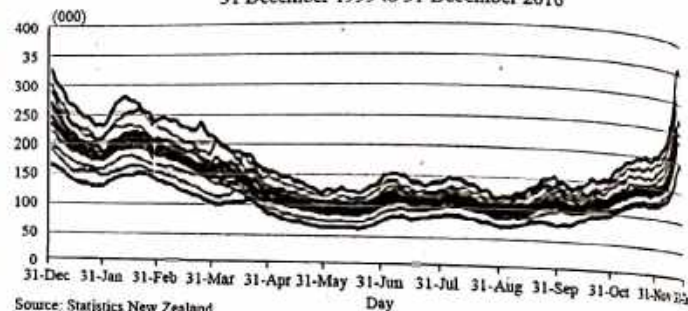
- In 2016, the number of overseas visitors in New Zealand ranged from 112,000 on 31 August to 354,000 on 29 December.

- In contrast, in 2016 the number of New Zealand residents temporarily overseas ranged from 72,000 on 1 March to 235,000 on 29 December.

- In both cases, the late December peak reflects an upsurge in travellers visiting friends and family, as well as an upsurge in those visiting for holidays.

3. There are strong seasonal patterns in visitor numbers (see figure below). In recent years the number of visitors in New Zealand peaked in the week of 27 December to 2 January. The peak day was 29 December in 2011-13 and 2016, and 31 December in 2014 and 2015.

Number of overseas visitors in NZ by day
31 December 1999 to 31 December 2016



4. At that peak in 2016, the number of overseas visitors in New Zealand was 354,000. This compares with a peak of 191,000 in 2000. Since 2000, the number of visitors in New Zealand has increased across every day of the year, but more during the summer months (December to March).

5. The number of visitors in New Zealand tends to be at its lowest in late August, early September, and mid-June. On 31 August 2016, there were an estimated 112,000 overseas visitors in New Zealand. This is 242,000 less than the peak reached on 29 December.

6. The seasonality of visitor numbers presents challenges to the tourism sector. These challenges include:

- Managing the peak summer influx of visitors.
- Marketing New Zealand as a destination at other times of the year, in order to spread visitor numbers throughout the year.

Answer the following questions, based on given passage:

(i) How does the seasonality of visitor numbers affect the tourism sector in New Zealand, and what challenges does it present?

(ii) Which of the following is not a direct demand created by the influx of visitors to New Zealand?

- (a) health
- (b) accommodation
- (c) transport
- (d) goods

(iii) State whether the following sentence is TRUE or FALSE:

The number of visitors in New Zealand tends to be at its lowest only in late August. 1

(iv) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1

The peak of overseas visitors and the temporary leaving of residents in the country in the late December reflects

(v) What challenges does the fluctuating number of visitors pose to New Zealand's tourism sector throughout the year? 2

(vi) The number of visitors in New Zealand on 31 August is less than the visitors on the peak day in the year 2016. 1

(a) 354,000

(b) 235,000

(c) 242,000

(d) 191,000

(vii) During which time of the year does New Zealand see a spike in the number of overseas visitors? 1

(viii) How many New Zealand residents were abroad for a short term on 29 December 2016? 1

Passage-II

Read the following text.

(10 M)

- The Supreme Court, this past month, provided us with a useful reminder about its worth to our constitutional democracy. Its intervention in the imbroglio over government formation in Karnataka was flawless. The hearings conducted in the early hours of the morning may have been theatrical, but the court's ultimate decision certainly helped avert a subversion of the Constitution.
- Yet, much as its decision here deserves appreciation, we must be careful not to allow any ascription of credit to veil the deeper wounds that afflict it for a litany of problems that continue to strike at the court's independence.
- Three of these are especially salient. The first involves the rejection by the government of the collegiums' recommendation of KM. Joseph, currently Chief Justice of the Uttarakhand High Court, for elevation to the Supreme Court. The second concerns the need for a systemic mechanism to deal with allegations of corruption in the higher judiciary.
- The third area of worry concerns the embroiled state of Chief Justice of India, Dipak Misra, his position as the master of the roster, and the critical question of whether such powers ought to be vested in the hands of one individual. Recurring problems:
- At first glance, these issues might strike us as unique to the times that we live in, as examples of crises that will eventually pass. But, on closer examination, it becomes clearer that these are, in fact recurring problems left unaddressed for decades. In trying to resolve the issues, therefore, we must ask ourselves how we got here. As AG. Noorani recently wrote in Frontline magazine "Crisis in Judiciary," (May 11, 2018): "We have not reached the nadir all of a sudden. The decline was long in process."

- In his seminal book, *America's Unwritten Constitution: The Precedents and Principles We Live By*, Akhil Reed Amar points to how the written constitution often invites us to heed what's unwritten, which in turn, he writes, "refers us back in various ways to its written counterpart like the Chinese symbols yin and yang, America's written Constitution and America's unwritten Constitution form two halves of one whole, with each half gesturing toward the other."

(Source: *The Hindu*)

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- In what context does the Supreme Court's intervention in Karnataka showcase its constitutional importance? 2
- Which incident from the passage indicates government intervention in the Supreme Court's decisions? 1
 - The court's decision in Karnataka.
 - The rejection of the collegium's recommendation of KM. Joseph.
 - Allegations of corruption in the higher judiciary.
 - The position of Chief Justice of India, Dipak Misra.
- What commonality does Chief Justice KM. Joseph and Chief Justice of India, Dipak Misra share in the context of the passage? 1
 - The current Chief Justice of the Uttarakhand High Court is K.M. Joshi
 - The hearings were conducted in the afternoon.
 - The third area of worry concerns the embroiled state of Chief Justice of India, Dipak Misra.
 - The court's ultimate decision did not help avert a subversion of the Constitution.
- Pick the option that lists statements that are NOT TRUE according to the passage. 1
 - (I) and (II)
 - (II) and (IV)
 - (III) and (IV)
 - (I) and (IV)
- What is Akhil Reed Amar's perspective on the written and unwritten constitution as mentioned in the passage? 1
 - They contradict each other.
 - The unwritten constitution is more important.
 - They function independently.
 - They complement each other like yin and yang.
- How does AG. Noorani describes the current crisis in the judiciary, as indicated in the passage? 2
- Complete the sentence appropriately. 1

The unwritten constitution, as described by Akhil Reed Amar, often _____.
- State TRUE or FALSE. 1

The main focus of the passage is to highlight the landmark decisions of the Supreme Court.

Passage-III

Read the following text:

(10 M)

In the last decade, there has been an increasing shift in dietary preferences among young adults in India. A survey aimed at individuals aged 18-25 sought to understand the motivations behind their food choices, documenting the percentage variation for 10 common factors that affect dietary decisions.

Among those who prefer a vegetarian diet, the primary reason was ethical concerns related to animal welfare (57%). This was followed by health reasons, as many believe that a vegetarian diet is healthier (51%). Moreover, environmental concerns, considering the lower carbon footprint of a vegetarian diet, influenced 46%. Cultural and religious beliefs were also cited by 38%.

Conversely, those who consume non-vegetarian food often mentioned taste and culinary satisfaction (59%) as their primary motivation. Many believe that non-vegetarian food provides essential nutrients more abundantly (54%). Some individuals also cited cultural and family traditions (48%). Additionally, 37% felt there was a larger variety of dishes and flavors in non-vegetarian cuisine.

Surprisingly, both groups expressed a notable interest in trying international cuisines (41% for vegetarians, 39% for nonvegetarians). Moreover, both groups emphasized the importance of organic and chemical-free food (35% for vegetarians, 33% for non-vegetarians).

However, there were discernable differences. Vegetarians were more likely to prioritize eco-friendly and sustainable food options (44%) compared to non-vegetarians (26%). In contrast, non-vegetarians were more inclined towards experimenting with new flavors and foods (40%) compared to vegetarians (28%).

In summary, the survey findings indicate that both vegetarian and non-vegetarian diets have distinct appeals based on individual preferences and beliefs.

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (i) What could be two potential advantages of conducting the survey mentioned in the first paragraph? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (ii) Considering the survey's findings, which would encourage restaurants to offer a diverse international menu? 1
 - (a) Ethical concerns
 - (b) Taste and culinary satisfaction
 - (c) Importance of organic food
 - (d) Interest in trying international cuisines
- (iii) What do the primary dietary preferences indicate about young adults? 1
- (iv) Identify the vegetarian from the statements below: 1
 - (a) Aisha - "I love exploring dishes from various countries."
 - (b) Raj - "Nothing beats the flavors of grilled chicken."
 - (c) Meena - "I abstain from meat due to my concern for animals."
- (v) Which of the following aligns with the motivations of vegetarians as mentioned in the passage? 1

- (a) Trying seafood dishes
- (b) Cooking with organic vegetables
- (c) Relishing family traditional meat dishes
- (d) Exploring spicy dishes

- (vi) How might the emphasis on eco-friendly food options among vegetarians influence the food industry in India?
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately.
The shared enthusiasm for organic and chemical-free food between both groups might stem from _____.
- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE.
The title, "Dietary Dichotomy: Vegetarian vs. Non-Vegetarian Preferences Among Indian Youth", suits the passage.

Passage-IV

Read the following text.

1. In recent years, there has been a surge in both group and solo travel among young adults in India. A survey conducted among young adults aged 18-25 aimed to explore the reasons behind their travel preferences and recorded the percentage variation for 10 common points that influence travel choices.
 2. Among those who prefer solo travel, the most common reason cited was the desire for independence and freedom (58%), followed closely by the opportunity for introspection and self-discovery (52%). Additionally, solo travellers appreciated the ability to customize their itinerary to their preferences (44%) and the chance to meet new people on their own terms (36%).
 3. On the other hand, those who prefer group travel often cited the desire for socializing and making new friends (61%) as their primary reason. Group travel also provided a sense of security and safety in unfamiliar places (52%) and allowed for shared experiences and memories with others (48%). Additionally, group travellers enjoyed the convenience of having pre-planned itineraries and organized transportation (38%).
 4. Interestingly, both groups had similar levels of interest in exploring new cultures and trying new experiences (41% for solo travellers, 36% for group travellers). Similarly, both groups valued the opportunity to relax and escape from the stresses of everyday life (36% for solo travellers, 32% for group travellers).
 5. However, there were also some notable differences between the two groups. For example, solo travellers placed a high priority on budget-friendly travel options (38%) compared to group travellers (24%). Conversely, group travellers were more likely to prioritize luxury and comfort during their travels (28%) compared to solo travellers (12%).
 6. Overall, the survey results suggest that both group and solo travel have their own unique advantages and appeal to different individuals, based on their preferences and priorities.
- (CBSE SQP, 2022)

Answer the following questions, based on given passage.

- (i) Infer two possible ways that the survey, mentioned in paragraph (1) could be beneficial.

- (ii) Which travel choice point of the survey would influence tour operators to incorporate group dinners, social events, and shared accommodations in their itinerary? 1
- Freedom to customise itinerary
 - Luxury and comfort
 - Security and safety
 - Desire for making new friends
- (iii) What do the top choices in the survey, for traveling solo and in a group suggest about young adults? 1
- (iv) Identify the solo traveller from the following three travellers: 1
- Reshma- I don't want to keep hunting for rickshaws or taxis. A pre-booked vehicle is perfect.
 - Nawaz- I'm happy sharing a room in a hostel. I don't need hotel accommodation.
 - Deepak- I'm not worried about my well-being, even while exploring remote areas.
- (v) Which of the following is an example of an opportunity for self-discovery, as mentioned in paragraph 2? 1
- Trying new cuisine
 - Hiring a tour guide
 - Purchasing local artifacts
 - Advance booking travel tickets
- (vi) How might the differences in budget priorities between solo and group travellers impact the types of accommodations and activities offered by the travel industry in India? 2
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1
- The similarities in the percentage of both solo and group travellers who are interested in exploring new cultures and trying new experiences may be due to _____.
- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE 1
- The title, "Wanderlust: The Solo Travel Trend Among Young Adults in India", is appropriate for this passage.

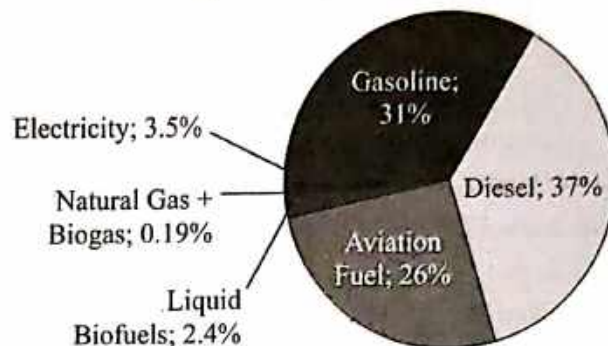
Passage-V

Read the following text.

(10 M)

- Swiss energy policy is characterized by two fundamental drivers: Phase out the use of nuclear energy, and reduce greenhouse gas emissions. The challenge is to achieve these objectives while maintaining security of supply at affordable prices and reducing carbon dioxide (CO₂) emissions.
- The core measures of the revised Energy Act in force since 2017 are therefore to withdraw step by step from the use of nuclear, to reduce electricity consumption, and an expansion of hydropower and new, renewable energy sources. The Swiss Parliament has been debating revision of the (CO₂)-Act since 2018 and has not reached a conclusion by the end of 2019.
- Climate change discussions worldwide and the strikes of young people locally affected parliamentary elections in autumn 2019. Green party candidates won numerous seats and several cities and cantons declared states of climate emergency. Furthermore, the Federal Council has decided in August 2019 to reduce Switzerland's net carbon emissions to zero by 2050.

- Therefore the new parliament is expected to pass the revised (CO₂)-Act soon, in which importers of motor fuels will have to compensate for at least 20% of (CO₂) emissions by 2025. A portion of the climate protection measures financed by the fuel price must be reserved for electric transport or the development of alternative drive concepts. In the parliament's view, this can contribute to the long-term reduction of transport-related (CO₂) emissions. To finance the respective measures, the revised Act is expected to specify that fuel price can be increased up to €0.09 (\$0.10 US).



- In alignment with the European Union Commission, the Federal Council also aims, from 2021 to 2024, to reduce average CO₂ emissions from passenger cars to 95 g CO₂/km and from light commercial vehicles (vans up to 3.5 metric tons) to 147 g CO₂/km. Further reductions are foreseen for 2025 to 2029 and the use of synthetic CO₂-neutral fuels should be allowed to achieve the limit values.
- The Swiss Petroleum Association also established the Foundation for Climate Protection and Carbon Offset (Klik) to launch and subsidize projects to reduce CO₂ emissions in fields such as transportation, industry, buildings, and agriculture. Another measure to reduce CO₂ emissions is to blend fossil fuels with biofuels.
- To support the target for CO₂ emissions, a reduction-or even an exemption-for environmentally friendly motor fuels was enacted in 2008. Biofuels that satisfy minimum environmental and social standards are completely or partially exempt from the mineral oil tax.
- So, importers of fossil motor fuels started blending fossil fuels with biofuels in 2014, due to the obligation to reduce CO₂ emissions. Within five years, the use of liquid biofuels rose from 29.4 million L to 248.5 million L.
- The new CO₂-Act will accelerate both use of biofuels and sales of electric and hybrid vehicles. In addition, the average of CO₂ emissions from passenger cars has to be reduced by 15% compared to 2021; after 2030, the average must be reduced by 37.5 %. The Swiss gas industry has set a goal to achieve a 30% share of renewable gas in the gas grid by 2030. To meet this goal different sources of renewable gas are needed. This includes power-to-gas technologies to produce hydrogen that can be methanated and fed in the natural gas grid. The Swiss engine industry and research institutes are intensively engaged in developing engines that can use natural gas/biogas and renewable liquid and gaseous fuels for passenger, long-haul, marine transportation and other off-road applications.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) According to the passage, we can gather that the CO₂ bill is about _____. 1
 - (a) Reducing CO₂ emissions
 - (b) Substituting CO₂ emitting vehicles
 - (c) Introducing eco-friendly fuels
 - (d) All of the above
- (ii) Pick the option that lists statements that are NOT TRUE according to the passage. 1
 1. Swiss government aims to completely remove CO₂ emission by 2030.
 2. Climate change discussion affected to parliamentary elections in 2019.
 3. CO₂ calls for people to compensate for CO₂ emissions.
 - (a) 1 and 3
 - (b) 2 and 3
 - (c) Only 1
 - (d) All of these
- (iii) The word 'blend' in the passage means _____. 1
 - (a) Mix
 - (b) Match
 - (c) Separate
 - (d) Suit
- (iv) To support the target for CO₂ emissions, _____ 1
 - (a) Heavy fines in the use of non eco-friendly fuels was enacted
 - (b) a reduction in taxes for environmentally friendly motor fuels was enacted in 2008
 - (c) new alternatives fuels are being researched.
 - (d) CO₂ emitting vehicles have been banned
- (v) In the parliament's view, _____ can contribute to the long-term reduction of transport-related CO₂ emissions. 1
 - (a) the development of alternative drive concepts
 - (b) Reduction in the fuel price
 - (c) taking heavy fines
 - (d) producing electric vehicles
- (vi) Which word from the passage means same as 'to support financially'? 1
 - (a) Engaged
 - (b) Subsidise
 - (c) Exempt
 - (d) Affordable
- (vii) What is the purpose of Foundation for Climate Protection and Carbon Offset (KliK)? 2
- (viii) How can you describe the condition of the Swiss government in 2019? 2

Passage-VI

Read the following text.

(10 M)

1. With technological advancements, there's been a notable rise in work-from-home (WFH) trends in the corporate sectors globally. A survey conducted among professionals aged 25-40 aimed to understand their inclinations towards WFH or office-based work. The survey also delved into key factors affecting these choices by recording the percentage variation for ten significant influencing points.

2. Among the proponents of WFH, the most recurring was the absence of daily commuting, leading to time (65%). This was closely followed by the flexibility in terms of work hours (59%). Moreover, professionals highlighted the comfort of their own space (55%), reduced overhead costs like daily transportation and attire (50%) as perks of remote work.
3. Conversely, those favoring office-based work emphasized the importance of face-to-face interactions for more effective communication (62%). Many believed that being in an office environment increased their productivity (57%) and provided a clear boundary between professional and personal life (53%). These respondents also acknowledged the benefit of readily available resources and infrastructural facilities (46%).
4. Surprisingly, both cohorts equally recognized the significance of networking opportunities in their career growth, with 40% for WFH enthusiasts and 37% for office-goers. Likewise, both groups understood the importance of team-building activities, with 39% for remote workers and 35% for office-based professionals preferring office setups.
5. However, distinctions existed too. Remote workers were more concerned about achieving a better work-life balance (40%) as opposed to their counterparts (28%). On the contrary, office-goers valued the social aspects of an office, such as casual conversations and breaks with colleagues (33%), while only 18% of remote workers felt they missed these.
6. In conclusion, the survey underscores that both WFH and office-based setups have their distinct benefits. The preference between them boils down to individual priorities, lifestyles, and job roles in the ever-evolving corporate landscape.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Identify two potential advantages companies might gain based on the WFH trend mentioned in paragraph 2. Answer in about 40 words.
- (ii) Which factor from the survey would most likely prompt companies to invest more in online communication tools and platforms?
 - (a) Comfort of their own space
 - (b) Absence of daily commuting
 - (c) Effective face-to-face interactions
 - (d) Clear boundary between professional and personal life
- (iii) Based on the top reasons for preferring WFH and office-based work, what general observation can be made about modern professionals?
- (iv) From the following professionals, identify who most likely prefers working from home:
 - (a) Rohan: "I hate the traffic during rush hour. Working from home in my pajamas is ideal."
 - (b) Aisha: "Brainstorming sessions are much more effective in person."
 - (c) Priya: "I love the coffee breaks and quick chats with colleagues."

- (v) Which of the following represents the clear boundary between professional and personal life, as mentioned in paragraph (3)? 1
- Having a separate workspace at home.
 - Logging off from the work server after office hours.
 - Attending team-building activities.
 - Access to office infrastructure.
- (vi) How might the preference of a better work-life balance among remote workers influence corporate policies and incentives? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately: 1
- The similar emphasis on networking opportunities by both WFH enthusiasts and office-goers can be attributed to _____.
- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE. 1
- The title, "Digital Revolution: The Rising WFH Culture Among Modern Professionals", would be suitable for the passage.

Passage-VII

Read the passage given below:

(10 M)

- News - If you can't remember the last time you saw a teenager reading a book, newspaper or magazine, you're not alone. In recent years, less than 20 percent of teens report reading a book, magazine or newspaper daily for pleasure. More than 80 percent say they use social media every day, according to research published by the World Psychological Association.
- "Compared with previous generations, teens in the 2010s spent more time online and less time with traditional media, such as books, magazines and television," said lead author of the book *yGen* and professor of psychology at ABC University. "Time on digital media has displaced the time that was once spent enjoying a book or watching TV."
- Swaner and her colleagues analyses data concluded from an ongoing study of a nationally representative sample of approximately 50,000 eighth, tenth and twelfth grade students annually. They looked at survey results from 1976 to 2016, representing more than 1 million teenagers. While the study started with only twelfth - graders in the 1970s, eighth and tenth - graders were added in 1991.
- Use of digital media increased substantially from 2006 to 2016. Among twelfth-graders, internet use during leisure time doubled from one to two hours per day during that period. It also increased 75 percent for tenth-graders and 68 percent for eighth-graders.
- "In the mid-2010s, the average twelfth-grader reported spending approximately two hours a day texting, just over two hours a day on the internet - which included gaming - and just under two hours a day on social media," said Swaner. That's a total of about six hours per day on just three digital media activities during their leisure time."
- In comparison, tenth-graders reported a total of five hours per day and eighth-graders reported four hours per day on those three digital activities. Consequently the spent time in the digital world is seriously degrading the time they spend on more traditional media such as print book and newspapers.

- The decline in reading print media was especially steep. In the early 1990s, 33 percent of tenth-graders said they read a newspaper almost every day. By 2016, that number was only 2 percent. In the late 1970s, 60 percent of twelfth-graders said they read a book or a magazine almost every day; by 2016, only 16 percent did. Twelfth-graders also reported reading fewer books each year in 2016 compared to how much they read in 1976 and approximately one-third did not read a book (including e-books) for pleasure in the year prior to the 2016 survey.
- There's no lack of intelligence among young people. However due to over dependence on digital media they find it difficult to focus for long periods of time and to read long-form text. Subsequently they find it challenging to understand complex issues and develop critical thinking skills. **(CBSE, 2023)**

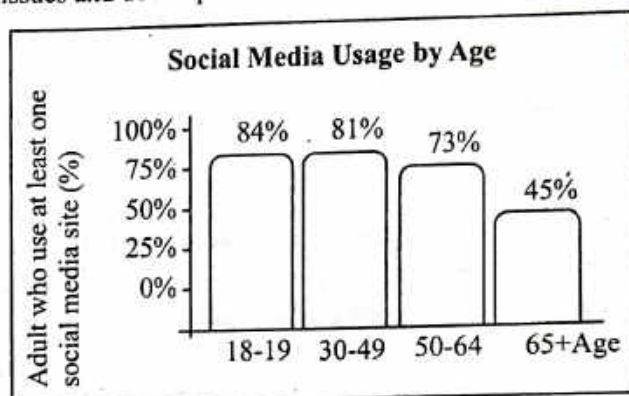


Fig. 1

On the basis of your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below:

- Does the following statement agree with the information given in paragraph? 1
The writer believes that very few teens indulge in reading as a pleasurable activity.
Select from the following:
True : if the statement agrees with the information.
False: if the statement contradicts the information.
Not given : if there is no information on this.
- Select the option that displays the most likely reason for this research. 1
In order to find out.....
(a) reading choices of teenagers.
(b) digital competency of teenagers.
(c) speed of reading text.
(d) the decline of time spent on traditional media.
- Complete the statement based on the following statement: 1
Traditional media has been replaced by digital media. We can say this because _____.
- Do you think that the researchers of study added tenth and eighth graders to the survey deliberately? Support your answer with reference to the text. 1
- Complete the given sentence by selecting the most appropriate option: 1

The concluding sentence of the text makes a clear case for _____ by listing it as a core competency for analysis and application.

- following social media
 - reading long texts
 - building focus and concentration
 - developing constructive habits
- (vi) Complete the given sentence by selecting the most appropriate option: **1**

The digital activities that the twelfth-graders indulge in are _____.

- texting, gaming, television
 - texting, gaming, social media
 - newspaper, books, magazine
 - television, books, gaming
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately with one/two words: **1**

Teens today hardly read print media for _____.

- (viii) Based on the reading of the text, state a point to challenge the given statement. **1**

"Time on digital media has displaced time once spent enjoying a book or watching T.V."

- (ix) What does the author mean by degrading the time in para 6? **1**

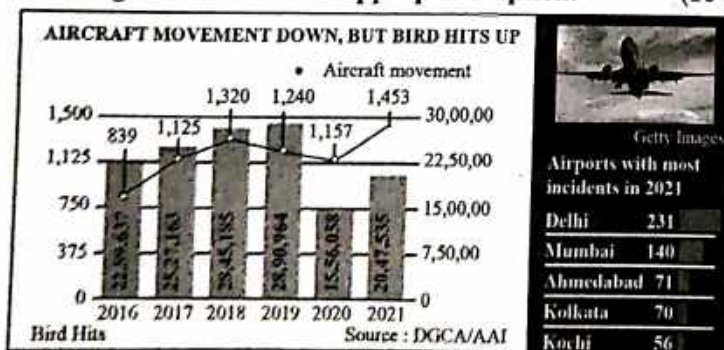
- spending less time
- waste of time
- consuming more time
- saving time

- (x) As per Fig. 1, the percentage of people above 50 yrs is _____ the percentage of teenagers using social media. **1**

- greater than
- less than
- equal to
- negligible to

Passage-VIII

Read the following report and answer the questions by choosing the correct/most appropriate option: **(10 M)**



1. How bird hits happen, why they are a concern?

New Delhi June 20

At least two bird strike incidents happened on Sunday. Both aircrafts returned to their airports of origin and were grounded for maintenance. An ABC aircraft, which took off from Guwahati towards Delhi, suffered damage to its left engine following a bird hit at 1600 feet. The pilots returned to Guwahati. The other strike happened on another flight from

Patna to Delhi. The pilots of the aircraft suspected a bird during the take-off roll but continued to climb. Following the take off rotation, they were informed by the cabin crew of sparks emanating from the left engine. Subsequently, pilots were also informed by air traffic control of an emergency coming out of one of the engines. The pilots declared emergency and returned to Patna.

2. Why are bird strikes a concern?

Bird strikes are among the most common threats to air safety, and they typically occur during take-off or landing. Dozens of bird-strikes happen each day but some can be more dangerous than others. Typically, when birds collide with an aircraft's airframe, it is unlikely to cause significant problems for the pilots flying. But there are instances when the engine ingests the birds. This can lead to a loss of thrust in the engine and cause maneuverability problems for the aircraft. In these cases, where a jet engine ingests a bird, pilots would generally call for pilots to land the plane at the closest airport. While most airframe bird strikes are not considered critical to air safety, if a collision cracks a window or a screen, pilots will look to land as early as possible.

3. How critical are bird strikes to air safety?

Smaller planes would generally be more susceptible to the dangers of bird strikes than larger ones. However, given that bird strikes mostly happen during take-off and landing, these incidents could distract the pilots during what are the most critical phases of flights that demand the complete attention of the crew.

4. What causes bird-strikes?

The presence of birds around an aircraft increases the chance of a bird strike. In the monsoon, as water puddles emerge on open grounds attracting insects to breed, the presence of birds increases. In some cases, bird hits also happen at high altitudes when a plane is cruising. These are more dangerous than the low-altitude hits, given that they can cause rapid depressurization of cabins. Other reasons for bird activity around the air field could be presence of landfills or waste disposal sites that can attract a large number of birds.

(CBSE, 2021)

- (i) Does the following statement agree with the information given in paragraph

When an airplane is hit by a bird or is suspected to have been hit, the passengers must be asked to get down at once.

Select from the following:

True: If the statement agrees with the information.

False: If the statement contradicts the information.

Not Given: If there is no information on this

- (ii) Select the option that displays the most likely reason for Bird hits

- when the aircraft is overloaded
- at the time of landing or taking off
- when the crew become negligent
- when the passengers become panicky

- (iii) Complete the sentence appropriately with one word. 1
Smaller planes are generally more _____ than the larger ones.
- (iv) Complete the sentence by selecting the most appropriate option: 1
When the window or the windscreen of the air plane is cracked due to a bird hit _____.
- (a) the crew must rush to the cockpit.
(b) the pilot must land at the earliest airport.
(c) the pilot must inform the maintenance engineer.
(d) the pilot must get instructions from the aviation wing what should do in emergency.
- (v) Based on the reading of the text, state a point to further the statement. 1
Dozens of bird hits take place every day _____.
- (a) but only a few are dangerous.
(b) all of them are fatal.
(c) but after every bird hit it is imperative to land the aircraft.
(d) the pilot should ignore them.
- (vi) Complete the sentence based on the following statement: 1
Complete attention of the crew is demanded during take off and landing.
We can say this because _____.
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately with one/two words. 1
In cases where the aircraft engine infests the bird, it leads to the loss of thrust and causes problems in _____.
- (viii) Which are the areas more prone to bird hits? 1
- (ix) Based on the reading of the text, state a point to challenge the given statement: 1
The area around air fields should be clear of any waste disposal sites.
- (x) Look at the graph. It shows that between 2016 and 2021, whereas air flights have come down, the bird-hits have gone up. This implies that the incidence of bird hits has _____. 1
- (a) decreased (b) increased
(c) remained constant (d) been alarming

Passage-IX

Read the following text.

(10 M)

- The world of entrepreneurship in India has been buzzing with activity in recent years. A study conducted among young adults aged 20-28 set out to investigate the driving factors behind this growing trend. The research focused on 10 major elements that influence the decision to start a business.
- The primary motivation for many budding entrepreneurs, according to the survey, was the desire for autonomy and the freedom to make decisions (62%). This was followed by a wish to solve real-world problems and innovate (55%). Furthermore, there was an aspiration among many to build something from scratch (49%) and the thrill of facing challenges head-on (41%).

- Conversely, individuals who leaned towards traditional employment routes highlighted the value of job security (65%). Many felt that stable income, routine work hours, and the absence of the unpredictability that comes with entrepreneurship appealed to them (58%). Additionally, a structured work environment with clear roles and responsibilities attracted 52% of respondents.
- Interestingly, both budding entrepreneurs and those inclined towards regular employment shared similar views on the importance of work-life balance (44% for entrepreneurs, 42% for traditional job seekers). Both groups also recognized the importance of personal growth and learning opportunities (40% for entrepreneurs, 39% for job seekers).
- However, significant contrasts were evident too. Entrepreneurs were more open to taking financial risks (50%) compared to their traditionally employed counterparts (18%). On the flip side, those in regular employment greatly valued benefits such as healthcare and retirement plans (32%), a point that only 15% of entrepreneurs found essential.
- In conclusion, the study showcases that while entrepreneurship offers independence, innovation, and the challenge of building something new, traditional employment offers stability, structured environments, and assured benefits. The choice between the two, it seems, is driven by individual priorities and perspectives.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- Highlight two potential benefits that such a study on entrepreneurial tendencies among youth might offer. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- If a corporation wanted to attract entrepreneurial-minded young adults, which aspect should they highlight in their recruitment drives? 1
 - Job Security
 - Autonomy and Decision-making Freedom
 - Structured Work Environment
 - Regular Work Hours
- What do the top motivating factors for entrepreneurs and traditional job seekers reveal about their respective aspirations? 1
- Identify the entrepreneur from the following individuals: 1
 - Ritesh: "I value my monthly salary and the healthcare benefits."
 - Ayesha: "Every day presents a new challenge; I thrive on unpredictability."
 - Veena: "I prefer a job description that clearly states my tasks."
- Which of the following aligns with an entrepreneur's desire to solve real-world problems? 1
 - Investing in stock markets
 - Following a fixed work schedule
 - Innovating a sustainable product
 - Seeking retirement benefits
- How might the rising entrepreneurial trend in India influence business education and training programs? 2

- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1
The emphasis on work-life balance by both entrepreneurs and traditional job seekers suggests _____.
- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE. 1
The title, "Entrepreneurship vs. Employment: The Youth's Perspective in India", suits the passage.

Passage-X

Read the following text.

(10 M)

- Zebras are known for their distinctive black and white stripes. The intriguing enigma of these stripes lies in their function and nature. Specifically, two scientific studies have sought to understand the purpose and underlying mechanisms of zebras' unique stripes.
- Study 1- The Case of Alison & Stephen Cobb's Study:
(Published in The Journal of Natural History, Volume 53, Issue 13-14)
 - Researcher couple, Alison and Stephen Cobb, conducted an experiment that explored the idea of zebras' stripes helping to keep them cool and shared that thermoregulation was the primary function of zebra stripes.
 - They measured the temperatures of black and white stripes on two zebras, throughout separate sunny days in Kenya. There was a 12-15°C difference between zebras' stripe temperatures throughout the middle seven daytime hours.
 - They shared that the movement of sweat away from the skin is accelerated by the surfactant equid protein -latherin - a vital component of cooling in racehorses.
 - They noted that latherin decreases the surface tension of the sweat, facilitating evaporative cooling at the hair tips.
 - Their theory was that the abrupt temperature difference between the stripes causes chaotic air movement above the hair surface, thus enhancing evaporative heat dissipation.
- Study -2 The Case of Prof. Tim Caro's Experiment:
(Published in The Journal of Experimental Biology, Volume 226, Issue 4)
 - Prof. Caro and four other researchers investigated what deters horseflies from landing on zebras.
 - Their experiment involved close-up observations of fly behaviour around zebras. They also observed the flies' interactions with domestic horses, some of which were dressed in striped jackets, and others left without.
 - The results of the study showed that flies approached all three groups—the zebras, the horses with striped jackets, and the plain horses—similarly. However, they behaved differently around the zebras and the horses with striped jackets. Flies approaching these animals merely bounced off, whereas they could land on plain horses.
 - The researchers concluded that the sharply outlined and thin stripes are the deterrent to horseflies as it is the occurrence of only large monochrome dark patches that are highly attractive to horseflies at close distances.

[Created for academic usage / 350 words]

(CBSE APQ, 2023)

Answer the following questions, based on given passage

- What might be the MOST likely purpose of the author of "intriguing enigma", while referring to the zebra stripes?
- Supply the response to the following, in a phrase, from the text given above.
According to the Cobb's study, what is the relation between zebras' stripes and thermoregulation?
- Complete the sentence with an appropriate inference.
The choice of "middle...daytime hours" is likely driven by the need to study zebras under the condition of _____.
- Select the option that DOES NOT display the nature of these experiments correctly.

(a) Collaborative	(b) Observational
(c) Analytical	(d) Fictional
- In the absence of latherin, a surfactant protein, what is the likely consequence for an equid, such as a zebra or horse?
 - Improved thermoregulation in hot conditions.
 - Enhanced evaporative cooling.
 - Impaired sweating
 - Increased resistance to heat stress.
- The text makes a mention of the studies being published. What implication does this hold for the readers? (Answer in 30-40 words)
- Which of the following can we cite as an example to explain the meaning of "deterrent", as used in the line—*researchers concluded that the sharply outlined and stripes are the deterrent to horseflies ...?*
 - Installing security cameras on a property will act as a deterrent for burglars.
 - Planting flowers in a garden will become a deterrent for pollinators like bees.
 - Painting a room in bright, for a welcoming atmosphere will be a perfect deterrent.
 - Hanging wind chimes on a porch is a common deterrent for the area's visual appeal.
- In terms of the purpose of the zebra stripes, examine the findings in the Cobb's study and Prof. Caro's experiment align or differ?

Passage-XI

Read the following text.

- In the digital era, the rise of e-commerce platforms has transformed shopping habits across India. A study among urban residents aged 20-30 aimed to decipher why they are drawn to online shopping and recorded the percentage variation for 10 reasons that influence their shopping preferences.
- For those who choose online platforms, convenience was the dominant reason, with 65% citing the ability to shop anytime and anywhere. Next was a wider variety of options (50%) followed by better prices due to discounts and deals (35%).

- The review system, which allowed them to base decisions on others' experiences, was another significant factor at 50%.
3. In contrast, traditional shoppers valued the tactile experience, with 60% saying they prefer to touch and feel products before purchasing. Trust in brick-and-mortar stores stood at 57%. They also appreciated the lack of wait time for deliveries, with immediate possession as a bonus (53%). Negotiating prices was a factor for 40%.
 4. Remarkably, both groups were keen on supporting local artisans and products (42% for online shoppers, 40% for traditional shoppers). Additionally, both sets were drawn to festive sales and seasonal discounts, albeit at slightly different percentages (38% for online shoppers, 35% for traditional shoppers).
 5. There were clear distinctions, however. Online shoppers were more inclined to buy international brands (45%) compared to traditional shoppers (25%). Meanwhile, traditional shoppers placed a higher emphasis on the shopping experience itself (30%) than their online counterparts (15%).
 6. To summarize, the study revealed that while online and traditional shopping methods have distinct benefits, the choice between them boils down to individual preferences and priorities.

Answer the following questions, based on the given passage.

- (i) Highlight two potential applications of the survey discussed in paragraph 1 for retail businesses. Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (ii) Based on the survey results, which aspect might compel businesses to provide 24/7 customer service support? 1
 - (a) Wider variety of options.
 - (b) Convenience of shopping anytime.
 - (c) Tactile experience.
 - (d) Supporting local artisans.
- (iii) What do the top choices for online and traditional shopping methods reveal about urban residents? 1
- (iv) Identify the online shopper among the following: 1
 - (a) Ramesh: I need to see and touch the fabric before buying.
 - (b) Sneha: I love reading product reviews before making a purchase.
 - (c) Varun: I enjoy haggling over the price at local markets.
- (v) Which of the following resonates with an online shopper's reason of basing decisions on others' experiences as described in paragraph 2? 1
 - (a) Trying a free sample
 - (b) Reading customer reviews
 - (c) Visiting a local store
 - (d) Discussing with a store manager
- (vi) Considering the distinct budget preferences of online and traditional shoppers, how might this influence the marketing strategies of businesses in India? 2
- (vii) Fill in the blank appropriately. 1
The similarity in the percentage of both online and traditional shoppers supporting local products may be attributed to _____.

(viii) State TRUE or FALSE. 1

The title, "E-Revolution: Digital shopping preferences among urban residents in India" would be fitting for this passage.

Passage-XII

Read the following text:

(10 M)

The rise of digital technology in the last decade has revolutionized the way we learn and communicate. According to a recent study, almost 80% of young adults in India now rely on digital platforms for education, work, and entertainment. This research aimed to understand the patterns and motivations behind this digital immersion among individuals aged 16-24.

A significant section of the youth (68%) reported that online platforms provided them with flexibility in terms of time and location. This was especially relevant to college students and working professionals who found it easier to juggle multiple responsibilities.

Interestingly, 56% of the participants claimed that digital learning methods, including online classes and e-books, made education more engaging and comprehensive. They felt that the use of multimedia elements like videos, quizzes, and interactive modules provided a richer experience compared to traditional classroom teaching.

However, there were also challenges associated with this digital transition. Around 50% reported occasional internet connectivity issues, and 42% mentioned the distractions that came with online platforms, such as notifications from social media apps during study hours.

Another observation from the study was the increased usage of online entertainment platforms. 62% of respondents said they preferred streaming movies and shows online due to the vast choice available. Moreover, 48% of them highlighted their engagement with online gaming as a means of relaxation and social interaction.

While the digital shift has made several tasks convenient, 34% of the participants expressed concerns about the effects of prolonged screen time on their physical and mental well-being. They mentioned issues like strained eyes, disrupted sleep cycles, and lack of physical activity.

In conclusion, while digital platforms have undeniably made learning, work, and entertainment more accessible and engaging for the Indian youth, there is also a growing awareness of the challenges and health implications that come with it.

Answer the following questions, based on given passage.

- (i) What could be two possible implications of the increasing dependency on digital platforms among the youth? Answer in about 40 words. 2
- (ii) Which aspect of digital learning would motivate educational institutions to incorporate multimedia elements in their curriculum? 1
 - (a) Internet connectivity issues
 - (b) Flexibility in timing
 - (c) Making education more engaging
 - (d) Juggling multiple responsibilities

Question	Statement	Num resp
Should ChatGPT be used in Education?	No, it should be banned.	
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	
	Yes, it should be actively incorporated.	
Should ChatGPT be used in Research?	No, it should not be used at all.	
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	
	Yes, but it should only be used to brainstorm.	
	Yes, as long as its use is transparently disclosed.	
Should ChatGPT be used in Healthcare?	Yes, disclosure is NOT needed.	
	No, it should not be used at all.	
	I don't know; it is too early to make a statement.	
	Yes, it can be used for administrative purposes.	
	Yes, it can be used for any purpose.	

- (iii) What does the study suggest about the Indian youth's view on traditional classroom teaching versus online learning? 1
- (iv) Identify the respondent who seems to prefer digital platforms for work or study: 1
- (a) Reena: "I love reading physical books; the feel is irreplaceable."
- (b) Aman: "I sometimes face internet connectivity issues during my online lectures."
- (c) Priya: "I usually watch movies on my TV, not on my phone."
- (v) Which of the following is a direct benefit of online entertainment platforms as indicated in the passage? 1
- (a) Reduced screen time
- (b) Multimedia elements
- (c) A vast choice of movies and shows
- (d) Flexible timings for learning
- (vi) How might the increasing usage of digital platforms influence the health and fitness industry in India? 2
- (vii) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1
- The study's findings about the youth's preference for online entertainment might be attributed to _____.
- (viii) State TRUE or FALSE. 1
- The title, "Digital Dominance: The Online Habits of Indian Youth", would be apt for this passage.

Passage-XIII

Read the following text.

(10 M)

- ChatGPT has been gaining attention for how closely it mimics human-like responses. Created by OpenAI in 2022, it is a chatbot that has been trained to have knowledge of worldly events and phenomena up till September 2021 and to interpret the context of texts to produce meaningful responses. The tool can provide answers on many topics, and often states disclaimers if it cannot answer a prompt accurately. Unlike a search engine, it cannot browse the internet for information. It also does not collect any personal information of users.
- A survey was administered to understand the uses of ChatGPT in the fields of education, healthcare and research. There were 420 participants in the study of which 59 respondents were from the medical field, 118 respondents were students and faculty from the research field, 70 respondents identified as administrative staff, and 173 people marked 'other' as their occupation. Of the 420 respondents, only 40% had used ChatGPT before. More medical trainees and students as well as research students had used ChatGPT as compared to medical staff and research faculty.
- The survey asked about the viability of ChatGPT for its use within the fields of education, research, and healthcare. The following table summarises the responses.

- Based on the responses, there was a greater uncertainty around its use in healthcare and education, compared to its use in research. Regarding the use of ChatGPT in healthcare, a significant portion of respondents (42%) approved its use for administrative purposes (for example, preparing profiles or reports) and a smaller population of respondents (12.2%) felt it could be used for any purpose.

- The current application of ChatGPT and its future potential needs to be examined. It can help students understand and write more effectively, simplify medical information for patients and automate administrative tasks, and provide a summary of information which otherwise would require hours of reading through various resources. However, the negative impact must also be considered before instituting its use.

(CBSE APQ)

– Multiple Authors

Source (edited): 'An exploratory survey about using ChatGPT in education, healthcare, and research' (330 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- Complete the given sentence in ONE word.
Based on the summary table, the _____ number of respondents think that ChatGPT should not be used.
- The following was a prompt posted by a user in ChatGPT as their first question:
'What's my name?'



Based on information from the passage, which of these is most likely to be ChatGPT's response?

- (a) 'Error 404: page not found.'
- (b) 'Your name is user 1000004.'
- (c) 'Sorry, can you repeat the question?'
- (d) 'Sorry, I don't have access to your data.'

(iii) Imagine that you have to write a news report on a major landslide that occurred in Manipur on 30 June, 2022. Would using only ChatGPT be useful for your project? State why or why not in 40 words.

2

(iv) The following are the profiles of some respondents from the survey. Based on the passage, which of these profiles is MOST LIKELY to be a part of the 40% who have used ChatGPT before?

1

- (a) a manager in a hospital who has done 5 years of administrative work
- (b) a professor of Psychology who has 30 years of teaching experience
- (c) a college graduate who is studying in a 2-year Master's course
- (d) a 25-year-old teacher who is working in a public school

(v) Which of these is true about the respondents of the survey?

1

- (a) It had 118 respondents who were employed in the field of education.
- (b) It had 70 respondents who had administrative roles in educational institutions.
- (c) It had 173 respondents who were working in the field of research including students.
- (d) It had 59 respondents who were from the medical field including those who study medicine.

(vi) Why do you think some respondents feel that ChatGPT should be banned in education? State a reason in 40 words.

2

(vii) Locate a detail from the passage that shows that we still do not know enough about ChatGPT. Answer in one sentence.

1

(viii) State TRUE or FALSE.

1

More than half of the respondents think it is ok to use ChatGPT in research if one clearly states its contribution.

HINTS & EXPLANATIONS

Literary Passage

Passage-I

- (i) (b) Communication and interaction
- (ii) (c) Getting more sleep.
- (iii) Social media often highlights only the positive aspects of life, leading to a skewed perception. This can make users feel as though their personal challenges are unique, causing feelings of loneliness and inadequacy in comparison to others' seemingly perfect lives.
- (iv) (b) Amplifying voices and meaningful dialogue
- (v) (c) It can lead to feelings of loneliness.
- (vi) Balancing online and offline lives is critical because excessive immersion in the digital world can detach us from real-world experiences and genuine human connections. Social media, although it offers numerous advantages, can also create a distorted perception of reality, where we might feel pressured to live up to unrealistic standards. By striking a balance, we can appreciate genuine moments and maintain our mental well-being.
- (vii) (c) Prioritizing our mental health in the digital realm
- (viii) To ensure a healthy relationship with technology, the author recommends several strategies: setting specific limits on screen time, ensuring regular breaks from digital devices, and indulging in activities that mentally and physically rejuvenate us. These habits encourage us to stay rooted in reality, reminding us that while the digital world offers various benefits, real-world experiences and connections are invaluable.
- (ix) (d) Technology primarily causes negative impacts on our lives.

Passage-II

- (i) (c) it includes physical activity
- (ii) In the text, the author wants to convey that Cricket is a game bound within rules and usually does not go out of those rules. So, it doesn't carry secrets.
- (iii) Watching the game of cricket gives rise to -
 - (a) Make us experience the thrill of war
 - (b) Calm our impatience without creating any conflict
- (iv) (c) generate
- (v) (b) Watching a cricket match makes the viewer believe that he is fighting a battle.
- (vi) (c) a spectator who enjoys the match as an armchair soldier
- (vii) The writer aptly compares games to a morality play as the rules are made by us and thus can easily be tested for fair and foul conduct, principles of reward and punishment, and emotions of joy and disappointment by the people who are involved or engaged in them also show morality.

(viii) morality play

(ix) they will lose the purpose of entertaining us with outlet for our aggressiveness.

(x) (b) The Benefits of Playing Cricket

Passage-III

- (i) (c) A previously unknown comet was heading for Earth.
- (ii) (b) By its ability to communicate
- (iii) Neil's casual remark, "Another day at the office, huh," the face of an unprecedented and potentially catastrophic event—a mysterious comet approaching Earth—captures the essence of understated humor. The writer skillfully juxtaposes a colossal cosmic event with an everyday mundane expression, evoking a chuckle and lightening the mood of a tense situation.
- (iv) (d) An advanced AI for communication
- (v) (c) An entity travelling through space for observation
- (vi) The discovery of Cosmo was groundbreaking for scientists because they encountered a sentient entity that could communicate, share experiences, and had observed numerous galaxies. Such an entity challenged our understanding of the universe, promising insight into faraway galaxies, singing stars, and whispering black holes.
- (vii) (c) Curiosity
- (viii) Neil and Priya found it challenging because Cosmo's experiences were beyond human experience and comprehension. It spoke of phenomena and places that humans had never observed or even imagined, making it a complex blend of wonder and information to process.
- (ix) (b) Scientists Discover Sentient Comet

Passage-IV

- (i) (b) were not aware of different forms of coffee.
- (ii) Coffee plant produces a chemical known as caffeine which acts as a natural pesticide.
- (iii) The writer refers to the unique feature of the coffee plant which is its ability to produce caffeine as a chemical to protect itself from pests. However, this feature has unintended consequences as humans consume coffee and its caffeine content, which has both positive and negative effects on the human body. The chemical secreted by the plant averts the pests but with passing time, it attracts humans who get addicted to it and become a great threat to the plants.
- (iv) (d) stimulants
- (v) the characteristic taste and aroma of coffee beans.
- (vi) The interesting phenomenon discussed in paragraph 2 is of changing the bland green seed of a coffee plant into a flavourful coffee bean.

- (vii) It depends on the quantity of the coffee powder. For a lighter or stronger coffee, less or more coffee powder is to be used.
- (viii) (a) The burr grinder grinds coffee beans uniformly.
- (ix) It is fair to say that the right degree of extraction of coffee is important because under extraction will not get all flavours of the coffee, as the water runs too quickly, and on the other hand over extraction will make the coffee bitter.
- (x) (a) The Art of Coffee Making

Passage-V

- (i) (c) Used in ancient Babylon for business contracts.
- (ii) Dr. Henry Faulds made a major contribution to study the ridges of fingertips in the 1870s by publishing an article that suggested fingerprints could be used for identification. He developed a method to classify fingerprints, significantly influencing future forensic science.
- (iii) unique and permanent
- (iv) (b) Herschel wanted empirical evidence.
- (v) The Galton-Henry system is significant because it developed a detailed classification of fingerprints, such as arches, loops, and whirls. This system greatly improved the process of fingerprint identification and is still used by law enforcement today.
- (vi) Integrated Automated Fingerprint Identification Systems
- (vii) IAFIS can quickly find and compare fingerprints across the United States and internationally within thirty minutes. It helps law enforcement identify individuals and has over 250 million fingerprints in its database.
- (viii) (b) For employment, licenses, and adoption
- (ix) (b) To ensure they don't have a criminal background for the child's safety

Passage-VI

- (i) (d) The Many Aspects of Fidgeting
- (ii) Experts suggest tricks to overcome fidgeting habits such as playing with a coin in one's pocket, wearing a ring to rub, or using polished stones designed for thumb stroking. Additionally, some taxi-drivers in Greece use worry-beads to combat fidgeting.
- (iii) Based on the information given in the excerpt, one can infer that the habit of fidgeting in a grown-up person is seen as a distraction and is not a pleasant sight.
- (iv) A leading psychiatrist asserts that a bit of anxiety often brings out the best in people during instances like meeting deadlines, submitting reports, or at interviews and examinations. Tennis players, for example, play with "manageable anxiety."
- (v) All of the above
- (vi) He had complained of exhaustion after his gruelling schedule over the past week.
- (vii) Fidgeting helps release stress that could lead to physical ailments like headaches, muscle pain, or ulcers. It also helps burn calories, comparable to the energy used during a jog, thus potentially aiding in weight management.

- (viii) Dr. James Buyers implies that pausing amidst the fast-paced nature of contemporary life can offer a moment of calmness and reflection. This break, even if brief, can benefit individuals by reducing stress and potentially curbing the need to fidget.
- (ix) The author introduces the passage by posing relatable actions like scratching one's head or tapping a foot, indicating that these habits, likely formed during childhood, persist into adulthood. This use of familiar scenarios draws the reader in and provides a tangible connection to the broader discussion on fidgeting.

Passage-VII

- (i) (c) Loss and change
[Destruction of his home planet = loss and the introduction of new technologies = change]
- (ii) (b) It serves as the ship's computer
[It is mentioned in the text that the white lab mouse in the control room of the Heart of Gold spaceship is the ship's computer.]
- (iii) Descriptive
["In the centre of the room was a large console covered in buttons and switches, and in the middle of the console was a small, white mouse." This description provides a clear image of the setting and the unconventional form of the ship's computer.]
Humorous
["Oh, not again," groaned Ford. This line is humorous because it suggests that the ship's computer, Eddie, frequently offers to sing songs and annoy the crew. Ford's reaction of groaning implies that this is a common occurrence and that he's tired of it. The humour comes from the fact that a computer is attempting to sing a song, which is an unexpected and absurd situation.]
- (iv) highly intelligent/technologically advanced [because they built the Earth as a giant computer]
- (v) (c) Impressive, yes?
- (vi) The name "The Paranoid Android" is ironic because it is unexpected for a robot to exhibit human-like emotions such as paranoia. Robots are often thought of as logical and unemotional, whereas the name "paranoid" implies irrational fear and anxiety. It plays with readers' expectations and stereotypes of robots.
- (vii) The comparison is with cobblers, who take scraps of leather and stitch them together to create a shoe, in the same way in which the body of Marvin was put together or 'cobbled', using spare parts.
- (viii) The statement by Marvin, despite being an android, humanizes the character by evoking a sense of loneliness and isolation that is relatable to the reader. It also emphasizes the theme of the alienation and lack of communication between beings in the vastness of space. This creates a sense of sympathy towards Marvin and also raises questions about the meaning and value of existence, regardless of whether one is organic or synthetic.
- (ix) (b) B, C and D

Passage-VIII

- (i) (c) The stories of courage, sacrifice, and resilience during the war
- (ii) (d) Compassion and understanding
- (iii) The passage contrasts humanity's capacity by showing both the darkest aspects, like atrocities and brutal battles, and the brightest, such as acts of heroism and compassion. This illustrates how extreme adversity can bring out both the worst and the best in people.
- (iv) (c) It acted as a catalyst for societal change, reshaping gender roles.
- (v) (b) "ordinary individuals doing extraordinary things"
- (vi) The "glimmer of light" referred to in the passage symbolizes the hope and potential for positive change that emerges even in the darkest times, represented by acts of heroism, compassion, and the resilience shown by individuals during the war.
- (vii) (b) To support the war effort through various means, including women taking on new roles and factories producing supplies.
- (viii) The author perceives the legacy of World War II as a profound and enduring impact on humanity and the world. It serves as a reminder of the consequences of unchecked power and the importance of justice, while highlighting the resilience of the human spirit and the need to prevent such conflicts in the future.
- (ix) (b) WWII: A TAPESTRY OF BRAVERY, SACRIFICE, AND HUMAN SPIRIT
[This headline aligns with the main theme discussed in the passage about the human experiences of courage, sacrifice, and resilience during the war.]

Passage-IX

- (i) (b) Peaceful and routine
- (ii) (c) He sought to uncover the hidden treasure.
- (iii) The chest was found under the roots of a big old oak tree. It was decorated with beautiful designs and patterns, hinting at its old age. The intricate designs made it look special, suggesting the treasures it held inside were of great value.
- (iv) (b) Bold and adventurous.
- (v) (c) She confronted him with greed.
- (vi) The oak tree in the clearing is significant as it marks the spot where Willowbrook's fabled treasure was hidden. Buried beneath its ancient, gnarled roots lay the chest filled with invaluable riches, making it a beacon in Samuel's quest.
- (vii) (b) Mysterious and puzzling.
- (viii) Elena and her crew's sudden appearance brings an unexpected twist to Samuel's discovery. Their intentions, clearly driven by greed, pose a threat to Samuel's claim on the treasure. This confrontation in the moonlit forest, coupled with Elena's challenge, intensifies the narrative's suspense.
- (ix) (d) The Legendary Treasure of Willowbrook

Passage-X

- (i) (b) Since there was no internet, I couldn't stream the movie.
[In this option, "stream" refers to transmitting or receiving data (especially video and audio material) over the internet, not a continuous flow or sequence as in the passage.]
- (ii) People from cultures with strict, formal, and intense mourning rituals are able to cope with loss better.
- (iii) Mourning rituals are beneficial because they provide a structured way to express grief, helping to manage the initial shock and disbelief. They also bring people together, offering emotional support and solace through shared expressions of grief.
- (iv) (b) "There is no grief like the grief that does not speak"
Henry Wadsworth Longfellow
[This option reflects the passage's emphasis on the importance of expressing grief through mourning.]
- (v) In modern society, a person affected by grief is often expected to act as if nothing has happened, suppressing their feelings and quickly returning to normal life activities, which contradicts the natural grieving process.
- (vi) (b) To rejoin the mainstream of life immediately
[The passage discusses the expectation in modern society to quickly overcome grief and resume normal activities.]
- (vii) the loss of one's job, house, or a close friend
- (viii) The phrase "time has passed like a river under the bridge" signifies that as one progresses through the stages of grief, they may not notice the passage of time. It flows steadily and inevitably, indicating that mourning has led to healing and acceptance of loss.
- (ix) (d) (V), (I), (II), (IV), (III)
[This sequence correctly follows the progression described in the passage, starting with shock and numbness, followed by difficulty in daily activities, moving towards a positive phase, and finally, readiness to cope and acceptance.]

Passage-XI

- (i) The phrase "book-lined study" suggests Mr. Chipping is scholarly and values knowledge, showing his dedication to learning and education.
- (ii) Mr. Chipping feels surprised and unwilling to consider retirement, as indicated by his hesitant and repeated "umph" showing his reluctance and surprise at the suggestion.
- (iii) The conversation's undercurrent reveals a clash of values: Chips's passionate response ("flamed up") contrasts with Ralston's cold, dismissive attitude ("said, icily"), highlighting their conflicting views on education and personal conduct.
- (iv) (b) B and C
- (v) Chips's reaction of "sheer bewilderment" to Ralston's "plain words" stems from his strong identification with his teaching methods and personal habits, making Ralston's criticism unexpectedly harsh and perplexing to him.

- (vi) became a central figure in the school, responsible for commemorating the fallen soldiers, showing his deep connection to the school community
- (vii) during wartime, governments controlled information to maintain security and morale, leading to the censorship of communications from conflict areas
- (viii) If true, this statement suggests Max Staefel was a valued member of the community and a friend to Chips, making his inclusion in the chapel service a gesture of remembrance and respect, rather than a controversial act.
- (ix) (d) dismissive, indicating a lack of seriousness or respect towards Chips's actions or thoughts.

Passage-XII

- (i) (c) Adolescents or young adult women
- (ii) (b) Anorexia nervosa
- (iii) The text states that those suffering from anorexia nervosa undergo extreme weight loss, making them at least 15% below their standard body weight. Despite appearing notably thin, these individuals still perceive themselves as being overweight. This misperception and denial of their physical state indicate a distorted and skewed perception of their body image.
- (iv) (c) Vomiting or abusing laxatives
- (v) (b) They experience frequent weight fluctuations and are prone to obesity-related problems
- (vi) Individuals with bulimia nervosa indulge in excessive food consumption followed by purging methods like vomiting, using laxatives, and excessive exercise. These practices can result in severe health issues, including the risk of heart failure, potential stomach ruptures, inflammation of the esophagus, and mineral loss. Frequent purging also affects their menstrual cycles and can cause psychological distress.
- (vii) (c) They overeat beyond normal satiety.
- (viii) This revelation underscores the severity and interconnectedness of eating disorders. It highlights that anorexia nervosa isn't just an isolated issue; it can evolve and lead to other serious conditions like bulimia, emphasizing the importance of early intervention and comprehensive treatment.
- (ix) (b) (B) and (D)

Passage-XIII

- (i) (c) Only I, IV, and V
[The descriptions in I, IV, and V exemplify the given statement as they show Gods as flawed and behaving like a human being might.]
- (ii) (d) 'How dare he play better than me? I am supposed to be the best in the world.'
[The passage mentions that Apollo felt jealous and insecure after hearing Marsyas play. Therefore, he is likely to say something that shows how offended he is about not being the best musician in the world.]

- (iii) (c) to highlight the point that the Greek Gods are more human-like in nature

[The author concludes paragraph 1 by making the point that the Greek Gods were 'flawed' and would not act like 'Gods' sometimes, or that they would behave like a human being would. This option best captures why the author begins the passage with Apollo's story.]

- (iv) It is ironic as he is the god of 'healing' and he brought about destruction. The god of healing acted on an impulse that shows that he himself needed healing. The behaviour of the god is unexpected as he is supposed to show behaviours that would 'heal' mortals.
- (v) It means to be protected against harm or damage.
- (vi) The Greek gods surpass humans in their striking beauty, grandeur, and incredible strength, and they possess the power of immortality, making them undying unlike mortals.
- (vii) vengeful/ revengeful
- (viii) (b) a pandemic that has been caused by a contagious virus
[Ichor, as described in the passage, never causes disease. Therefore, someone born of Ichor and having it flow through their veins would also not contract any disease. A pandemic caused by a contagious virus would, therefore, be a situation that such a creature would be able to survive successfully.]
- (ix) By 'tragic downfalls,' the author refers to severe consequences resulting from flaws or mistakes, similar to how Greek gods' human-like errors led to serious troubles. An example today could be powerful individuals facing downfall due to personal flaws, like corruption or abuse of power.

Case Based Factual Passage

Passage-I

- (i) The seasonality of visitor numbers to New Zealand, with peaks during late December and lows in late August, early September, and mid-June, poses challenges for the tourism sector. The key challenges include managing the influx during peak summer and marketing New Zealand during off-peak times to spread visitor numbers throughout the year.
- (ii) (a) health
- (iii) False. The number of visitors in New Zealand is at its lowest in late August, early September, and mid-June.
- (iv) The peak of overseas visitors and the temporary departure of residents from the country in late December mainly signifies an upsurge in travellers visiting friends and family, as well as those visiting for holidays.
- (v) The challenges posed by the fluctuating number of visitors to New Zealand's tourism sector include managing the peak summer influx of visitors and marketing New Zealand as a destination at other times of the year to spread visitor numbers throughout the year.
- (vi) (c) 242,000

- (vii) New Zealand sees a spike in the number of overseas visitors during the week of 27 December to 2 January, with the peak day often falling on 29 December.
- (viii) On 29 December 2016, 235,000 residents of New Zealand were temporarily overseas.

Passage-II

- (i) The Supreme Court's intervention in Karnataka is highlighted as crucial to our constitutional democracy because it helped prevent the subversion of the Constitution during a government formation crisis. The court conducted hearings early in the morning, emphasizing the urgency and importance of the situation.
- (ii) (b) The rejection of the collegium's recommendation of KM. Joseph.
- (iii) Both Chief Justice KM. Joseph and Chief Justice of India, Dipak Misra, are mentioned in contexts that concern challenges to the judiciary's independence and its functioning.
- (iv) (c) (II) and (IV) are NOT TRUE according to the passage.
- (v) (d) They complement each other like yin and yang.
[Akhil Reed Amar views America's written and unwritten constitutions as two halves of a whole that refer to and complement each other.]
- (vi) AG. Noorani describes the current crisis in the judiciary as not having occurred suddenly but as part of a long decline that has been ongoing for years, suggesting a deep-rooted issue within the judiciary that needs addressing.
- (vii) refers us back in various ways to its written counterpart like the Chinese symbols yin and yang
- (viii) FALSE.
The main focus of the passage is to discuss the challenges and issues affecting the judiciary's independence and effectiveness.

Passage-III

- (i) The survey could help food industries cater to the preferences of young adults more effectively. Moreover, it provides insight into the evolving dietary trends, aiding in future marketing and product development strategies.
- (ii) (d) Interest in trying international cuisines
- (iii) The primary dietary preferences suggest that young adults value ethical concerns, health, taste, and cultural traditions in their food choices.
- (iv) (c) Meena
- (v) (b) Cooking with organic vegetables
- (vi) Recognizing this emphasis, food businesses might increase their offerings of sustainable and eco-friendly products. This could also lead to more partnerships with local organic farmers and a rise in vegetarian or vegan restaurant options.
- (vii) a growing awareness of health and environmental concerns among young adults in India
- (viii) TRUE

Passage-IV

- (i) (a) Allow researchers to gain a better understanding of motivations and travel behaviours of young adults, which can inform academic studies and literature in the field
- (b) Can provide a benchmark for comparison with studies conducted in different regions or countries, helping to identify cross-cultural differences in travel preferences
- (ii) (d) Desire for making new friends
- (iii) The top choices in the survey, for travelling solo in a group, suggest that young adult travellers value independence and freedom when travelling alone and, travelling in a group, they value socialising and making new friends.
- (iv) (b) Nawaz
[solo traveller-budget friendly; (a) group traveller-organised transport; (c) group traveller high focus on safety and security]
- (v) (a) Trying new cuisine
[It allows an individual to explore new flavours and ingredients that they may not have been exposed to before, thus helping them discover more about themselves by trying things they like/dislike.]
- (vi) • To cater to budget-conscious solo travellers, the industry may need to provide more affordable accommodation options such as hostels and budget hotels.
• For group travellers, the industry may need to focus on offering more luxury accommodations and experiences that cater to their desire for comfort and convenience.
- (vii) a willingness to step outside of their comfort zones.
- (viii) FALSE
[The passage is not about solo travel trend but more of a group travel debate among young adults in India.]

Passage-V

- (i) (d) All of the above
- (ii) (c) Only 1
[The passage states that the Swiss government decided in August 2019 to reduce Switzerland's net carbon emissions to zero by 2050, not by 2030.]
- (iii) (a) Mix
[In the passage, "blend" refers to mixing fossil fuels with biofuels.]
- (iv) (b) a reduction in taxes for environmentally friendly motor fuels was enacted in 2008
- (v) (a) the development of alternative drive concepts
- (vi) (b) Subsidise
- (vii) The purpose of the Foundation for Climate Protection and Carbon Offset (KliK) is to launch and subsidise projects aimed at reducing CO₂ emissions across various fields such as transportation, industry, buildings, and agriculture. This supports Switzerland's broader goals of environmental sustainability and CO₂ reduction.

- (viii) In 2019, the Swiss government was actively engaged in climate policy, influenced by local climate strikes and the election of Green party candidates. The government was in a state of transition, expecting to pass revised CO₂-related laws and aiming to significantly cut CO₂ emissions, as evidenced by multiple new legislative and policy initiatives described in the passage.

Passage-VI

- (i) Two potential advantages for companies due to the WFH trend are reduced overhead costs, as employees cover their own transportation and work attire, and enhanced employee satisfaction from flexibility in work hours and the comfort of working from home.
- (ii) (c) Effective face-to-face interactions
- (iii) A general observation about modern professionals based on the top reasons for their preferences is that they value both flexibility and work-life balance from WFH and the productivity and social interactions provided by office-based work.
- (iv) (a) Rohan: "I hate the traffic during rush hour. Working in my pajamas is ideal."
- (v) (b) Logging off from the work server after office hours.
- (vi) The preference for a better work-life balance among remote workers might lead companies to create more flexible working conditions, such as adjustable hours and the ability to work from different locations, to improve employee satisfaction and retention.
- (vii) The similar emphasis on networking opportunities by both WFH enthusiasts and office-goers can be attributed to the universal recognition of its importance for career growth.
- (viii) TRUE
[The title "Digital Revolution: The Rising WFH Culture Among Modern Professionals" accurately reflects the content of the passage, discussing the shift and implications of WFH trends among professionals.]

Passage-VII

- (i) TRUE
- (ii) (b) digital competency of teenagers.
- (iii) because young people today are more dependent on digital media.
- (iv) Yes, the researchers added tenth and eighth graders to the survey deliberately. This is stated in paragraph 3, which says, "While the study started with only twelfth-graders in the 1970s, eighth- and tenth-graders were added in 1991."
- (v) (c) building focus and concentration
- (vi) (b) texting, gaming, social media
- (vii) pleasure
- (viii) It is not necessarily true that time on digital media has completely displaced time once spent enjoying a book or watching TV. While it is true that digital media has become more prevalent in our daily lives, many people still enjoy reading books and watching TV as a form of entertainment

and relaxation. In fact, some studies suggest that the popularity of e-books has actually increased the amount of time people spend reading. Although digital media has absorbed too much of people's time, still there are people who prefer reading books and enjoy watching T.V. for entertainment and relaxation.

- (ix) (a) spending less time

- (x) (b) less than

Passage-VIII

- (i) Not given
- (ii) (b) at the time of landing or taking off
- (iii) susceptible
- (iv) (b) the pilot must land at the earliest airport
- (v) (a) but only a few are dangerous
- (vi) these are highly critical phases of flying
- (vii) maneuverability
- (viii) Areas with presence of more bird activity (like in Monsoon) at open grounds attracting insects to breed or in some cases birds hit also happen at higher altitudes when a plane is cruising. Other reasons for bird activity around the field could be presence of landfills or waste disposal sites that can attract a large number of birds.
- (ix) However, planes are still at risk of bird hits due to the presence of birds for some other reason.
- (x) (b) increased

Passage-IX

- (i) The study provides insights into the mindset of the youth, guiding policymakers and educational institutions. It can also assist venture capitalists and corporations to tailor their strategies and outreach programs.
- (ii) (b) Autonomy and Decision-making Freedom
- (iii) Entrepreneurs value independence, innovation, and problem-solving, while traditional job seekers prioritize stability and a predictable work environment.
- (iv) (b) Ayesha
- (v) (c) Innovating a sustainable product
- (vi) With the growing entrepreneurial trend, business education might evolve to include more practical courses on start-ups, innovation, risk management, and real-world problem-solving, preparing students for entrepreneurial ventures.
- (vii) A universal desire among the youth for a balanced life, irrespective of their career choices.
- (viii) TRUE.

Passage-X

- (i) The MOST likely purpose of the author's use of "intriguing enigma" is to highlight the mystery and fascination surrounding the reasons behind the existence of zebra stripes.
- (ii) According to the Cobb's study, zebras' stripes help in thermoregulation, keeping zebras cool.

- (iii) peak sunlight and heat to understand how stripes affect temperature regulation
- (iv) (d) Fictional.
- (v) (c) Impaired sweating
- (vi) The mention of the studies being published implies for the readers that the findings have undergone peer review, adding credibility and reliability to the information presented, ensuring that the conclusions drawn are supported by empirical evidence.
- (vii) (a) Installing security cameras on a property will act as a deterrent for burglars
- (viii) The findings in the Cobb's study and Prof. Caro's experiment align in showing that zebra stripes have functional benefits—thermoregulation and deterring flies. However, they differ in focus; Cobb's study emphasizes temperature control, while Caro's highlights fly deterrence, showing stripes serve multiple purposes.

Passage-XI

- (i) The survey described in paragraph 1 can be beneficial for retail businesses in two key ways. Firstly, it helps businesses understand the preferences of urban residents aged 20-30, enabling them to tailor their products and services accordingly. Secondly, it guides marketing strategies, allowing businesses to focus on aspects that matter most to their target audience, ultimately enhancing customer satisfaction.
- (ii) (b) Convenience of shopping anytime.
- (iii) Urban residents value convenience and variety in online shopping, while traditional shoppers appreciate tactile experiences and trust in physical stores.
- (iv) (b) Sneha: I love reading product reviews before making a purchase.
- (v) (b) Reading customer reviews
- (vi) The varying budget priorities of online and traditional shoppers can impact business strategies. Online shoppers, who seek discounts and international brands, may lead to more online exclusive deals and global product promotion. Traditional shoppers, valuing in-store experiences, may encourage businesses to enhance store ambiance and customer service to attract and retain customers.
- (vii) The shared sentiment of nationalism or regional pride.
- (viii) TRUE

Passage-XII

- (i) The increased dependency on digital platforms could lead to more flexible learning and working environments but might also raise concerns regarding health issues related to prolonged screen time and potential distractions.
- (ii) (c) Making education more engaging
- (iii) The study suggests that Indian youth find online learning more engaging and comprehensive than traditional classroom teaching due to multimedia elements.

- (iv) (b) Aman
- (v) (c) A vast choice of movies and shows
- (vi) With growing concerns over health issues like strained muscles, disrupted sleep cycles, and lack of physical activity due to increased screen time, there might be a surge in demand for solutions like bluelight glasses, fitness apps, and programs that address digital fatigue.
- (vii) the convenience and vast choices available on digital platforms.
- (viii) TRUE.

Passage-XIII

- (i) least
- (ii) (d) 'Sorry, I don't have access to your data'.
[Paragraph 1 clearly states that ChatGPT gives human-like responses, does not collect personal information, and often gives disclaimers if it cannot answer a prompt appropriately. Since the question states that it is the 'first' question asked by the user, we can assume that no other details have been shared before. Therefore, this option correctly displays a response that applies all three features of ChatGPT.]
- (iii) Using only ChatGPT wouldn't be fully useful for a report on a specific event like the Manipur landslide on 30 June, 2022, because ChatGPT only has information till September 2021. ChatGPT cannot browse the internet for information.
- (iv) C. a college graduate who is studying in a 2-year Master's course
[The passage states that more medical trainees and students as well as research students of the survey have used ChatGPT. This means that the profile of a student is most likely to be a part of the 40% of users who have used ChatGPT.]
- (v) (d) It had 59 respondents who were from the medical field including those who study medicine.
[The passage states that a total of 59 respondents of the survey were individuals from the medical field. The passage also states that medical trainees and students have used ChatGPT. Therefore, we can infer that the 59 respondents from the medical field include students.]
- (vi) Some respondents might feel that ChatGPT should be banned in education because they fear it could encourage academic dishonesty, enabling students to complete assignments or exams with AI assistance rather than learning and applying the knowledge themselves.
- (vii) The summary table's statement 'I don't know' is too early to make a statement' has a majority selection for Education and Healthcare.
- (viii) TRUE
[259 respondents selected the statement, 'Yes, as long as its use is transparently disclosed.' This is more than half of the 420 participants of the survey.]



SECTION-B- CREATIVE WRITING

NOTICE | INVITATION & REPLY

CBSE Marking Scheme:

Format- 1

Content - 2

Accuracy of spelling and grammar -1

FORMAL LETTER | ARTICLE WRITING | REPORT WRITING

CBSE Marking Scheme:

Format- 1

Content- 2

Organisation- 1

Accuracy of spelling and grammar- 1

Preview

Notice writing is a formal mode of communication, typically used in schools, institutions, organizations, or communities to convey important information or instructions. It's concise and to the point, focusing on essential details like the date, subject, and the key message. It is always placed at a prominent location for maximum visibility and usually contains an actionable item, deadline, or information about an upcoming event.

Steps to attempt Notice Writing

- **Format is crucial:** Always follow the correct format for notice writing. Typically, it begins with the the name of the institution followed by the word 'NOTICE' at the top centre, then the date, and the content.
- **Be concise:** A notice should be brief and to the point. Avoid any unnecessary details. It's advisable to stick to the word limit provided.
- **Heading:** The heading should be catchy and give a clear idea of the content of the notice at a glance. An apt heading is not more than 5-6 words.
- **Salutation:** The notice may begin with a salutation such as "Dear all," "Attention," or a similar term to address the recipients.
- **Specific details:** Always mention clear details like the date, time, and venue for an event. If it's about a competition or event, mention the eligibility criteria and the person to contact for further details.
- **Formal tone:** Always use a formal and polite tone in notice writing. Avoid using slang or informal language.
- **Clarity:** The language used should be simple and clear. The reader should be able to understand the purpose of the notice in a single reading.
- **End properly:** Conclude the notice with the name and designation of the person issuing it.
- **Proofread:** Check for grammatical or spelling errors before finalizing the notice.
- **Practice:** Before the actual exam, practice writing notices on various topics to get a hang of the format and tone.

Remember, in notice writing, clarity and briefness are of utmost importance. Make sure the notice serves its purpose efficiently and effectively.

SOLVED EXAMPLE

1. Springdale International School has recently set up "EduFarm", a small organic farm that promotes sustainable farming behind the basketball court on campus. As Rohit Verma, Head of the Environment Committee, draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of classes XI-XII about a hands-on farming workshop in EduFarm, after the lunch break on Friday, 26th April. Request volunteer applications for the maintenance of EduFarm.

Ans.

SPRINGDALE INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

NOTICE

April 19, 2024

HANDS-ON FARMING WORKSHOP AT "EDUFARM"

Attention students of classes XI-XII,

Join us for a unique farming workshop at "EduFarm" on Friday, 26th April, post lunch. Learn about sustainable farming and organic practices. We will gather near the school auditorium. We also invite students to volunteer for the regular maintenance of EduFarm. For details and volunteer sign-up, see the undersigned.

Plant today for a greener tomorrow!

Rohit Verma

Head, Environment Committee

MISCELLANEOUS EXERCISE

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purposes.

Practise and draft the following questions in about 50 words.

(4 m)

1. Sunrise Senior Secondary School has recently set up Aqua Bliss, a specially designed aquatic habitat for native fish and aquatic plants, next to the science block. As Arjun Kumar, President of the Nature Society, draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of class XII, about a demonstration session at Aqua Bliss, right after the lunch break, on Wednesday, 29th May. Also, invite volunteers who are interested in maintaining and looking after Aqua Bliss.
2. The residents of Coral Heights, Phase 2, have recently added a community library in the common hall area. As Ankita Desai, Secretary of the Resident Welfare Association (RWA), draft a notice for the society notice board, informing the residents about the inauguration of the library on Sunday, 28th April at 10 am. Also, request residents to donate books and inform them about the monthly book club meetings that will start from May.
3. Maruti Public School will be conducting an online course on news reading during the summer vacations for students of Class XI and XII. In this course, students will learn to

understand news reports, build the habit of reading news regularly, and will have a chance to interact with well-known journalists. As Ritwik Sen, Editor of the school magazine, draft a notice in about 50 words for the school notice board, urging students to sign up. Mention any other relevant details required for the notice.

(CBSE APQ, 2022)

4. In collaboration with the Municipal Health Department, your school is organising a Health Camp with an emphasis on fit living and healthy eating for the benefit of students between the ages of 12 years to 17 years. Draft a notice in about 50 words informing students of the event. Also state the day, date, time and venue. You are Amit/Amita – Secretary, Student council.
(CBSE, 2022)
5. You are Asha, the Activity Coordinator of Vomaji Public School, Mumbai. Your school is organising an excursion to Elephanta Caves for students of Class XI. Interested students will need to make a payment of Rs 500 each. Draft a notice about this, in about 50 words, for your school notice board, inviting registration of students interested in going for the excursion along with necessary details. Also

inform that registrations would be invalid without parent-consent slips, available in the Activity Room.

(CBSE APQ, 2023)

6. You are the Secretary of the Cultural Club at your school. Draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of classes XI-XII about the upcoming Inter-School Dance Competition. Invite participants and provide registration details.

7. You are the English Club's Head, Neha Reddy. Your school has chosen to host English Week in honour of the International Day of the English Language. To make plans for the event, you must organise a meeting of the English Language Club's officer bearers. Draft a notice for the same.

8. You are Mr. Afsal Ansari, the RWA Secretary of your residential society. While on your evening walk in the neighbourhood park, you found a small faux-leather bag containing a few documents and some cash. You write a notice in about 50 words to be put up on the RWA* notice board, asking the owner to identify and collect it from you. Write this notice, with the necessary details.
[*Resident Welfare Association]

(CBSE APQ, 2023)

9. Members of the Resident Welfare Association have decided to visit the senior residents of the society as a gesture of affection and sensitivity. Draft a notice in 50 words inviting residents to volunteer for these visits. Mention relevant details. You are Ritika/Rahul, Secretary, R.W.A.

(CBSE, 2023)

10. You are the Secretary of the Neighbourhood Watch Scheme, Jastinapur, Sector D-3 Society. Draft a notice for the Society notice board, informing residents about the change of personnel, Head Security, Gate 2 and share necessary details. Also, include the news of installation of the much

awaited security camera, on the Eastern periphery of the Society.

(CBSE SQP, 2023)

11. You are Gaurav/Geeta, Sports Captain of A.J. Bhopal. Your school is planning to start football coaching for middle school students. As Sports Captain, draft a notice in about 50 words informing students about the details of the football coaching. Mention date, time and venue. (CBSE, 2023)

12. Bali High Public School has recently created CureGreen, a dedicated area for local medicinal herbs and shrubs, adjacent to the flower garden, on campus. As Rachel Tiwari, Captain of the Eco-Club, draft a notice for the school notice board, informing students of classes XI-XII, about a guided walk through CureGreen, post assembly, on Friday, 10 July. Invite care-giver applications, for CureGreen.

(CBSE SQP, 2023)

13. Water supply will be suspended for eight hours (10 am to 6 pm) on 10th August for cleaning of the water tank.

Write a notice in about 50 words advising the residents to store water for a day.

You are Priyanka Bajaj, Secretary, Jeevan Group Housing Society, Palam Vihar, Kurnool.

14. You are Sunil/Sunila, Head Boy/Girl of Lotus Valley Public School, Ahmedabad. Your school is planning to organise a theatre workshop for students. Draft a notice in about 50 words informing the students about the workshop mentioning day, date, time and venue. (CBSE, 2023)

15. The Teen Well-Being Association of your society, EcoTech World, Sector 13, Chandigarh, will be holding free yoga classes on Sunday mornings, in the common hall. As a member of the association, draft a notice in about 50 words informing the young residents. Mention any other relevant details required for the notice. (CBSE APQ, 2023)

HINTS & EXPLANATIONS

1.

SUNRISE SENIOR SECONDARY SCHOOL NOTICE

April 17, 2024

DEMONSTRATION SESSION AT AQUA BLISS

Attention Class XII students!

Join us for a special demonstration at our new aquatic habitat, Aqua Bliss, located next to the science block. Discover the fascinating world of native fish and aquatic plants!

Date: Wednesday, 29th May

Time: Right after the lunch break

Venue: Aqua Bliss, next to the science block

We are also seeking volunteers to help maintain and care for Aqua Bliss. Interested students, please contact me directly.

Don't miss this chance to be part of something unique and enriching!

Arjun Kumar

President, Nature Society

2.

CORAL HEIGHTS, PHASE 2 RESIDENT WELFARE ASSOCIATION (RWA) NOTICE

April 18, 2024

INAUGURATION OF COMMUNITY LIBRARY

Dear Residents,

We are delighted to announce the inauguration of our community library in the common hall area, scheduled for Sunday, 28th April at 10:00 am. Everyone is cordially invited to attend. We also encourage residents to donate books for the enrichment of our collection. Those interested can drop their contributions at the library during opening hours. Starting from May, we will be organising monthly book club meetings. Details will be shared soon.

Join us in fostering a love for reading in our community!

Ankita Desai

Secretary, RWA

3.

MARUTI PUBLIC SCHOOL NOTICE

April 10, 2024

ONLINE COURSE ON NEWS READING

Dear Students,

This notice has been put up to inform all the students of classes 11th and 12th that an online course will be conducted this summer vacation. The course will cover topics like, importance of regular news reading, understanding news reports, building habit of newspaper reading along with some interesting interactive sessions with many well-known journalists.

Date: 20th April, 2024

Time: 10.00 am-01.00 pm

The meeting link will be provided with you further. Interested students should sign up to their respective class teachers by 14th April, 2024.

Ritwik Sen

Editor of school magazine

4.

MK GANDHI SCHOOL NOTICE

June 12, 2024

HEALTH CAMP

Attention students!

It is hereby informed that our school is organising a Health Camp in collaboration with the Municipal Health Department. Emphasis will be given on fit living and healthy eating for the benefit of the students between the ages of 12 years to 17 years. All the students are invited to take advantage of the Health Camp.

Date: Saturday, June 20, 2024

Time: 10 AM - 2 PM

Venue: School Auditorium

Amit/Amita

Secretary, Student Council

5.

VOMAJI PUBLIC SCHOOL, MUMBAI NOTICE

March 16, 2024

EXCURSION TO ELEPHANTA CAVES

Hello, Class XI Students!

We're excited to announce an excursion to Elephanta. Interested students can register by submitting Rs 500/- for the trip by 25th March.

Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

Students might not clearly invite or request the intended audience to attend the event or contribute to the library/book club.

Important: You must bring a parent-consent slip (get it from the Activity Room) for your registration to be valid. Further details will be shared soon.

Join us for an adventurous day!

Cheers,
Asha, Activity Coordinator

SCHOOL CULTURAL CLUB

NOTICE

April 18, 2024

INTER-SCHOOL DANCE COMPETITION

Dear Students,

Prepare to dance your way to glory!

We are hosting an Inter-School Dance Competition. Students from classes XI-XII are invited to participate. To register your team and for competition details, please visit the Cultural Club room by 25th April, 2024.

Minimum of 3 members are required to participate as a team.

Let's dance to the beat!

Sunidhi

Secretary, Cultural Club

MOTHER INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL

NOTICE

October 15, 2023

MEETING FOR PLANNING ENGLISH WEEK

In celebration of the upcoming International Day of the English Language, we are excited to announce English Week at Mother International School. I would like to invite all officer-bearers to a crucial meeting to plan and coordinate the events for this exciting week.

Date: 23rd October, 2023

Time: 12:30 p.m.

Venue: Auditorium

During this meeting, we will discuss and finalize the schedule of events, including debates, spelling bees, literary quizzes, and other activities that will engage and celebrate the richness of the English language. Your active involvement is essential for the success of this event, and your insights and enthusiasm are highly valued.

Neha Reddy

English Language Club's Head

Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

Students might use an informal or inappropriate tone in the notice, which is not suitable for a formal school notice.

8.

RESIDENT WELFARE ASSOCIATION NOTICE

April 17, 2024

FOUND: SMALL FAUX-LEATHER BAG

Dear Residents,

During my evening walk in our neighbourhood park, I found a small faux-leather bag containing some documents and cash. If it's yours, please contact me to identify and collect it from me.

Mr. Afsal Ansari

RWA Secretary

[Tele. No. 0214 xxxx23]

9.

RESIDENT WELFARE ASSOCIATION NOTICE

April 15, 2024

VOLUNTEERS NEEDED FOR SENIOR RESIDENTS VISIT

This is to inform all the residents of the society that the members of the Resident Welfare Association have decided to visit the senior residents of the society as a gesture of affection and sensitivity. Interested members to become a volunteer, please sign up by April 20, 2024 to the undersigned.

Time: 4 PM onwards, April 22, 2024

Venue: Community Hall

Join us in making a difference!

Ritika

Secretary, R.W.A.

10.

NEIGHBOURHOOD WATCH SCHEME, JASTINAPUR NOTICE

April 16, 2024

CHANGE IN SECURITY PERSONNEL

Dear Residents of Sector D-3 Society,

Please be informed that we have a new Head of Security at Gate 2, effective immediately. We welcome Mr. Ajay Kumar, who brings extensive experience in community safety.

Additionally, we are pleased to announce the installation of a new security camera on the Eastern periphery of our society. This enhancement will further ensure our community's safety and security.

For any questions or more information, please feel free to contact the Neighbourhood Watch Scheme office.

Ritik

Secretary, Neighbourhood Watch Scheme

**A.J. BHOPAL
NOTICE**

April 16, 2024

**FOOTBALL COACHING FOR
MIDDLE SCHOOL**

We are delighted to announce the start of our football coaching sessions designed to help you develop your skills and passion for the game. This program is a fantastic opportunity to learn from experienced coaches, improve your techniques, and have fun with your peers.

Start Date: May 5, 2024

Time: 4:00 p.m. to 6:00 p.m.

Venue: School Football Ground

Come join us, improve your football skills, and be part of our dynamic team. Sign up today and don't miss out on the action!

Gaurav

Sports Captain

**BALI HIGH PUBLIC SCHOOL
NOTICE**

July 08, 2024

GUIDED TOUR OF CUREGREEN

Dear Students of Classes XI-XII,

Join us for a guided tour of CureGreen, our new area dedicated to local medicinal herbs and shrubs, located next to the flower garden. The tour will be held after the assembly on Friday, July 10th.

We are also looking for dedicated students to become caregivers for CureGreen. Interested students should apply by contacting me directly.

Come explore and help us nurture our green heritage!

Rachel Tiwari

Captain, Eco-Club

**Jeevan Group Housing Society
NOTICE**

Date: August 5, 2024

**TEMPORARY WATER SUPPLY
INTERRUPTION**

This is to inform all residents that water supply will be suspended on 10th August from 10 AM to 6 PM due to cleaning of the society water tank. Please ensure adequate water is stored for your needs.

Priyanka Bajaj

Secretary

Palam Vihar, Kurnool

We encourage all residents to support our library by donating books. Your contributions will benefit the entire community. Also, we are pleased to welcome Anita Verma as our librarian. Feel free to approach her for donations or any library-related inquiries.

Manager

Community Events Committee

**LOTUS VALLEY PUBLIC SCHOOL
NOTICE**

April 17, 2024

**EXCITING THEATRE WORKSHOP
OPPORTUNITY!**

Attention all students!

We are thrilled to announce a theatre workshop aimed at enhancing your acting abilities and boosting your stage confidence. This is a fantastic chance to learn from experienced instructors and improve your theatrical skills.

Date: April 29, 2024

Time: 10:00 AM to 01:00 PM

Venue: School Auditorium

Don't miss this opportunity to engage in creative expression and personal growth!

Sunila

Head Girl

**ECOTECH WORLD
SECTOR 30, CHANDIGARH
NOTICE**

April 16, 2024

FREE YOGA CLASSES FOR TEENS!

Join the Teen Well-Being Association for free yoga classes every Sunday morning! Improve your health and well-being with us.

Where: Common Hall, EcoTech World, Sector 13, Chandigarh

When: Every Sunday, starting this week

Time: 08:00 AM to 09:00 AM

Bring your yoga mat and water bottle. See you there!

Mr. R Sengupta

Member, Teen Well-Being Association

FORMAL/INFORMAL INVITATION AND REPLY

2

Preview

1. Formal/Informal Invitation and Reply

Introduction to Invitations:

- **Definition:** An invitation is a formal request to someone to attend a specific occasion, celebration, program, or event.

Types of Invitations:

1. **Formal Invitations:** Used for official or significant events such as graduation ceremonies, inaugurations, or seminars.
2. **Informal Invitations:** Suitable for personal or casual events like birthdays or casual get-togethers.

Key Highlights for Writing Invitations:

1. Purpose & Tone:

- Understand the context and significance of the event to adjust the tone accordingly—formal for official events and relaxed for personal gatherings.

2. Format:

Formal Invitations:

- Start with the name or title of the host.
- Clearly mention the purpose and details of the event.
- Include a polite request for RSVP (*Répondez s'il vous plaît*).

Informal Invitations:

- Can adopt a personal tone and be written in the first person.
- Mention event details in a conversational style.

3. Content Essentials:

- Date, time, and venue must be clearly stated.
- Mention any specific dress code or themes.
- For formal events, include instructions for RSVP.

4. Language & Phrasing:

- Use a neutral and respectful language for formal invites and a more casual, colloquial (informal) language for informal invites.

5. Brevity and Clarity:

- Be concise yet thorough to ensure all important details are communicated without unnecessary elaboration.

6. Details to Include:

- Always verify the accuracy of names, titles, and addresses.
- Ensure all necessary event details are included and correct.

Contd...

7. Signature:

- Formal invitations typically conclude with a formal signature and designation.
- Informal ones may end with a simple first-name sign-off.

8. Proofreading:

- Review the invitation to avoid any errors in grammar or fact, enhancing the professionalism or personal touch of the invitation.

Practice Tips:

- Write sample invitations to practice both formal and informal styles.
- Review examples to understand better the appropriate language and format.

2. Invitation Reply

Introduction to Invitation Replies:

- **Definition:** An invitation reply is a communication sent in response to an invitation for an event or occasion. It informs the host about the invitee's attendance plans and is vital for event planning.
- **Variety:** Replies can be formal or informal, depending on the nature of the invitation and the event.

Types of Invitation Replies:

1. **Formal Replies:** Adhere strictly to a formal format and language.
2. **Informal Replies:** More relaxed in tone and can be more personal.

Key Steps for Writing an Effective Invitation Reply:

1. **Identifying the Invitation Type:**
 - Determine whether the invitation is formal or informal by its tone, language, and the way it's structured.
2. **Matching the Tone:**
 - Align your reply's tone with the invitation's tone to ensure appropriateness and respect.
3. **Being Concise and Prompt:**
 - Respond promptly and keep your reply clear and to the point, covering all necessary information without unnecessary details.
4. **Addressing Properly:**
 - For formal replies: Start with titles like "Dear Mr./Mrs./Dr. [Surname]."
 - For informal replies: A simple "Dear [First Name]" might suffice.
5. **Expressing Gratitude:**
 - Thank the sender for the invitation, regardless of whether you are accepting or declining.
6. **Clearly Stating Your Response:**
 - Explicitly state if you are attending, not attending, or might attend, and provide brief reasons if declining.
7. **Reiterating Important Details:**
 - For formal replies, restate the date and time of the event to confirm your understanding and presence.
8. **Using Appropriate Language and Sign-off:**
 - Choose words and phrases suitable for the context; use formal or friendly closures based on the type of invitation.
9. **Proofreading:**
 - Check for any grammatical or typographical errors to ensure clarity and professionalism.

Practice Tips:

- Engage in writing both types of replies to get accustomed to the different styles and requirements.
- Review and analyze sample replies to enhance understanding and application of the guidelines.

SOLVED EXAMPLE

Formal/Informal Invitation

1. You are Mr. Raghav Sharma, the Sports Coordinator of V.P. Sr. Sec. School. Your school is hosting an inter-school basketball tournament next month. Create an invitation to send to nearby schools, inviting them to participate in this tournament. Include necessary information about the date, venue, and registration process.

Invitation to Inter-School Basketball Tournament V.P. Sr. Sec. School

Dear Respected Principals,

We are thrilled to announce that V.P. Sr. Sec. School is hosting an inter-school basketball tournament on the 13th May. We cordially invite your esteemed school to be a part of this event and showcase the talents of your students.

Details:

Date: 13th May, 2024

Venue: V.P. Sr. Sec. School Basketball Ground

Registration Deadline: 3rd May, 2024

To register, please contact our sports department at sportsdeptt@school.com or call us at (123) 456-7890.

Let's come together to celebrate the spirit of sportsmanship and competition.

Warm Regards

Mr. Raghav Sharma

Sports Coordinator

V.P. Sr. Sec. School

Formal/Informal Reply

1. You need to compose a reply to the invitation for your uncle, Mr. Anand Gupta, accepting the invitation to the conference on Ancient Indian History and mentioning that you will be accompanying him for the drive to the location.

257, Park Street,
Mumbai - 400001

6th May, 2024

Dear Mr. Gupta,

I am thrilled to accept the gracious invitation to the Ancient Indian History conference. It will be my pleasure to accompany you for the drive to the location. I look forward to an enlightening and insightful day exploring the richness of our history together.

Best regards

Aarav Sund

MISCELLANEOUS EXERCISE

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purposes.

Formal/Informal Invitation

Practise and create the following invitations in about 50 words. (4 m)

1. Your parents have completed 25 years of happy married life. Create an invitation, for your uncle, living in Surat, to join you in the silver jubilee celebrations of their marriage at your residence C-4/Sector 9, Kumar Enclave, Sagar. (CBSE APQ, 2023)
2. You are a member of the Cultural Society at L.J. High School. Your school is organising a cultural programme aimed at spreading awareness about environmental conservation. The programme will have dance and song performances, poetry recitation, and art exhibitions by the students throughout the day, in the school auditorium. In about 50 words, create an invitation for parents and school teachers to attend. Mention the relevant details required for an invitation. (CBSE APQ, 2023)
3. You are the Sports Captain, A.B. High School. Your school is hosting an inter-school badminton championship next month. Create an invitation, inviting students and their families to come and support the participating teams. Share information about the venue and time.
4. You are V. Gajender, the Secretary of the Literary Club of Model Public School, Vellore. Your club members are staging Anton Chekhov's play 'Uncle Vanya', as part of their annual showcasing. Draft an invitation in not more than 50 words for Mr. Mohan Rakesh, noted theater and cinema artist and Chairperson of The Drama School, Chennai requesting him to be the guest of honour for the event. (CBSE APQ, 2023)
5. You are the Student Head, Cultural Affairs, at M.K. Sr. Sec. School. Your school is organising a 2-day Yoga camp over the weekend, for parents of the school students. Create an invitation, inviting the school parents for this Yoga camp. Share information about the camp organisers and include other necessary details. (CBSE SQP, 2023)
6. You are Sania, the Science Club President of A.B.C. School. Your club is organizing a one-day Science Fair in which students will display their projects. Draft an invitation to be sent to the parents, encouraging them to attend the event and support the students. Mention the date, time, and venue in the invitation.
7. You are the Student Head of Sports at St. Xavier's Sr. Sec. School. Your school is organizing a weekend Badminton Workshop for students of classes XI-XII. Create an invitation for the students, mentioning the professional badminton player who will be training them and include other necessary details.

8. Your school has invited a group of foreign students to attend your Annual Day function. Draft an invitation in 50 words to the guests and parents of the students. Also state the day, date and time of the function. You are Dr. Ahluwalia, Principal, Rohtak Public School. (CBSE, 2023)

9. You are Rishabh Malhotra, President of the Science Club, P.R. Sr. Sec. School. Your club has organized an Astronomy Night event for observing celestial bodies using telescopes. This event is open to all students and their families. Design an invitation inviting students and their families for this Astronomy Night. Mention the date, time, and some key highlights.

Formal/Informal Reply

Practise and draft the following replies in about 50 words. (4 m)

1. Your elder brother, Mr. Ramesh Mehta, has received an invitation from his college friend to attend a musical evening at a renowned auditorium in the city. Due to his work commitments, he won't be able to attend. Draft a polite response regretting his inability to attend and wishing the event a success.
2. Mr. Vinod Verma, you have been invited by your old college friend to attend a silver jubilee reunion party, scheduled for next Saturday at a local resort. Given your recent leg surgery, you would require assistance with mobility. Frame a suitable response.
3. You are Dr. Mehra, an eminent educationist who has been invited to address the students of Sunshine Public School on 'The Benefits of Reading' and release a book written by one of the students. Draft a formal letter in 50 words expressing your inability to attend the function. Mention day, date, time and venue. (CBSE, 2023)
4. Mr. Anil Mehta, your neighbour, has sent an invitation for his daughter's wedding to your family. Due to a prior commitment, your parents won't be able to attend. However, you wish to go on their behalf. Write a reply accepting the invitation and conveying the regrets of your parents' absence.
5. You and your parents have received an invitation for your elder cousin's wedding to be held in Jaipur on 6th and 7th July. All of you would be delighted to attend. Draft a reply to your cousin accepting the invite and sharing your excitement while congratulating him. (CBSE APQ, 2023)

6. Mrs. Meena Kaur, your aunt, has sent an invitation for her son's graduation ceremony to your family. Unfortunately, your family had planned a holiday during the same period. Write a response, regretfully declining the invitation and expressing your best wishes for the ceremony.
7. You are Simran Sodhi, the Personal Assistant of the IG (Inspector General), Police, Chandigarh. The IG has received an invitation from the 'Women's Institute for Self Defence', Chandigarh (WISDC) to preside over the Graduation Ceremony of the current batch of women cadets and address them. You draft a formal reply, on behalf of the IG, to the Chairperson of WISDC, accepting the invitation. Write this reply and include all the necessary details.
- (CBSE APQ, 2023)**

8. You are renowned illustrator Sakshi/Sunil Sharma. You have been invited by the literacy club, S.K. School, Jaipur, to deliver a lecture on 'Life Skills'. Write a proper acceptance letter for the invitation in no more than 50 words. Send it to the school's director.
9. Smt. Leelavati Khatri, your grandmother, has received an invitation from her childhood friend, residing at a distance in the same city. The invite is for the blessing ceremony and celebratory dinner, marking the birth of her granddaughter. Your grandmother wishes to attend the event but would need to be accompanied by a family member to assist her with her wheelchair. Create an appropriate reply, accepting this invitation, on behalf of your grandmother.

(CBSE SQP, 2023)

HINTS & EXPLANATIONS

Formal/Informal Invitation

1.

C-4/Sector 9

Kumar Enclave, Sagar

4th May, 2024

Dear Uncle,

I hope this letter finds you in the best of health and spirits. It brings me immense joy to invite you to the Silver Jubilee celebrations of our beloved parents' 25 years of blissful married life. Your presence would add warmth to our celebrations.

Details of the Celebration:

Date: 20th May, 2024

Time: 7:00 pm onwards

Venue: Our Residence, C-4/Sector 9, Kumar Enclave, Sagar.

Please grace the occasion with your esteemed presence.

Warm regards

Rashi

Championship next month. This is a golden opportunity for us to come together, support, and cheer for our participating teams.

Details are as follows:

Date: 18th May, 2024

Venue: A.B. High School, Indoor Badminton Court

Time: 10 am to 4 pm

Your enthusiastic presence will be a source of encouragement for our players.

For any queries,

Contact:

Rahul Mishra

Sports Captain



Nailing the Right Answer

Be clear and concise. Keep the invitation short and to the point, providing all the necessary details such as the date, venue, and time in a clear and organized manner.

2.

L.J. High School

INVITATION TO CULTURAL PROGRAMME

Dear Parents and Teachers,

You are cordially invited to our cultural programme focused on environmental conservation, featuring student performances in dance, song, poetry, and art exhibitions.

Date: Saturday, 25th April

Time: 9 a.m. onwards

Venue: School Auditorium

Looking forward to your presence.

Warm regards,

Cultural Society, L.J. High School

4.

Model Public School

INVITATION TO BE GUEST OF HONOUR

Dear Mr. Mohan Rakesh,

We, the Literary Club of Model Public School, Vellore, are delighted to invite you as the Guest of Honour for our staging of Anton Chekhov's play 'Uncle Vanya'.

Date: Friday, 26th April

Time: 6 p.m.

Venue: School Auditorium

Your presence will inspire us immensely.

Warm regards,

V. Gajender

Secretary, Literary Club



Nailing the Right Answer

- Students must ensure they include all crucial details: the event (play name), the role of the invitee (Guest of Honour), date, time, and venue.
- Missing any of these can make the invitation incomplete.

3.

Invitation to Inter-School Badminton Championship A.B. High School

Dear Students and Esteemed Families,

We are excited to announce that A.B. High School is hosting the much-anticipated Inter-School Badminton

**M.K. Sr. Sec. School Invites You
WEEKEND YOGA CAMP**

Dear Parents,

We warmly invite you to a Yoga Camp organized especially for you! Join us to experience the benefits of yoga under expert guidance.

Dates: April 20th and 21st

Time: 7:00 a.m. - 9:00 a.m.

Venue: School Ground

Organized by: XYZ Yoga Institute

Bring your yoga mats and join us for a refreshing start to your day!

Looking forward to welcoming you!

RSVP

Student Head, Cultural Affairs

M.K. Sr. Sec. School

Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

The invitation should clearly state that it is for the parents of the school students. If not clearly mentioned, other community members might assume they are also invited.

**Invitation to Science Fair
A.B.C. School**

Dear Parents,

A.B.C. School's Science Club warmly invites you to our Science Fair on 27th May, 2024. Witness innovative projects crafted by our students!

Details:

Date: 27th May, 2024

Time: 10:00 am - 3:00 pm

Venue: School Auditorium

Your presence will encourage our young scientists.
Looking forward to seeing you!

Warm regards,

Sania

Science Club President

A.B.C. School

7.

**Invitation to Weekend Badminton Workshop
St. Xavier's Sr. Sec. School**

Dear Students of Classes XI-XII,

We are elated to invite you to a special Badminton Workshop, offering a unique opportunity to be trained by the renowned professional badminton player, Mr. Rajat Sharma.

Details:

Dates: 17th - 18th May, 2024

Time: 9:00 am - 11:00 am

Venue: School Sports Complex, St. Xavier's Sr. Sec. School

Don't miss this chance to refine your skills and learn from the best. Please confirm your participation by 7th May, 2024.

Warm Regards

Aryan Verma

Student Head of Sports

8.

**The Principal and the Staff of
ROHTAK PUBLIC SCHOOL**

requests the presence of all the parents and eminent guests on the occasion of

ANNUAL DAY FUNCTION

of the school

at 05.00 p.m. on Monday,

22nd April, 2024

in the School Auditorium.

A group of Foreign Students will grace the occasion.

Regards

Dr. Ahluwalia

Principal, Rohtak Public School

9.

**Invitation to Astronomy Night by the Science Club
P.R. Sr. Sec. School**

Dear students and respected parents,

Join us for a mesmerizing night under the stars! Explore the mysteries of our universe through telescopes.

Date: 11th May

Time: 7 pm onwards

Venue: School Grounds

Highlights:

- Moon crater observation
- Spotting constellations
- Expert guidance

See you among the stars!

Warm Regards

Rishabh Malhotra

President, Science Club

Formal/Informal Reply

1. 277, D-Block
Sarita Vihar
Delhi

11th May, 2024

Dear Shashank,

I hope you're doing well. It is with genuine regret that I inform you that my elder brother, Mr. Ramesh Mehta, won't be able to attend the musical evening due to unavoidable work commitments. He deeply appreciates the invitation and wishes he could be there to enjoy the event. We both hope the evening turns out to be a grand success and memorable for all.

Warm regards

[Somesh Mehta] on behalf of Mr. Ramesh Mehta

2. 302, Green Meadows,
Mumbai - 400076

13th May, 2024

Dear Rajan,

I hope this letter finds you well. Thank you for inviting me to the reunion party. I am deeply honored and delighted to accept the invitation to the silver jubilee reunion party next Saturday.

However, I'd like to inform you that due to a recent leg surgery, my mobility is slightly compromised. Thus, my son will accompany me to assist and ensure my comfort throughout the event. Please inform us if any specific arrangements are needed.

Thank you for the invitation, and we both look forward to joining the celebration.

Yours affectionately

Vinod Verma

3. The Principal
Sunshine Public School

17th April, 2024

Dear Principal,

I regret to inform you that I am unable to accept your generous invitation to address the students of Sunshine Public School on 'The Benefits of Reading' and to launch a book written by one of the students on Thursday, 25th April, at 10 a.m. Due to prior commitments, I will not be available.

Thank you for your understanding.

Yours sincerely

Dr. Mehra

4. Rose Avenue
Bangalore - 560032

13th May, 2024

Dear Mr. Mehta,

I hope this letter finds you in the best of health and spirits. Firstly, thank you for inviting us to the auspicious occasion of your daughter's wedding. It's truly an honor.

I regret to inform you that due to a prior commitment, my parents will be out of town on the said dates. However, I will be delighted to attend the wedding and represent our family.

We send our heartfelt congratulations in advance and pray for abundant blessings for the couple.

Looking forward to celebrating the joyous day with you.

Yours affectionately

Sudipti

5. C-106
Patel Chowk
Delhi, Pin- 11xxxx

24th May, 2024

Dear Mahima,

Thank you for the wedding invitation! We are thrilled to join you and the family for your special days on 6th and 7th July in Jaipur. Congratulations on this beautiful journey you are about to embark on. We can't wait to celebrate with you!

Excited to Attend Your Wedding!

Warm regards,

Ishita and Family

6. 123 Park Street,
Chennai - 600073

15th May, 2024

Dear Aunt Meena,

Thank you for inviting us to your son's graduation we have a pre-planned holiday during that time and cannot attend. We send our hearty congratulations and best wishes for a successful ceremony. Our thoughts will be with you on this proud day.

Yours truly

Jiya

7. IG Office

Chandigarh

Pin- xxx234

18th April, 2024

Dear Chairperson,

I am honoured to accept the invitation on behalf of the IG, Police, Chandigarh, to preside over the Graduation Ceremony of the Women's Institute for Self Defence. He looks forward to celebrating the achievements of the women cadets and addressing them on this special occasion.

Please advise on any preparations required from our side.

Warm regards,

Simran Sodhi

Personal Assistant to the IG, Police

Chandigarh

8. A-101

Green Park

Delhi

16th May, 2024

The Director,

Literacy Club,

S.K. School, Jaipur

Subject: Acceptance of Invitation for Lecture on 'Life Skills'

Dear Sir/Madam,

Thank you for inviting me to deliver a lecture on 'Life Skills' at S.K. School, Jaipur. I am honored by the invitation and happily accept it. I look forward to addressing the students and sharing insights on this essential topic.

Warm regards

Sunil Sharma

9. A- 125

Shivalik Colony

Delhi- 324XXX

April 17, 2024

Dear Niharika,

Thank you for inviting me to the blessing ceremony and dinner for your granddaughter. Your son and daughter-in-law are blessed to have an angel in the family. I am happy to accept and will be accompanied by my grandson, Ranjan, who will assist me with my wheelchair. If I'm with him then I would be more comfortable and will be able to enjoy the events.

Looking forward to celebrating with you.

Warm regards,

Smt. Leclavati Khatri

Nailing the Right Answer

The reply should include contact information for further coordination and confirm who will be the point of contact on the IG's staff for event-related communications.

□ □ □

LETTER TO EDITOR/APPLICATION FOR JOB

3

Preview

Letter to the Editor

A "Letter to the Editor" is a brief, concise letter sent by a reader to a newspaper or magazine to express opinions, raise concerns, or respond to content presented in the publication. These letters serve as a public forum where readers can voice their perspectives, correct perceived errors, or bring attention to topics they feel are of community or national significance.

Steps to Write an Effective Letter to the Editor:

1. Format is Key:

- **Sender's Address:** Top left of the letter.
- **Date:** Below the sender's address. (Do not write: 15-03-2023)
Example: 12th June, 2024
- **Recipient's Address:** Below the date, typically the editor's address.

Example:

The Editor

The Times of India

Darya Ganj

Delhi - 110002

- **Salutation:** Use "Dear Editor" or "Sir/Madam."
- **Subject Line:** Concise, giving a hint about the letter's topic.

2. Being Precise: Start with a clear statement of the issue without excessive elaboration.

3. Body of the Letter:

- **Introduction:** Introduce the issue clearly.
- **Development:** Elaborate on the issue, its relevance, and your viewpoint.
- **Suggestion:** Suggest solutions or express your expectations.
- **Conclusion:** Hope for action or emphasize the importance of the issue.

- 4. **Formal Language:** Maintain a formal tone. Avoid slang or overly casual language.
- 5. **Adherence to Word Limits:** CBSE often provides a word limit for such tasks. Ensure you don't exceed it, but also make sure you utilize it effectively to put forth your points.
- 6. **Factual Accuracy:** Ensure all stated facts or data are accurate and verifiable.
- 7. **Formal Closure:** End with "Yours sincerely", "Yours faithfully," or "Yours truly" followed by your name.

Note: The first letter of the second word (here, 's', 'f', 't') is never written in capital letters. (largely accepted: Yours truly- for editor and Yours sincerely- formal /business)

Contd...

8. **Proofreading:** Check for grammatical or spelling errors to enhance clarity and professionalism.
9. **Practice Regularly:** Before the exam, practice writing on different topics. This will help you get a good grasp of the format and improve your speed.
10. **Stay Updated:** Being aware of current issues will give you an edge, as you can use this knowledge in the exam if a related topic comes up.

Writing a Job Application Letter

A job application letter, often accompanied by a Bio-data (or resume/CV), is a formal letter that articulates your interest and qualifications for a specific job position within a company.

To clearly present the theory and explanation of writing an application for a job, here's a structured format based on the document you shared:

Steps to Write an Effective Job Application Letter:

1. **Proper Format:**
 - **Sender's Address:** Placed at the top left.
 - **Date:** Below the sender's address.
 - **Recipient's Address:** Follows the date.
 - **Salutation:** Use "Dear [Title] [Surname]," depending on your familiarity with the recipient.
2. **Subject Line:**
 - Clearly state the purpose of the letter, such as "Application for the Position of XYZ."
3. **Introduction:**
 - Begin by introducing yourself and stating the job position you are applying for.
 - Mention how you found out about the job opening.
4. **Highlight Qualifications:**
 - Summarize key qualifications, skills, and relevant experiences that align with the job requirements.
 - Keep this section concise and impactful.
5. **Attach Resume/Biodata:**
 - Inform the recipient that your resume or biodata is attached for more detailed information.
 - Ensure that your resume is well-organized and error-free.
6. **Formal Tone and Language:**
 - Maintain a professional and respectful tone throughout the letter.
 - Avoid colloquialisms (informal language) and keep the language clear and precise.
7. **Concluding the Letter:**
 - Express hope for a positive response or an interview opportunity.
 - Thank the recipient for considering your application.
 - Use a polite closing such as "Yours sincerely" followed by your name.
8. **Proofreading:**
 - Check the letter for any spelling, grammar, or formatting errors.
9. **Presentation Matters:**
 - Ensure the overall presentation of the letter is clean and professional.
 - If handwriting, make sure it is neat and legible.
 - If you make an error, try to correct it neatly without making the paper look messy.
10. **Follow Instructions:**
 - Adhere to any specific instructions mentioned in the job posting regarding the application process.

Contd...

Format of Resume/Bio-Data

○ Header:

Full Name

Contact Information: Phone number, Email address

○ Objective:

A brief statement about your career goal or what you aim to achieve in the next job role.

○ Educational Qualifications:

List your educational background in reverse chronological order starting from the most recent.

Class 12: School name, Board, Year of Passing, Percentage/CGPA

Class 10: School name, Board, Year of Passing, Percentage/CGPA

○ Skills:

List relevant skills (e.g., communication, teamwork, leadership)

○ Extracurricular Activities:

Any clubs, societies, or events you've participated in or organized.

Include Sports, arts, volunteer work, etc.

○ Achievements:

Any academic or extracurricular achievements.

○ Languages Known:

Specify languages you can read, write, or speak.

○ Hobbies and Interests:

A few hobbies or interests that you genuinely pursue.

○ References (optional):

Mention a teacher or principal's name and contact information, but always ask for their permission before you include them.

Important Points to Keep in Mind:

1. Consistency:

- Use consistent fonts, bullets, and headings to maintain a uniform appearance throughout the document.

2. Relevance:

- Only include information pertinent to the job or role you are applying for.

3. Honesty:

- Be truthful about your qualifications and achievements to avoid any discrepancies.

4. Length:

- Bio-data should ideally be concise; typically one page for school students or fresh graduates.

5. Proofreading:

- Ensure there are no grammatical or spelling mistakes.

6. Contact Information:

- Provide correct and active contact information.

7. Use of Action Words:

- Employ verbs like "achieved", "organized", "led" to describe activities and achievements effectively.

8. Presentation:

- If printed, use good quality paper. If electronic, ensure the file is in a commonly accessible format like PDF.

SOLVED EXAMPLE

Letter to Editor

1. Despite the government's initiatives and public awareness campaigns, there is an increasing menace of plastic pollution in our water bodies. Many individuals continue to discard plastic irresponsibly, leading to severe environmental consequences. Write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper, expressing your concern about the rising plastic pollution in our rivers and oceans. Examine the causes of such behavior and suggest measures to combat this problem. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to frame the letter. You are Aishwarya Rao, an environmental enthusiast.

- For awareness:
 - Target audience: general public/educational institutions
 - Methods: in-person workshops/social media campaigns
 - Highlighting the consequences: Impact on marine life and human health
- Ensuring adherence:
 - Implementing fines & penalties
 - Setting up regular clean-up drives
 - Strengthening monitoring forces with technology

Ans. 1657/9

Nirman Vihar
Delhi

April 21, 2024

The Editor
Local Times
Delhi

Subject: Urgent action needed against Plastic Pollution in our Water Bodies

Sir/ Madam,

I am Aishwarya Rao, an environmental enthusiast, writing to express my deep concern over the escalating plastic pollution in our rivers and oceans. Despite government efforts and awareness campaigns, irresponsible disposal of plastic continues, severely affecting marine life and human health.

To address this, we need targeted awareness campaigns in educational institutions and via social media that emphasize the critical consequences of plastic pollution. Implementing fines and penalties for violators, organizing regular clean-up drives, and enhancing monitoring through technology can also help enforce adherence to environmental policies.

I sincerely hope that this letter will inspire us to protect our aquatic ecosystems and ensure a healthier environment for future generations.

Sincerely
Aishwarya Rao

Application for a Job with Bio-Data

1. You see a classified advertisement in a leading daily inviting application for the post of an accountant. Write a letter along with a resume in 120-150 words to the Manager, Rockfield Pvt. Ltd., Bhopal, offering your candidature. You are Raman Kumar/Reshma Kumari.

Ans. C-23/12,
Rajouri Garden,
West Delhi - 110022

April 22, 2024

The Manager
Rockfield Pvt. Ltd.
Bhopal

Subject: Application for the post of Accountant

Dear Sir/Madam,

In response to your advertisement for an accountant position, I am submitting my application along with my resume. With a strong foundation in accounting principles and a commitment to accuracy and detail, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to Rockfield Pvt. Ltd.

Thank you for considering my application.

Warm regards

Raman Kumar

Enclosed: Resume

RESUME

Raman Kumar

Address: C-23/12, Rajouri Garden, West Delhi - 110022

Phone: +91 999XXXXX77

Email: rkumar@email.com

Father's Name: Shailesh Kumar

Objective:

To apply my accounting knowledge and detail-oriented work ethic as an Accountant at Rockfield Pvt. Ltd.

Education:

- B.Com in Accountancy
University of Bhopal, Graduated 2023

Skills:

- Proficient in accounting software and Excel
- Strong numerical and analytical abilities
- Efficient organizational skills

Experience:

- Accounting Intern
XYZ Finance Co., Bhopal (Jan 2023 - Mar 2023)
- Assisted with bookkeeping and tax preparation

Languages: English, Hindi

Raman Kumar

(Signature)

Key Takeaways

A CV (Curriculum Vitae) provides a comprehensive detail of one's academic and professional experiences, used mostly in academic or research roles. A resume is a concise summary, typically one to two pages, highlighting relevant job experience and skills for a specific position. Bio-data focuses on personal particulars including marital status, religion, and other personal information, often used in certain parts of Asia.

MISCELLANEOUS EXERCISE

Note: All details presented in the questions are imaginary and created for assessment purposes.

Letter to Editor

Practise and write the following letters in about 120-150 words. (5 m)

- Despite the constant efforts by local municipalities and concerned citizens, public parks are increasingly turning into littered spaces. The careless attitude of park visitors, who discard trash without using the bins, is proving harmful for the environment. Write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper, expressing your concern about littering in public parks. Discuss the reasons behind such irresponsible behavior and suggest measures to create awareness and ensure cleanliness. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to craft this letter. You are Karan Mehta, a concerned local resident.

Awareness Campaigns:

Target audience: General public, especially younger generation.

Methods: In-person workshops, social media platforms.

Reasons for Littering:

Careless attitude of visitors.

Lack of civic sense.

Impact:

Environmental challenges.

Enforcement Measures:

Fines and penalties for littering.

Strengthening park monitoring forces.

Use of technology for monitoring cleanliness.

- With the increasing influence of social media, many individuals, especially the youth, are experiencing heightened feelings of inadequacy due to unrealistic standards set by influencers and celebrities. This has led to severe mental health issues among many. Write a letter to the editor of a prominent monthly magazine, sharing your concern, and understanding the implications of such behaviour. Provide suggestions to mitigate these feelings of inadequacy and promote healthy social media consumption. Use the given cues along with your thoughts to draft this letter. You are Arijit Banerjee, a college student and an active social media user.

For awareness -

Schools/colleges

Workshops on healthy social media usage

Negative Impact -

Low self-esteem

Comparison with peers

Solutions -

Mindful consumption

Digital detox sessions

- Despite being an essential component of road safety infrastructure, many people do not respect zebra crossings and fail to follow traffic rules, which results in hazardous situations on the roads. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, sharing your concern, and examining the reasons for such behaviour. Provide suggestions for spreading awareness of rules and etiquettes involved, and ways to ensure adherence. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this letter. You are Soma Baruah, a concerned city resident. (CBSE SQP, 2023)

• For awareness -

→ general public/educational institutions

→ how? - In person/social media

• Dire consequences - self and others

• Adherence -

→ fines & penalties

→ revoking driving licenses

→ strengthening traffic police force - monitoring resources and technology

- You are Anushka/Amit staying at A-23/1, Ashok Nagar, Delhi. You find it disturbing that despite a ban on smoking in public places, people are seen smoking in cities. It shows a lack of civic sense in the people. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily expressing your concern about indifference of people to their own as well as others' health. Provide suggestions to sensitize city dwellers about the safe environment. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this letter.

• Adverse environmental effects of smoking

• Ways to prevent it

- Draft a letter to the editor of a renowned daily in 120-150 words on the need to keep our surroundings clean to avoid outbreak of common diseases like malaria and dengue. You are Bharat/Bharati. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to compose this letter. (CBSE, 2023)

DONT STORE WATER

DONT EXPOSE
YOUR SKIN

PROTECT YOURSELF FROM
DENGUE & MALARIA

APPLY
SOSQUITO
REPELLANTS

SLEEP UNDER
MOSQUITTO NETS

FIGHT THE BITE.....

KEEP SURROUNDINGS CLEAN TAKE CHARGE

6. The recent rise in the number of accidents at local playgrounds has raised concerns among parents. Using the given pointers and your own ideas, write a letter to the editor of a local newspaper highlighting the issue and suggesting safety measures. You are Priya Rajan, a resident of Park Lane, Mumbai.

For awareness:

- Target group: Parents and local authorities
- How: Community meetings, social media campaigns

Safety measures:

- Installation of soft floor mats
- Regular inspection and maintenance of playground equipment
- Training sessions for children on using equipment safely

7. As Sarah Alter, a student at Lotus World Residential School, Nainital, you've observed the littering issue, in and around the city, during the tourist season. Discuss the environmental and community impact of this littering problem caused by most tourists and suggest measures to address it, in a letter to the Editor of 'The Himalayan Bugle'. Use the given cues along with your own ideas to create this letter in about 120-150 words. (CBSE APQ, 2023)

Description of the issue – Consequences (environmental)
- Impact on the community (local residents) – Solutions –
Appeal for awareness & significance of a clean environment

8. With the rise in cyberbullying incidents, there is a growing concern among parents and educators about the safety of children and teenagers online. Write a letter to the editor of a popular magazine, expressing your apprehensions about this trend and suggesting preventive measures. Use the given pointers along with your own perspectives. You are Nitish Verma, a high school teacher.

- For awareness:
 - School workshops on cyberbullying
 - Parental monitoring of online activities
- Adherence:
 - Enforce strict online rules in schools
 - Provide counseling for victims

9. Lifestyle diseases such as diabetes, obesity, hypertension, and heart diseases have increased in India. 53% of deaths in India are due to lifestyle diseases. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily about the issue and your understanding of the reasons behind the same. Offer suggestions on how one can reduce their risk of having such diseases and on ways to cope with them. You may use the following cues to compose the letter. You are Shriya Rawat, a concerned citizen. (CBSE APQ, 2023)

Consequences:

- leads to a poor quality of life mentally and physically
- increases the cost of health care
- can reduce life expectancy and cause early deaths

Solutions:

- follow a balanced diet
- incorporate some form of exercise that is sustainable
- get regular blood tests to check our health status

Application for a Job with Bio-Data

Practise and write the following letters in about 120-150 words. (5 m)

1. Recently, you came across a radio advertisement about a vacancy for a Music Director at the renowned 'Raaga Melodies' recording studio in Bengaluru. As Rohit Mehta who recently graduated from Delhi School of Music, write a letter expressing your desire to apply for the advertised role. Highlight your qualifications and experience in the resume attached.

♫ **Raaga Melodies Recording Studio** ♫

◆ Vacancy Alert!

Position: ♫ Music Director ♫

Location: Bengaluru

Roles and Responsibilities:

- Oversee and direct the music production process.
- Collaborate with artists, lyricists, and sound engineers.
- Contribute to the creative direction of music albums.

Qualifications:

- A degree/diploma from a recognized music school.
- Familiarity with both classical and modern music genres.
- Strong leadership and communication skills.

Experience:

- Fresh graduates are welcome.
- Prior experience in music direction will be a plus.

Benefits:

- Competitive salary package.
- Opportunity to work with renowned artists.
- Modern recording and production facilities.

Interested candidates are requested to send their detailed resume and sample works to raagamelodies@mail.com.

◆ Last Date for Applications: 29th April, 2024

Join us and create symphonies that touch souls! 🎵🎹

2. You are Sheena Singh, a recent graduate of High Horizon School. You came across the following advertisement about an internship in editing that you would like to apply for. Write a letter to Books Galore, expressing your interest in the position along with your resume. (CBSE APQ, 2023)



Books Galore

We are a non-profit organisation that works with underprivileged children. Our goal is not only to make reading possible, but also enjoyable!

SEEKING EDITORS

For the children's magazine
Internship for 3 months (May-July 2025) with a monthly pay

Your role:

- Edit children's entries (stories, poems, essays)
- Make sure content is free of grammatical errors
- Meet publishing deadlines for the magazine

Requirements:

- Senior Secondary Education Degree or above (Above 80% in Grade XII English Exam)
- Excellent command over the English language
- Positive attitude and willingness to learn

Send a sample of your writing and your resume to: internhr@booksgalore.org
Deadline: 14th April, 2025

3. You are Aisha Roy, a recent graduate with a Bachelor's degree in Computer Science from ABC University, Kolkata. You came across the following advertisement:

TechCo Innovations

SOFTWARE ENGINEERS WANTED

For our new branch in Kolkata

Opportunity for budding tech enthusiasts!

WHO DO WE NEED?

Fresh Graduates, Experienced developers - All are welcome

REQUIREMENTS: Bachelor's degree in Computer Science or related field, proficiency in Java and Python, problem-solving aptitude, and good teamwork skills.

Please send your Bio-Data to TechCo Headquarters, Suite 304, XYZ

Towers, Salt Lake City, Kolkata (latest by 15th May 2024).

4. While browsing a travel magazine, you stumbled upon an advertisement from 'Wanderlust Travels', a well-known travel agency. They are in search of Travel Consultants who have good knowledge about global destinations, who have strong communication skills, and possess a degree in Travel & Tourism. Candidates with a passion for exploring and suggesting travel destinations are preferred. Use the following advertisement as reference and write a letter along with your updated bio-data to apply for the position.

Wanderlust Travels

TRAVEL CONSULTANTS WANTED!

Join our dynamic team to guide world travelers.

Required:

- Degree in Travel & Tourism
- In-depth knowledge of international destinations
- Excellent communication skills

Apply at: Wanderlust Travels, Suite 501, Azure Towers, New Delhi.

(Latest by 28th May, 2024)

5. You are Damanjit Singh, a fresh graduate of film-making (BFA), from JTTI, Chandigarh. You saw the given advertisement in the newspaper and wish to apply for the position advertised. Write a letter to Mili Johar Arts, along with your bio-data, expressing your interest in the advertised post. (CBSE SQP, 2023)



Mili Johar ARTS

ASSISTANT DIRECTORS wanted

For Feature Film

Opportunity for aspiring Assistant Directors

WHO DO WE NEED?

Freshers, Experienced, both welcome

REQUIRED -Degree/ Diploma in Film Making

Skills : Camera handling, functional knowledge of Marathi, exceptional communication skills and ability to multi-task

Please send your resumes to- The Johar House, Offices 05-06, (latest by 23 July 2023) Dnyanesh, Mumbai

6. You are Antara Rathore/Ashish Rathore of 17, Vinoba Nagar, Bhopal. You would like to apply for the post of Marketing Manager in an MNC in Delhi. Write a letter in 120-150 words giving your bio-data to the Director, Chipmunk Enterprises, D-7 Vikas Marg, Delhi, applying for the job.
7. You are Anil/Anita of Vasant Road, Lucknow. You saw the given advertisement in the newspaper and wish to apply for the position advertised. Write a letter of application in 120-150 words along with a detailed biodata. (CBSE, 2023)

Credence Pvt. Ltd.

Required: Food Technologist

Preferred Skills and Qualifications:

2 years degree/diploma in Food Technology, having minimum 2 years Lab experience.

Competency in basic computer skills.

Send your bio-data within 10 days to Manager, Credence Pvt. Ltd., Hazratganj, Lucknow.

For further details, check our website: www.credence.com.

8. You are Roshni Iyer, a recent graduate in Hospitality Management from GHM Institute, Pune. You came across the following advertisement in a leading daily:

Global Deluxe Resorts

Front Desk Manager Wanted

For our upcoming luxurious resort in Goa
Opportunity for dynamic hospitality graduates

Who do we need?

Freshers & experienced candidates are both welcome.

Required: Bachelor's Degree in Hospitality Management

Skills: Fluent in English and Konkani, effective interpersonal abilities, computer proficiency.

Please send your resumes to: The HR Department, Global Deluxe Resorts, Building 11, Miramar Road, Goa.

(latest by 15th May, 2024)

Write a letter to Global Deluxe Resorts, along with your bio-data, expressing your interest in the advertised post.

9. You are Vihan Kapadia, a recent Commerce graduate from the National College of Commerce, Surat, looking for a job. You came across the following advertisement in the Classifieds columns of a national daily. You think the job requirements are a good fit for your skills/personality. Write a letter along with your biodata, expressing your interest in the advertised post.

(CBSE APQ, 2023)

Star-Bharat Lever Limited

12, Greater Kent I, Hyderabad -500001

WANTED

Marketing Executives, for launching of new products. All zones of Andhra Pradesh & Telangana. Driven, goal-oriented fresh Commerce graduates, with good communication skills & the ability to multitask may apply. Working knowledge of AI tools - mandatory.

Apply within 7 days to the Manager, HR.

Letter to Editor

1. 456, Block- C
Malviya Nagar
Delhi

April 18, 2024

The Editor
Local Daily News
Delhi

Subject: Call for action against littering in Public Parks

Dear Sir/ Madam,

I am Karan Mehta, a resident deeply concerned about the growing litter problem in our public parks. Despite numerous bins, visitors continue to discard trash carelessly, reflecting a lack of civic sense and awareness about environmental consequences.

This behaviour not only degrades our parks but also presents significant environmental challenges. To combat this, I propose targeted awareness campaigns, especially for the younger generation, through in-person workshops and social media platforms.

Additionally, implementing stricter fines and enhancing park monitoring with technology can deter littering. Strengthening our community's commitment to cleanliness is crucial for the health and beauty of our shared spaces.

Yours sincerely

Karan Mehta
Local Resident

2. 42, Lake Road
Kolkata - 700029

April 21, 2024

The Editor
Pioneer Monthly Magazine
Kolkata - 700015

Subject: The need for Healthy Social Media practices among Youth

Dear Sir/ Madam,

I am Arijit Banerjee, a college student, concerned about how social media influences the mental health of young users. The unrealistic standards set by influencers and celebrities

often lead to feelings of inadequacy, resulting in low self-esteem and harmful comparisons among peers.

To combat these negative effects, I suggest schools and colleges implement workshops focusing on healthy social media usage. Educating students on the curated nature of content they view online can promote more realistic perceptions and healthier engagement.

Additionally, promoting strategies like mindful consumption and organizing digital detox sessions can help mitigate these issues, ensuring a balanced approach to social media usage.

Sincerely

Arijit Banerjee

3. A- 302, Shivalik
New Delhi
Pin-110031

April 17, 2024

The Editor
National Daily
New Delhi

Subject: Need for better awareness and adherence to Zebra Crossing Rules

Sir,

I'm writing as a worried citizen about people ignoring zebra crossings and traffic rules. This careless behavior leads to dangerous situations every day on our streets.

It seems some don't understand how serious this is, both for their safety and others. Maybe they're in a hurry or just don't know the rules well. We need to teach everyone, in schools and through social media, why these rules matter.

To get people to follow the rules, we should talk about the big risks and the fines for breaking them. If someone doesn't listen, maybe they should lose their chance to drive for a while. Also, we should give our traffic police better tools and training to catch and stop rule-breakers.

Let's work together to make our roads safer.

Yours truly

Soma Baruah



Nailing the Right Answer

- Include an appeal to the readers or authorities to take action and raise awareness about the issue.
- Emphasize the significance of safety and how it impacts both individuals and the community.

4. A-23/1,

Ashok Nagar, Delhi

April 20, 2024

The Editor

The Hindu

New Delhi

Subject: Concern over Public Smoking and the need for Civic Sense

Sir/ Madam,

I am Amit, residing in Ashok Nagar, Delhi, writing to express my concern about the ongoing issue of smoking in public spaces despite a clear ban. This behavior not only disregards individual health but also adversely affects our environment, contributing to air pollution and endangering non-smokers through passive smoking.

To combat this, I suggest rigorous enforcement of the smoking ban coupled with heavier penalties for violations. Public awareness campaigns can also educate citizens about the health risks of smoking and its environmental impact. Such initiatives could include informative posters in public areas and community workshops.

Let's work together to ensure a healthier and cleaner environment for all city dwellers.

Yours sincerely

Amit



Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

- Students might not follow the standard letter format. They may omit or misplace components such as the date, recipient's address, or subject line.
- They may not align elements correctly (e.g., placing the sender's address on the right instead of the left).

5. Abhinav Colony

New Delhi

Pin- 112203

April 16, 2024

The Editor

Local Daily

New Delhi

Subject: Urgent need for clean surroundings to prevent disease outbreaks

Sir,

I want to talk about something important: keeping our places clean to stay away from sicknesses like malaria and dengue. Lately, more people are falling sick, and it's worrying.

We know mosquitoes cause these illnesses, and they love dirty water. So, we shouldn't let water collect anywhere like in buckets or pots outside. Also, throwing trash properly can help a lot because if our lanes and parks are clean, mosquitoes won't have a place to live.

It helps to use things like mosquito cream and sleep under nets to keep them away. But, to really fix this problem, we all need to work together to keep everything tidy and clean.

Together, we can make sure fewer people get sick just by making sure our homes and streets are clean.

Thanking you.

Yours sincerely

Bharat/Bharati

6. Park Lane,

Mumbai - 400001

April 21, 2024

The Editor

The Mumbai Times

Mumbai

Subject: Urgent need for Safer Playground conditions

Sir/ Madam,

I am Priya Rajan from Park Lane, Mumbai, and I am writing to express growing concerns over the increasing number of accidents in our local playgrounds. These incidents highlight the urgent need for enhanced safety measures.

To prevent further accidents, we should consider installing soft floor mats, ensuring regular inspection and maintenance of playground equipment, and organizing safety training sessions for children.

Additionally, raising awareness is crucial. I propose community meetings and social media campaigns targeted at parents and local authorities to emphasize the importance of playground safety.

Let's collaborate to create a safe play environment for our children, where the joy of play isn't overshadowed by the risk of injury.

Sincerely
Priya Rajan

7. Lotus World Residential School
Nainital

April 18, 2024

The Editor
The Himalayan Bugle
Nainital

Subject: Urgent action needed against tourist littering in Nainital

Sir,

I am Sarah Alter, a student from Lotus World Residential School, concerned about the increasing littering by tourists in Nainital. This issue not only spoils our beautiful landscapes but also endangers local wildlife, as they mistakenly consume discarded waste.

The local community is disheartened, seeing their town's natural charm diminish, affecting both the living environment and tourism-dependent livelihoods. I propose stricter penalties for littering, more waste bins in tourist areas, and educational campaigns to promote environmental awareness among visitors.

We must unite to maintain Nainital's cleanliness for our pride and prosperity. Please help us raise awareness and encourage responsible tourism.

Yours sincerely
Sarah Alter

Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

- The letter might lack a proper closing statement, such as a call for action or a sign-off like "Yours sincerely."
- Students might forget to include their name or other identifying information at the end of the letter.

8. 10, Green Lane
New Delhi
110027

April 21, 2024

The Editor
Royal Magazine
New Delhi - 110001

Subject: Urgent call for action against Cyberbullying

Dear Sir/ Madam,

I am Nitish Verma, a high school teacher, deeply concerned about the increasing incidents of cyberbullying affecting our children and teenagers. This disturbing trend is threatening the safety and well-being of young internet users.

To combat this, schools should conduct workshops to educate students about the dangers of cyberbullying and the importance of respectful online behavior. Parents must also actively monitor their children's online activities to prevent exposure to harmful content and interactions.

Additionally, schools need to enforce strict online rules and provide counseling for victims to support their recovery and ensure a safe digital environment for all students.

Together, we can create a safer online environment for our youth.

Sincerely
Nitish Verma

9. 42, Lake Road
Kolkata - 700029

April 18, 2024

The Editor
National Daily
Kolkata

Subject: Urgent need to address lifestyle diseases in India

Sir,

The rise of diseases like diabetes and heart problems is a big worry in India. It's shocking that these lifestyle diseases cause more than half of all deaths in our country. The way we live—eating too much junk food, not moving enough, and always being stressed—is making us sick and shortening our lives.

We need to eat better, with lots of fruits and veggies, and cut down on sugar and oily stuff. Also, finding an exercise we like and can keep doing is super important. And, getting regular blood tests can help us stay on track with our health.

If we start changing how we live, we can fight these diseases and live longer, healthier lives.

Yours truly
Shriya Rawat

Application for a Job with Bio-Data

1. Apartment 304,
Melody Manor, Koramangala
Bengaluru - 560034

April 22, 2024

The Hiring Manager
Raaga Melodies Recording Studio
Bengaluru

Subject: Application for the position of Music Director

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am Rohit Mehta, a fresh graduate from the Delhi School of Music, writing to express my interest in the Music Director vacancy at Raaga Melodies. With formal education in music and hands-on experience in music direction, I believe I can contribute positively to your team.

Enclosed is my resume detailing my qualifications and experience. I am keen on the opportunity to work with esteemed artists at your studio.

Yours sincerely

Rohit Mehta

Enclosed: Resume

RESUME

Rohit Mehta

Apartment 304,
Melody Manor, Koramangala
Bengaluru - 560034

Contact: rohit.mehta@email.com | +91 98765XXXXX

Father's Name: Ranvir Mehta

Objective:

To channel my passion for music and skills in direction to create inspiring symphonies with Raaga Melodies.

Education:

- **Diploma in Music Direction**
Delhi School of Music, 2023

Skills:

- Knowledge of classical and modern music
- Leadership and teamwork
- Excellent communication

Experience:

- **Assistant Music Director**

Worked on a graduation project that included orchestration and album production.

Languages: English, Hindi

Rohit Mehta

(Signature)



Mistakes 101 : What not to do!

- Forgetting to include contact information, or neglecting to mention availability for an interview.
- Not specifying the position being applied for in the subject line or first paragraph.

2. High Horizon School

New Delhi

April 21, 2024

Internship Coordinator

Books Galore

Email: interngh@booksgalore.org

Subject: Application for Editing Internship

Dear Sir,

I'm Sheena Singh, a recent graduate of High Horizon School. I'm excited to apply for the Editor Internship at your children's magazine as advertised. With a strong command of English and a love for creating engaging content for young readers, I am eager to contribute to your mission.

Please find my resume attached for your consideration. Thank you for this opportunity, and I look forward to potentially joining your team.

Warm regards

Sheena Singh

Enclosed: Resume

RESUME

Sheena Singh

High Horizon School

Contact: +91 1234567890 | sheena_singh@gmail.com

Objective:

To obtain the Editor Internship at Books Galore, offering my skills in writing and editing, as well as my enthusiasm for educating children.

Education: High Horizon School, New Delhi, Class XII

Skills:

- Good at English writing and grammar
- Can work on time and pay attention to details

Achievements:

- Head of School's English Literary Club
- Editor of the school magazine for 2 years

Interests: Reading, writing, and volunteer work

Looking forward to bringing my dedication and creativity to Books Galore.

Sheena Singh
(Signature)

3. 123 Park Street,
Kolkata

April 25, 2024

The Hiring Manager,
TechCo Innovations
Suite 304, XYZ Towers,
Salt Lake City, Kolkata

Subject: Application for the Software Engineer position

Sir/ Madam,

I am a recent Computer Science graduate from ABC University, Kolkata, eager to apply for the Software Engineer role at TechCo Innovations. With a strong foundation in Java and Python and a keen problem-solving aptitude, I am ready to contribute to and grow with your team.

Please find my bio-data enclosed. I look forward to the opportunity to discuss my application further.

Warm regards
Aisha Roy

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Aisha Roy

Address: 123 Park Street, Kolkata - 700091

Phone: (123) 456-7890

Email: aisharoy@email.com

Educational Qualification:

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science - ABC University, Kolkata (2020-2023) [GPA: 8.5/10]

Technical Skills:

Languages: Java, Python

Tools: Git, Eclipse, PyCharm

Familiar with Agile methodologies

Project Experience:

Smart Home Controller App (Java): Developed an application to control smart devices in homes using Java.

E-commerce Website (Python): Designed and developed a basic e-commerce site using Python and Flask.

Languages: English, Hindi, Bengali

Interests: Coding challenges, Robotics, Tech Blogging

Eager to join TechCo Innovations and bring my tech skills to your new Kolkata branch.

Aisha Roy
(Signature)

4. A-302, Jasmine Courts,
Gurgaon - 122018

April 25, 2024

HR Department,
Wanderlust Travels,
Suite 501, Azure Towers,
New Delhi - 110020

Subject: Application for the position of Travel Consultant

Dear Hiring Manager,

I came across your advertisement in a travel magazine and am excited to apply for the Travel Consultant position. With a degree in Travel & Tourism and extensive knowledge of international travel destinations, I am eager to assist clients in crafting their dream vacations.

Enclosed is my bio-data for your review. I look forward to potentially joining Wanderlust Travels and sharing my passion for exploration.

Warm regards
Arnav Ranjan

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Arnav Ranjan

A-302, Jasmine Courts

Gurgaon - 122018

Phone: 98765-43210

Email: arnavranjan@email.com

Educational Qualification:

Bachelor's Degree in Travel & Tourism, Delhi University, Delhi (2019 - 2022)

Skills: In-depth destination knowledge, excellent communication

Experience: Internship at GlobeTrotters Travel Agency

Languages: English, Hindi

Hobbies:

- Travel photography
- Documenting travel experiences through writing
- Engaging in cultural exchange

I'm enthusiastic about guiding travelers to their next adventure with Wanderlust Travels.

Arnav Ranjan
(Signature)

5. House No. 44,
Sector 17D,
Chandigarh,
India - 160017
April 22, 2024

The Hiring Manager
Mili Johar Arts
Assistant Directors Division
Mumbai

Subject: Application for the Position of Assistant Director

Sir,

I recently graduated with a BFA in Filmmaking from JTTI, Chandigarh, and am writing to apply for the Assistant Director position as advertised. I am eager to bring my passion for cinema and academic knowledge to a practical setting.

Please find my bio-data below for your consideration. I am ready to learn and contribute to your creative team. Thank you for this opportunity.

Warm regards
Damanjit Singh

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Damanjit Singh

House No. 44, Sector 17D,

Chandigarh, India

Email: damanjit_s@outlook.com

Phone: 98765XXXXX

Objective:

I am a new graduate in Filmmaking aiming to join Mili Johar Arts as an Assistant Director to put my learning and love for movies into action.

Education: Bachelor of Fine Arts in Filmmaking, JTTI, Chandigarh

Skills: Script analysis, Team coordination, Basic video editing

Languages: English, Hindi, Punjabi

Internship Experience:

- Assisted in planning and managing shoots at Dreamcatcher Film Studio, Chandigarh

Interests:

- Making short films and storytelling
- Learning about new movie-making technologies

Damanjit Singh
(Signature)

6. 17, Vinoba Nagar,
Bhopal

April 22, 2024

The Director,
Chipmunk Enterprises,
D-7 Vikas Marg, Delhi

Subject: Application for the position of Marketing Manager

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in the Marketing Manager position at your esteemed MNC, as advertised. With substantial experience in market analysis and strategic implementation, I am confident in my ability to contribute to your company's growth.

Enclosed is my biodata for your consideration. I am looking forward to the opportunity to discuss how my skills and experiences align with the needs of Chipmunk Enterprises.

Yours sincerely
Antara Rathore

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Name: Antara Rathore

Father's Name: Ashish Rathore

Address: 17, Vinoba Nagar, Bhopal

Educational Qualification: MBA in Marketing from ABC Institute, Bhopal

Work Experience: 5 years in marketing and sales

Skills: Strategic planning, team leadership, strong communication

Languages: English, Hindi

Contact: +91 9876543210 | antara.ashish@email.com

Eager to bring my market knowledge and leadership skills to your dynamic team.

Antara Rathore

(Signature)

7. Vasant Road,

Lucknow

April 22, 2024

The Manager

Credence Pvt. Ltd.

Hazratganj, Lucknow

Subject: Application for the position of Food Technologist

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am writing to express my interest in the position of Food Technologist as advertised in the newspaper. I have a diploma in Food Technology and 2 years of lab experience, as required. Additionally, I am proficient in basic computer skills. I believe my background aligns with your requirements and I am excited about the opportunity to work with your team.

I look forward to hearing from you and discussing my application further. Thank you for your consideration.

Yours sincerely

Anita

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Name: Anita Yadav

Father's Name: Rahul Yadav

Date of Birth: March 16, 1998

Address: Vasant Road, Lucknow

Contact : +91-1234567890

Email id: anita.yadav@gmail.com

Marital Status: Unmarried

Nationality: Indian

Academic Qualification:

- B.Sc. in Food Technology from Lucknow University

- M.Sc. in Food Technology from Lucknow University

Experience: 2 years of Lab experience in the Food Processing Industry

Languages Known: Hindi, English

Hobbies: Reading, Painting

Anita Yadav

(Signature)

8. 45, Mangalore Street,

Pune - 411010

May 10, 2024

The HR Department,

Global Deluxe Resorts,

Building 11, Miramar Road,

Goa

Subject: Application for the position of Front Desk Manager

Dear Sir/Madam,

As a recent graduate in Hospitality Management from GHM Institute, Pune, I am excited to apply for the Front Desk Manager position at Global Deluxe Resorts, Goa. My educational background and language skills in English and Konkani, along with my proficiency in computer usage, prepare me to contribute effectively to your esteemed resort.

Please find my biodata attached for your review. I look forward to the possibility of discussing my application in further detail.

Yours sincerely

Roshni Iyer

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Name: Roshni Iyer

Father's Name: Mr. Rajan Iyer

Date of Birth: February 12, 2001

Address: 45, Mangalore Street, Pune - 411010

Nationality: Indian

Languages Known: English, Konkani, Hindi, and Marathi

Qualification:

- Bachelor's Degree in Hospitality Management

Skills:

- Good at talking to people, solving problems
- Knows how to use computers well

Contact: roshni.iyer@email.com | +91 9009009001

I am keen to bring my enthusiasm and hospitality skills to the Global Deluxe Resorts team.

Roshni Iyer

(Signature)

Nailing the Right Answer

Biodata should be concise. Including too much information can overwhelm the reader and bury important details.

9. National College of Commerce,
Surat

April 23, 2024

The Manager, HR
Star-Bharat Lever Limited
12, Greater Kent I
Hyderabad - 500001

Subject: Application for the Post of Marketing Executive

Dear Sir/Madam,

I am a fresh Commerce graduate from the National College of Commerce, Surat, and am keen to join Star-Bharat Lever Limited as a Marketing Executive. My academic

background and good communication skills, coupled with a strong understanding of AI tools, align well with the job requirements.

Enclosed is my biodata for your consideration. I am enthusiastic about contributing to the successful launch of new products across Andhra Pradesh and Telangana.

Warm regards

Vihan Kapadia

Enclosed: Bio-data

BIO-DATA

Name: Vihan Kapadia

Father's Name: Vishwanath Kapadia

Address: Vijay Nagar, Surat

Qualification:

- B.Com Graduate, National College of Commerce, Surat

Skills:

- Good communication and multitasking
- Proficient with AI tools

Experience: Internship with a local marketing firm

Languages: English, Hindi, Telugu

Contact: vihan.kapadia@email.com |
+91 999XXXXXX77

I am excited about the prospect of working with Star-Bharat Lever Limited and hope to contribute to your team.

Vihan Kapadia

(Signature)

